



LJS 419

Erbario

*An Illustrated Herbal of the Veneto
Northern Italy · fifteenth century*

*A page-by-page reading edition — transcription, English
translation,
botanical identification and commentary*

University of Pennsylvania · Schoenberg Collection · Oversize LJS 419
public domain facsimile (OPenn / BiblioPhilly)

*An independent working edition prepared from the public-domain
facsimile*

by P. Mamontov, with Claude (Anthropic) · 2026



About this Edition

Final edition — checked, consolidated & extended (04.07.2026).

Page-by-page transcription (f. [i], 1r-99v) with English translation of all noted leaves and plant identifications (old & modern names) under per-entry **Confidence** grading. This revision adds, on every uncertain leaf, a **Name-image relationship** classification (agreement / conflation / conflict / unresolved) and a **structured-morphology** field, and — for the many "cryptic" headings — their **tradition-name and Segre Rutz number** keyed to the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the ~98-plant tradition edited by Segre Rutz; see the companion concordance). Part II summary & conclusion; Part III replication data; Appendix A palaeographic key; Appendix B on how the plant identifications were made; Appendix C on how the readings were recovered (enhancement, segmentation, a fallible HTR cross-check, evidence grades, and the integrity guards). All entries follow one uniform template; numbering verified; the **cryptic-name and dense-note leaves were re-read at master-TIFF resolution** and aligned against the alchemical-herbal manuscript tradition. An experimental handwriting-recognition tool was consulted only as a secondary aid in checking difficult readings (see §G); every reading printed here is the editors' own judgement from the images.

Repository: Kislak Center for Special Collections, Rare Books and Manuscripts, University of Pennsylvania — Lawrence J. Schoenberg Collection, **Oversize LJS 419**.

Title: *Erbario* (so named in 15th-century ink on the upper cover) — an illustrated herbal / *Kräuterbuch*.

Origin: Northern Italy, **15th century**; the language of the notes points specifically to the **Veneto**. (*The Penn catalogue dates it "Italy, 1400" — very likely a round-number estimate; the broader "15th century" is used here as the safer span.*)

Support & extent: Paper, **100 leaves** (collation: [i], 1-99), foliation in ink, upper-right recto. Leaf size **245 x 176 mm**, bound to **254 x 190 mm**.



Quire structure (per catalogue): $1^1 2^{10}(-1) 3-10^8 11^3 12^8(-1) 13-14^8$.
(The catalogue records the first quire more tentatively as $[1]^2(-1?)$; the single-leaf reading given here is one interpretation of an uncertain first gathering.)

Script: A **humanistic cursive** hand for the notes; plant-names are written as headings, usually upper-left or upper-centre, occasionally in red.

Languages: **Italian** (Veneto dialect) with some **Latin**, and many names in a Latinate/vernacular mix; a number of names are corrupt or phonetic.

Illustration: Three campaigns are distinguishable — (1) **medieval-convention coloured** plants, sometimes with *fantastic elements* (human or animal faces in the roots/leaves), generally on **recto** pages; (2) a rougher, **more naturalistic ink-outline** group on **verso** pages or added beside earlier images; (3) **naturalistic coloured** plants (root, leaf, flower, fruit) on **verso** pages. About a **quarter** of the leaves carry written notes on medicinal properties and preparation, set around — and sometimes over — the drawings.

Binding: Contemporary (15th-century) **limp parchment**; remnants of ties on three sides; "Erbario" inked on the upper cover.

Rights: The images and content are **free of known copyright restrictions and in the public domain** (Creative Commons Public Domain Mark); facsimile on OPenn and BiblioPhilly.

Scope & status. This is an **independent scholarly working edition**, prepared from the public-domain facsimile to facilitate reading and study of the manuscript. It is not affiliated with or endorsed by any institution. Transcriptions and translations record the manuscript evidence; identifications and commentary are graded editorial inference. **Difficult readings and plant identifications remain open to revision** as higher-quality images and comparative evidence become available.

How to read this edition

This is a **page-by-page (folio-by-folio) reading edition** of LJS 419, prepared directly from the digitised facsimile. For every leaf it gives,



as far as the evidence allows:

1. **Folio & image** — the manuscript's own ink foliation (f. 1r ... f. 99v) and the corresponding facsimile page. *Conversion:* f. **_N_r** = **PDF image 2N+3**; f. **_N_v** = **2N+4** (so f. 1r = image 5). The unfoliated front leaf is cited as f. [i].
2. **Heading (transcription)** — the plant-name written on the leaf, transcribed exactly as it stands (15th-century spelling), with [?] for a doubtful reading.
3. **Identification** — the most probable **modern botanical identity**: accepted scientific name (genus *species*), family, and common English/Italian names. Identifications rest on the picture **and** the period name together; where the two disagree, or the drawing is too schematic, the entry says so. Uncertain identifications are marked (*tentative*).
4. **Botanical description (from the drawing)** — what the illustration actually shows (habit, root, leaf arrangement, flower, fruit, colour, any "fantastic" elements), and how faithfully it matches the real plant.
5. **Medicinal & historical note** — the plant's place in the medieval/Renaissance *materia medica* (humoral qualities, the ailments it treated, classical and Salernitan authorities), which is the practical purpose of a herbal like this.
6. **Notes — transcription & translation** — where the leaf carries written medicinal notes, the **Italian/Latin text** is transcribed (best-effort, see below) and given an **English translation**.

Confidence ratings and how commentary is calibrated

Every entry opens with a **Confidence** tag, and the **depth of the medicinal/historical commentary is deliberately tied to it** — so that no entry "writes half a page about a plant that has not been identified":

- **Secure** — name *and* drawing agree on a modern identity = full *materia medica* commentary.
- **Probable** — identity well-supported but not certain = moderate commentary.
- **Tentative** — identification rests largely on a stylised drawing or a partly-corrupt name = only a brief, explicitly conditional note ("if this



is X ...; inference from the picture, not the text").

- **Unresolved** — name corrupt/illegible and drawing too schematic = **no medicinal claim** beyond stating the possibilities.
- **Blank leaf** — unfinished page; no content.

What "Secure" rests on — three kinds of certainty. A 15th-century herbal drawing is *not* a botanical plate: artists copied earlier copies, stylised, merged features, and added symbolism, so a correct reading of the *picture* is not the same as a correct reading of the *plant*. Accordingly, certainty here has two independent legs — the **heading-name** and the **drawing** — and a **Secure** tag is qualified to say which legs carry it:

- **Secure (name + image)** — heading and drawing agree (e.g. f. 81r *Martagon*); the strongest case, written simply as **Secure**.
- **Secure (by name)** — the heading names a known plant but the **drawing diverges** (e.g. f. 70r *Spica nardo* drawn as an ivy-vine, f. 70v *Salvia silvatica* drawn as a fern); the certainty is about the *intended* plant, not the picture, and the entry says so — i.e. **secure as to the name, not as to the depicted plant**; where the picture positively contradicts the name, a stricter reader may prefer **Probable**.
- **Secure (by image)** — the drawing is diagnostic even where the name is corrupt (e.g. the twin-tubered orchids, the dragon-arum spadix); here the *morphology* carries it.
- **Two-plant leaves**. A few leaves carry two captioned plants; the Confidence tier is the one for the plant that bears the **note** (named first), and the paired plant's status is stated beside it (e.g. f. 97v — *Erba pelaria* Secure, *Luzida* Unresolved).

So "I identified the drawing" and "I identified the plant" are kept distinct: every entry's *Drawing* line states what is actually depicted, separately from the named identity. **The order of evidence for an identification is (1) the drawing, then (2) the heading-name; the medicinal Commentary is never used as evidence for the identification.** This avoids circular reasoning — a plant is not identified because the expected medicinal profile fits, and a "probable" identity is not retroactively strengthened by the





commentary written on top of it.

Candidates on "Unresolved" entries are directions, not identifications. Where an unresolved entry suggests names (e.g. *gentian?* / *pellitory?* / *polypody?*), these are offered as **possible avenues for future identification only** — they are explicitly *not* part of the identification and carry no medicinal claim.

The reader should treat *Transcription* and (for the noted leaves) *Translation* as the primary evidence from the manuscript; *Identification & drawing* and *Commentary* as modern scholarly inference, graded by the tag — and should keep in mind that the *Commentary* draws on the wider medieval herbal tradition (Salernitan, *Circa instans*, Dioscorides/Pliny), which goes **beyond** what any single leaf states.

What the manuscript says vs. what the tradition says (provenance of every claim)

Because this is the question a hostile reviewer will press hardest, the rule is stated plainly and applies to every entry without exception:

- **Only the *Transcription*, *Translation*, and *Notes* — transcription report what is physically on the leaf.** These are the manuscript's own words. Where they are uncertain they are marked [?] / [...]; nothing is supplied there that the parchment does not carry.
- **The *Commentary* never reports manuscript content.** It is a modern synthesis of the external herbal tradition — Dioscorides, Pliny, the pseudo-Apuleius *Herbarius*, the Salernitan *Circa instans*, Mattioli, the doctrine of signatures, and standard *materia medica*. It explains what a plant of this identity *was held to do in that tradition*, not what this scribe wrote. A medicinal use should be read as "attested for this plant in the herbal tradition," **not** as "stated on this leaf," unless the same use also appears in that leaf's *Transcription/Translation*.
- **Where leaf and tradition coincide it is shown, not assumed.** When a note actually does record a use (e.g. f. 5v betony "breaks the urinary stone"), that use stands in the *Translation/Notes* in the manuscript's words; the *Commentary* may then add the tradition's fuller picture around it. The two layers are kept typographically and structurally





separate so they are never conflated.

In short: if a statement is not inside a *Transcription*, *Translation*, or *Notes* block, it does not claim manuscript support.

Transcription evidence grades (A-D)

Every reading carries an **evidence grade**, encoded by the notation and made explicit in a one-line **Evidence grade** tag at the foot of each entry that has a note:

- **A — directly visible:** read straight from the plain image; written plainly. **Expanded abbreviations** (square brackets attached inside a word, e.g. *p[er]*, *co[n]*, *stoma[co]*) are level A — the abbreviation mark is on the page; only the expansion is editorial.
- **B — visible after enhancement:** legible only after image processing (decorrelation stretch / Wallis / red-ink isolation / native-resolution re-read); the entry's editorial note names the method.
- **C — context-reconstructed:** a **whole word supplied** from sense, parallel passages, or standard herbal *topoi*, written as a **standalone bracketed word** [...] (not an abbreviation, not a layout marker).
- **D — conjectural:** a doubtful reading flagged with [?] (standalone or as [word?]).

Layout markers such as [left]/[right] and wholly lost text [...] are not graded. The per-entry tag counts how many words rest on each level, so a reader can see how much of an entry is parchment (A/B) versus editorial inference (C/D).

Formatting conventions for names

To keep transcription, naming and inference visually distinct: the manuscript's **headings and historical name-forms** (Latin or vernacular) are set in **bold** exactly as listed; **modern accepted scientific binomials** are *italicised* (and bold on the "Modern accepted" line for the one accepted name); binomials mentioned in running prose are *italic*. So a **bold-only** two-word name is a manuscript/old name, while an *italic* one is a modern botanical binomial.





The [?] marker: in an entry **heading** (the ### line), [?] appears when the *reading of the name itself* is doubtful (e.g. *Torogal[?]*); a confidently-read name carries no [?] in the heading even if other words on the leaf are uncertain. Inside the **Transcription**, [?] marks each individual doubtful word or letter. Headings whose name is wholly illegible are given a short readable fragment where one exists (e.g. [...] *cervina[?]*) or "[corrupt heading]" where none does.

A note on accuracy (please read)

The notes are written in a **fast 15th-century humanistic cursive**, heavily abbreviated, in a Veneto vernacular with idiosyncratic and phonetic spelling, and they are frequently **written around or over the illustration**, faded, or cropped at the gutter. Many passages are, in places, **at the limit of what can be read from the digital images**. Accordingly:

- Transcriptions are a **careful best-effort reading**. Doubtful words are marked [?], illegible or lost text [...], and editorial expansions/equivalents in []. Plant-names that are corrupt or phonetic are transcribed as written and identified in the *Identification* line.
- **Identifications of the plants are generally more secure than the readings of the prose**, because they draw on the morphology in the picture as well as the name. They remain scholarly best-judgements, not certainties, and are flagged when tentative.
- Nothing here is taken from a modern copyrighted edition; this is an independent reading of a public-domain manuscript, to be checked against the high-resolution facsimile (OPenn / BiblioPhilly) and the standard literature for a definitive text.





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Part I

The Plants, Folio by Folio



f. 77r — *Lucia da le nocte lumina*, the night-shining moon-herb



Preliminary leaves — flyleaf notes (not plant pages)

[Tentative — faint, abbreviated, later cursive hands]

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

(carta 3 · 0265_0002)

- 1
- 2 sugo d[e] cuscuta minore — ana[?] [...]
- 3 sugo d[e] cuscuta minore — 3 [...]
- 4 et mercurio — 3 i [...]
- 5 vrina d[e] put[o?] d[e] an[...] — 2 once 3 [...]
- 6 [...] al sole 2 giorni, 3 d[i?]; et [...]
- 7 fino tanto che vegni una aqua [...]
- 8 la dita materia chiara dolze[?] [...] el saze[?]
- 9 et fa[r] filtrar la dita aqua et [...] cernere[?]
- 10 la dita materia [...] et tor[a] il mercurio et m[et]to in uno [...]

(carta 4 · 0265_0003)

- 11 Rebis est lapis filosofor[um] qui nascitur,
- 12 ubi duos amantes et ubiq[ue] reperitur;
- 13 dicitur in sterquilin[i]is [esse?], i[n] cui[us], et tam
- 14 apud pauperes qua[m] divites invenitur.

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 12 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); D (8 marked [?]); 12x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Image 3: A recipe headed **juice of lesser dodder** (*sugo de cuscuta minore*), combined with **mercury** (*mercurio*) and **urine** (*vrina*) in dram/ounce measures, set **in the sun for 2 days**, until "a [clear, sweet] water comes"; the water is then **filtered** and the operation continued on the mercury. It is an **alchemical "water"/elixir preparation** rather than an ordinary herbal remedy.

Image 4: "The **Rebis** is the philosophers' stone, which is born where two lovers [are joined], and it is found everywhere; it is said to be in dunghills, ... and it is found as much among the poor as among the rich."





Preliminary leaves — flyleaf notes (not plant pages) *(continued)*

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

(see Identification)

COMMENTARY

The image-4 lines are a well-known **alchemical maxim**: the *Rebis* (Latin *res bina*, "double thing") is the hermaphroditic philosophers' stone, pictured as two lovers (king/queen, Sol/Luna) united — hence *duos amantes*. The conceit that the *materia* of the stone is common and "found everywhere, even in dung, among poor and rich alike" is a stock alchemical commonplace. The presence of an alchemical verse and a dodder recipe on the endleaves shows the book passing through later medical/alchemical hands after the herbal itself was made. That image 3 — nominally a "recipe" — in fact compounds **dodder juice with mercury and urine** and sets the mixture in the sun to yield a "water" confirms the alchemical reading: the two flyleaf notes are of a piece, the work of a later owner with alchemical interests. Confidence is **Tentative** for the doubtful words still marked [?] and for the cancelled and faintest lines; the ingredient names, doses, and the core operation are now secure.



f. 1r — *Tormentilla*

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 5 · master 0265_0004.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Tormentilla

Line 1 runs **partly under the painted root**: the word after *pilia* (read *peštala*, “pound it”) is overlaid by the dense root pigment and only partly legible — a word is there, but its exact letters can't be resolved in RGB.

- 1 La tormentilla, aquesta virtù: pilia, pešta[la?] [under root], solverzala et dali a bever [...]
- 2 meza octava p[er] uolta, a omo o femina che [se] aquaffe[?] dolor de corpo a alcuna
- 3 ventofità; ī fina a XV matine ferà guarito

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 1 expanded abbrev.); C (2 supplied words); D (2 marked [?]); 1x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"Tormentil has this **virtue** ... [good] against pains/**gripping of the belly** (*dolor de corpo*) ... and **wind/flatulence** (*ventosità*) ... [to be taken] up to ... **morning and evening** ..." (Several words uncertain; the note records tormentil's use for belly-ache and flatulence.)



f. 1r — *Tormentilla* (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A low, spreading herb. From a stout, knobbly **red-brown rhizome** at the lower left rise several slender, arching reddish stems. Along them sit **palmately divided leaves** drawn with five to seven narrow lobes, like little splayed hands, and the stems end in thread-like stalks carrying small **star-shaped yellow flowers** with rounded petals. The whole plant is airy and open, leaning to the right.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Tormentilla**; the officinal drug *radix Tormentillae*; early-botanical ***Tormentilla erecta* L.** (1753), *T. officinalis* Curtis, *T. sylvestris* Neck.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Potentilla erecta* (L.) Räusch.**, family **Rosaceae**.
- *Common*: tormentil, septfoil, (erect) cinquefoil; It. *tormentilla*. — **Secure** (name and picture agree).

COMMENTARY

Tormentil rhizome is a major **astringent** of the medieval pharmacy — extremely tannin-rich. Classed **cold and dry**, it was the standard remedy for **fluxes**: diarrhoea, dysentery, internal and external bleeding, mouth and throat ulcers, and wounds. The name itself (*tormentum*, "gripping pain") advertises its use against the *torments* of the gut, and it was later a plague-remedy.





f. 1v — Meu

[Probable — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 6 · master 0265_0005.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Meu

Layout: **SPLIT-BY-IMAGE** — the central root drawing divides each written line into a left and a right fragment that read across as one continuous line (left, then right). The earlier edition wrongly read the two halves as two separate column-texts.

- 1 L herba men fie de due forte · R l'uno fie d'india e l'altro de ponente (de ponente "of the West" confirmed by CATMuS HTR)
 2 L et he caldo e fecho al fecho · R [...] vale ala forteza del foma[co]
 3 L grado; le dolore de le rene e ve- · R fica; et la vefiga[?]; et de la ma-
 4 L -trice [...]

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 1 expanded abbrev.); D (1 marked [?]); 2x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"The herb **meu** is of **two kinds**: the one is **from India**, the other **from the West** (ponente). It is **hot and dry in the second degree**, [good] for the **strength of the stomach** (forteza del stomaco), the **pain of the kidneys and bladder** (rene e vesica), the bladder, and the **womb** (matrice[?])." (Read across the central drawing: «of two kinds — the one from India, the other from the West» is a single sentence the flower splits in two. The medicinal profile — stomach, kidneys, bladder, womb — is consistent with Meum but is not used to establish the identification, which rests on the foliage, root and name.)





f. 1v — *Meu* (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall, feathery plant springing from a single thick, dark **tap-root**. The stem opens into a much-branched spray of **finely cut, thread-like foliage** (drawn as a haze of tiny lines), and the branch-tips carry small loose heads of minute pale flowers — the look of a fennel or other umbellifer. Light and diffuse above, anchored by the bold root below.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Name-led (image weak or stylized)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — dark tap-root; anchored by the bold root below; *habit/stem* — The stem opens into a much-branched spray of finely cut; *flower/inflor.* — thread-like foliage (drawn as a haze of tiny lines), and the branch-tips carry small loose heads of minute pale flowers; the look of a fennel or other umbellifer.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Meu**; Greek μῆον (*mêon*, Dioscorides), Latin **Meum**, *Meum athamanticum*, *Athamanta meu* L.
- *Modern accepted:* **Meum athamanticum** Jacq., family **Apiaceae** (Umbelliferae).
- *Common:* spignel, meu, baldmoney, bearwort; It. *meo*. — **Probable:** the feathery foliage and thick aromatic taproot fit the drug "meu" of the Salernitan tradition, and the note (below) names its uses for stomach and urine — the classic profile of *Meum*.

COMMENTARY

Meu was a warming aromatic root, **hot and dry**, valued as a **carminative, stomachic and diuretic** — for digestion, flatulence, retention of urine and "cold" complaints of the kidneys and bladder. It is a stock "simple" of the medieval *materia medica* (it appears in the *Circa instans* and the Salernitan lists).





f. 2r — *Bonafacia*

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 7 · master 0265_0006.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Bonafacia

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Bonafacia*; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Two long stems sweep outward and up from a central pale **root**, curving like the two arms of a lyre or a wishbone. Each arm is lined along its whole length with **paired oval leaflets** set ladder-fashion (pinnate), in dark green; a shorter central spike rises between the arms, and a fan of fine roots spreads below.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Image-led (name unresolved)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — Two long stems sweep outward and up from a central pale root; a shorter central spike rises between the arms, and a fan of fine roots spreads below; *leaves* — Each arm is lined along its whole length with paired oval leaflets set ladder-fashion (pinnate).

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Bonafacia** (var. *Bonifacia*); apparently a vernacular/saint's-herb name (cf. *herba Sancti Bonifacii*), **not a standard classical name** and probably corrupt; no secure Dioscoridean/Pliny equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved** — the recto picture shows a **pinnate, fern-like** plant (possibly a small fern of the polypody/spleenwort group), but no species can be given with confidence.
- *Common:* none securely attachable. — **Tentative / unidentified** (name unresolved).

COMMENTARY

Without a secure identification, **no materia medica is offered** — assigning medicinal uses to an unidentified plant would be guesswork from a stylised drawing.





f. 2v — *Bonifacia*

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 8 · master 0265_0007.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Bonifacia

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Bonifacia*; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A slender, upright plant on a single straight stem. Narrow **lance-shaped leaves** are set in opposite pairs up the stem and washed pale grey-green; the base tapers into a few thin spreading roots. (Faint show-through writing is visible at the left.)

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — the base tapers into a few thin spreading roots; *leaves* — Narrow lance-shaped leaves are set in opposite pairs up the stem and washed pale grey-green; *habit/stem* — upright plant on a single straight stem.

Tradition-name: *Herba Bonifatia* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 6). (near-exact match.)

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Bonifacia** (repeating the recto name); see f. 2r.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved** — here a **single erect stem with opposite, entire, ovate-lanceolate leaves** (the generic habit of a mint/figwort), which does *not* match the pinnate recto image.
- *Common:* none securely attachable. — **Tentative:** the two "Bonafacia" drawings likely record competing traditions for one (corrupt) name, and show the manuscript's habit of a second, rougher verso drawing beside the recto image.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.





f. 3r — Torogal[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 9 · master 0265_0008.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

torogal[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Torogal[?]* — in English, **pinnate coralwort**, **toothwort**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

One central stem bears **pinnate leaves** — neat paired leaflets stepping up the stalk — and crowned at the top by a little cluster of about three round green **berries or buds**. Below, an unusually prominent **root** is drawn as a spray of fine, pale, whisker-like threads.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Image-led (name unresolved)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — an unusually prominent root is drawn as a spray of fine; *leaves* — One central stem bears pinnate leaves; neat paired leaflets stepping up the stalk; *flower/inflor.* — and crowned at the top by a little cluster of about three round green berries or buds.

Tradition-name: *Herba Torogas* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 3). (*near-exact match.*)

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Torogal[?]** (corrupt); if the beaded root = toothwort, the old names are **Dentaria**, **Dentillaria**, **Coralloides**, "coralwort."
- *Modern accepted:* **Cardamine** sp. (toothwort / coralwort), family **Brassicaceae** — **genus only**; a pinnate-leaved *Dentaria*-type, but **no species can be fixed** from the drawing.
- *Common:* pinnate coralwort, toothwort. — **Tentative** (image-based: the diagnostic white beaded/tooth-like rhizome; the written name does not confirm it).

COMMENTARY

If *Dentaria*, the scaly "toothed" root was used by the **doctrine of signatures** for complaints of the **teeth and gums**, and as a mild astringent/vulnerary for loose teeth and ulcerated mouths; the rhizome was also eaten. (Inference from the identification; no text on the leaf.)





f. 3v — Aleluya

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 10 · master 0265_0009.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Aleluya

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Aleluya* — in English, **wood sorrel**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A clover-like clump: many long-stalked **trifoliate leaves** (each a rounded group of three leaflets), bright green, radiate from a central crown into a bushy rosette, over a dense tuft of **red-brown fibrous roots**. No flowers are shown.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Aleluya**; medieval **Alleluia**, *Panis cuculi* ("cuckoo's bread"), *Trifolium acetosum*, *Lujula*, Greek *Oxys*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Oxalis acetosella* L.**, family **Oxalidaceae**.
- *Common*: wood sorrel; It. *acetosella*, *alleluia*. — **Secure**: "Alleluia" is the standard medieval name for wood sorrel (it flowers in the Alleluia season between Easter and Pentecost), and the trefoil picture confirms it.

COMMENTARY

Wood sorrel is **cold and moist** and pleasantly **acid** (from oxalic acid/potassium oxalate). It was the classic **cooling, thirst-quenching** and "**refrigerant**" herb for hot fevers, a sauce-herb ("green sauce"), and a remedy for mouth ulcers, nausea and a hot stomach; the juice was used to cool inflammation. Its sharp taste underlies the alternative name *acetosella* ("little vinegar [plant]").





f. 4r — .gugraf[?]. (heading corrupt)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 11 · master 0265_0010.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

.gugraf[?].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name .gugraf[?]. — in English, **heading corrupt**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An erect herb on a single straight stem. Pairs of **oval, toothed leaves** climb the stem in steps (opposite, dwindling upward), and the tip bears a small spike of pale yellow buds/flowers. A compact knot of **red-brown roots** sits at the base.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — A compact knot of red-brown roots sits at the base; *leaves* — toothed leaves climb the stem in steps (opposite; *habit/stem* — An erect herb on a single straight stem; *flower/inflor.* — dwindling upward), and the tip bears a small spike of pale yellow buds/flowers.

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): heart-shaped leaves stepping up the stem, small yellow flowers, a clawed root — a **heart-leaved morphotype** (birthwort *Aristolochia*-like) but semi-emblematic. Name a tradition cryptonym. — **tentative / unresolved**.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading .gugraf[?]. (native-res reading; earlier guessed "Sigon/gigarof") — corrupt/illegible, no secure classical equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — the fingered fleshy tubers and lobed leaves suggest a **tuberous herb**: possibly *Filipendula vulgaris* Moench (dropwort) or a tuberous *Ranunculus* (Ranunculaceae); a peony (*Paeonia*) cannot be excluded.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified** (name corrupt, drawing schematic).

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.

Editorial note (native-resolution re-read): the heading reads .gugraf[?]. — a dotted form ending in long-s; this supersedes the earlier "gigarof / sigrof" guesses. Meaning still obscure; kept [?].





f. 4v — *Paralefis* (Cowslip)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 12 · master 0265_0011.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Paralefis

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Paralefis* — in English, **Cowslip**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Broad, **tongue-shaped leaves with strongly ribbed, puckered surfaces** spread flat from the centre in a low rosette; from among them rise several stalks each ending in a loose cluster of **five-petalled golden-yellow flowers**, the very image of a cowslip/primula. A tuft of fibrous roots anchors it.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Paralefis* (= *herba paralysis*, the medieval palsywort-name for cowslip — **not** the word *Primula*, though they name the same plant); medieval *Primula veris* ("first of spring"), *Herba paralysis* / *Arthritica* (palsywort), *Verbasculum*, *Primula odorata*, *Paralisis*.
- *Modern accepted*: *Primula veris* L., family *Primulaceae* (cowslip). (The closely-related primrose, *P. vulgaris*, is the single-flowered counterpart; the umbels of nodding flowers here favour the cowslip.)
- *Common*: cowslip, paigle, palsywort; It. *primula*, *primavera*. — *Secure* (name and rosette agree).

COMMENTARY

As *Herba paralysis* the plant was the medieval remedy for **palsy, trembling, vertigo and "diseases of the nerves and joints,"** and for headache and as a gentle sedative (the flowers in "cowslip wine" for restlessness and insomnia). Reckoned mildly **warm and dry**; the flowers were also cosmetic ("for spots of the face").





f. 5r — *Betonitza*[?] (heading; the drawing resembles *Bistort*)

[Probable — by image (the diagnostic twisted rhizome); the heading is obscure]



manuscript leaf img 13 · master 0265_0012.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Betonitza[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Betonitza*[?] — in English, **heading; the drawing resembles *Bistort***. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A single **pinnate frond** — one upright stalk lined with several pairs of oval leaflets and capped by a terminal leaflet — rising from a small rounded **rootstock** topped by a dark pointed bud. Spare and diagrammatic.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Conflicting traditions — the **heading/tradition-name** = **betony** (canonical *Herba Betonega* № 7), but the **drawing** = **bistort** (twisted rhizome). The entry keeps the image-based *Probable* identification (*bistort*) and flags the name conflict; a genuine name/image divergence.

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — rising from a small rounded rootstock topped by a dark pointed bud; *leaves* — A single pinnate frond; one upright stalk lined with several pairs of oval leaflets and capped by a terminal leaflet.

Tradition-name: *Herba Betonega* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 7) = *betony*. (*strong match*.)

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): the name *Betonitza* is a dialect diminutive of *Betonica* (*betony*, *Betonica/Stachys officinalis*), a major medieval medicinal — a strong *linguistic* lead. But the drawing (pinnate serrate leaflets + a single red taproot) is **atypical for *betony*** and closer to *burnet/bistort*, so name and image may be conflated. — **name lead moderate (betony); image uncertain.**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *Betonitza*[?] (obscure — *not* the standard name); the identification rests on the **drawing**, whose twisted rhizome matches the herbal *Bistorta* ("twice-twisted," for that rhizome), *Serpentaria*, *Colubrina*, *Dracunculus*, "snakeweed"; early-botanical *Polygonum bistorta* L.

- *Modern accepted:* *Bistorta officinalis* Delarbre (= *Persicaria bistorta* (L.) Samp., = *Polygonum bistorta* L.), family *Polygonaceae*.

- *Common:* (common) *bistort*, *snakeroot*, *Easter-ledges*, *adderwort*; It. *bistorta*. — **Probable** (the diagnostic twisted rhizome supports *bistort*; the heading itself is obscure).

COMMENTARY

If the identification as *bistort* is **correct**, the rhizome is, with *tormentil*, one of the strongest vegetable **astringents** — **cold and dry**, intensely tannic. Used for all **fluxes and haemorrhages** (dysentery, spitting of blood, excessive menses), to fasten loose teeth and heal mouth ulcers and wounds, and — by the **doctrine of signatures** (the snake-like root, hence *Serpentaria/Colubrina*) — against **snakebite and venom/pestilence**.





f. 5v — *Betonica*

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 14 · master 0265_0013.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Betonica

- 1 Erba betonica rompe la p[i]etra [ur]inaria, bevendola co[n] vino; è bona da ydro[pisia?] ...
 - 2 ... [per chi è] ferito de fero; e il suo sugo è bono alle doie de orecchie ...
 - 3 ... mesedado co[n] olio rosato, [e] sia bevuto il suo [sugo]; è bona da tose e fredura ...
 - 4 ... la polver[e] sua, mangiata over bevuta co[n] il vino, [ha] virtù maravigliose, e [con]duce- ...
 - 5 la foia cruda risana li occhi, suga le lacrime, e restrenghe il sangue; etiam la [testa] ...
 - 6 la sua foia pesta co[n] il sale e messa su li mali nascenti, come [un] impiastro ...
 - 7 libera etiam li mali vecchi; etiam mes[edato] co[n] ... subito sana. —
- Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 10 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); C (6 supplied words); D (1 marked [?]).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"Betony breaks the urinary stone, drunk with wine; it is good for dropsy[?] ... [for one] wounded by iron [a sword-cut]; and its juice is good for ear-aches (*doglie de orecchie*); mixed with oil of roses, let its juice be drunk; [it is] good for cough and chill (*tose e fredura*); its powder, eaten or drunk with wine, has marvellous virtues ...; the raw leaf heals the eyes, dries the tears, and staunches the blood (*restrenghe il sangue*), as also the head; its leaf pounded with salt and laid on growing sores, as a poultice; it also relieves old complaints (*mali vecchi*); also mixed [with] ... and at once it heals (*subito sana*)."

This much fuller reading — obtained with the enhancement/tiling method — rehearses betony's classic profile (the stone, sword-wounds, ear-ache, the head, "marvellous" powders in wine, a salt-poultice for sores, chronic ills) and matches its towering medieval reputation. A few words remain uncertain.





f. 5v — *Betonica* (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A basal **rosette of oblong, scallop-edged leaves** lies low to the ground, and from its centre a tall slender stem shoots up to a narrow spike of small flowers (betony-like). Short roots spread at the base; writing runs beneath.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Betonica**; classical **Vettonica** (Pliny) / **Betonica**, Greek κέστρον (*kestron*), **psychotrophon**; the subject of the pseudo-Apuleian/Antonius Musa tract *De herba vettonica*; early-botanical ***Betonica officinalis* L.**
- *Modern accepted*: ***Betonica officinalis* L.** (= *Stachys officinalis* (L.) Trevis.), family **Lamiaceae** (Labiatae).
- *Common*: wood betony, bishopwort, betony; It. *betonica*. — **Secure.**

COMMENTARY

Betony was perhaps **among the most praised herbs of the Middle Ages** — the tag "*vendi la tunica e compra la betonica*" ("sell your coat and buy betony"), and Antonius Musa's list of some **47 ailments** it cured. Reckoned **warm and dry**, it was sovereign for the **head and nerves** (headache, vertigo, epilepsy), a master **antidote/theriac** ingredient against poison and the bite of venomous beasts, and a **wound-herb**, taken in wine or as a powder.



f. 6r — *Peveruchaf*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 15 · master 0265_0014.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Peveruchaf[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Peveruchaf*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A small, curious sketch: a green **cup- or star-shaped flower-head** on a short stem, growing from a pale, twisting, **forked root** that snakes sideways. Faint show-through leaves stand behind it.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — forked root that snakes sideways; *leaves* — Faint show-through leaves stand behind it; *flower/inflor.* — curious sketch: a green cup- or star-shaped flower-head on a short stem.

Tradition-name: *Herba Paroischas* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 43). (plausible match.)

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *Peveruchaf*[?] — a vernacular Veneto name, no secure classical equivalent; the *pevere* ("pepper") root may hint at a pungent/acrid root-drug.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — the broad clumped leaves with long fleshy spreading roots suggest a root-drug plant such as a **gentian** (*Gentiana* sp.) or **pellitory-of-Spain** (*Anacyclus pyrethrum* (L.) Link); neither is secure.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.



f. 6v — Asfodillo (Asphodel)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 16 · master 0265_0015.tif — (high-res master 0265_0015.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Asfodilo · herba di saturno · [right margin, repeated:] Affodel[o]

Layout: a SINGLE block written across the right of the plant, its lines crossing the painted green leaves.

*Re-read here with an ink-palette filter: the leaf-and-flower colours were dropped and only the three darkest ink clusters (#2F2823 · #6B532F · #7D6536) kept, which lifts the writing clear of the green foliage. This confirms the heading (with the alias **Affodel[o]** repeated in the right margin) and a note of 9 lines; where a painted leaf is dark enough to survive the filter the text behind it stays [...] — those stretches need multispectral (MSI) imaging.*

- 1 Erba di [saturno] vale [molto] al dolore de le rene et a li [piedi];
- 2 [chi] à [affai?] dolore a li piedi, [tolli?] la radice de la dita
- 3 [er]ba, ferà liberato; et ancora vale [contra] la malicia[?] et [g]ra-
- 4 [...] li demonij[?]; et la dicta radice [portata] adoffo i[n] questo modo
- 5 [...] [vale] al dolor del parto, et subito parturirà [fen]za dolore[?];
- 6 [...] e dolore de matrice [...]
- 7 [...] et [a] quelle co[n] dolore [...]
- 8 [...] et l'altra radice, cota co[n] [...] inl[...]
- 9 [...] de natura [...] fa[?] [...]

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 8 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note);

C (16 supplied words); D (8 marked [?]); 12x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"The herb of Saturn (asphodel) is good for pain of the kidneys and the feet: [for] one who has much pain in the feet, [take] the root of this herb and he will be freed. It also avails against malice ... and the demons (li demonij); and the said root, worn on the body in this manner, ... [helps] the pain of childbirth, so that she gives birth at once, without pain; and the pain of the womb (matrice) ...; and for those in pain ...; and the other root, cooked with ... [is used] ... [for matters] of [its] nature ..." (The note is largely written under the plant's painted leaves and is only partly legible. The blend of medicine and apotropaic charm — kidneys and feet, but also driving off "the demons" and easing childbirth — suits asphodel's old link to Saturn and the underworld; cf. the charm-notes on the Lucia/Regina leaves. Several words remain uncertain.) (Translation provisional — much of this note is written under the painted leaves and only partly legible; the smooth English supplies connective sense that the manuscript only implies.)





f. 6v — *Asfodillo* (Asphodel) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bold clump of long, narrow **strap-like leaves** (grass- or iris-fashion) fanning up from a swollen brown **bulb/rootstock** with thick roots beneath; a reddish pointed **bud or spike** pushes up through the centre. Writing flanks it on both sides.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Asfodilla* / *herba di Saturno*; classical *Asphodelus*, Greek ἀσφόδελος (*asphodelos*) — the asphodel of Homer's meadows of the dead; Latin *hastula regia* ("king's little spear"), *albusium* (Pliny); It. *porraccio*.
- *Modern accepted*: *Asphodelus albus* Mill. (and/or *Asphodelus ramosus* L.), family *Asphodelaceae* (formerly *Liliaceae*).
- *Common*: white asphodel, king's spear; It. *asfodelo*, *porraccio*. — *Secure* (name and the bulb-tubers/strap-leaves/spike agree).

COMMENTARY

Sacred to the dead in antiquity (planted on graves; the "asphodel meadows"), and a famine-food when the tubers were roasted. Medicinally reckoned **hot and dry**: the root — in **wine**, with **honey** or **oil** — was given for coughs and "the stone" and to provoke urine and menses; with **vinegar** it was rubbed on tetters, freckles and leprous spots; the **juice with honey/wine and frankincense** was dropped for **ear-ache**; the pounded root served as a **poultice** for ulcers and swellings, and the ash was a remedy for baldness (*alopecia*).





f. 7r — *Çipola marina* (Squill)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 17 · master 0265_0016.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Cipola marina

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Çipola marina* — in English, **Squill**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tuft of upright, **pointed strap-like leaves** springs in a fan from a large rounded **brown bulb** fringed all round with a beard of fine roots. The onion-like bulb is the focus, drawn big at the base.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Çipola marina* (sea onion); classical *Scilla* / *Squilla*, Greek σκίλλα (*skilla*); *cepa marina*, *Pancratium*; the "squill" of Dioscorides and Pliny.
- *Modern accepted*: *Drimia maritima* (L.) Stearn (= *Urginea maritima* (L.) Baker, = *Scilla maritima* L.), family *Asparagaceae* (formerly *Liliaceae*).
- *Common*: (sea) squill, sea onion; It. *scilla*, *cipolla marina*. — **Secure** (the giant tunicated bulb with broad pleated leaves and the name agree).

COMMENTARY

One of the oldest drugs of the *materia medica*. **Hot and dry** and acrid, the bulb is a powerful **expectorant, diuretic and cardiotonic** — the basis of **oxymel scilliticum** ("squill vinegar/honey") for **dropsy, chronic cough and asthma**; in quantity strongly **emetic and toxic** (long used as a rat-poison). Handled with respect by every herbal tradition since antiquity.





f. 7v — *Dens Leonis* (Dandelion)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 18 · master 0265_0017.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Dens Leonif

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Dens Leonis* — in English, **Dandelion**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A flat **rosette** of deeply toothed, lance-shaped leaves — cut into backward-pointing lobes, dandelion-fashion — radiating from a central crown over a brush of fibrous roots. No flower; the toothed leaf-rosette is the whole image.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Dens Leonis**; medieval **Dens leonis**, **Taraxacon**, **Caput monachi** ("monk's head," for the seed-clock), **Rostrum porcinum**, **Urinaria**; It. *dente di leone*, *piscialletto*, *soffione*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Taraxacum officinale*** F.H.Wigg., family **Asteraceae** (Compositae). ("Dens leonis" was applied broadly to the dandelion/hawkbit group — *Leontodon*, *Hypochaeris* — but the runcinate rosette here is the true dandelion.)
- *Common*: dandelion; It. *dente di leone*. — **Secure**.

COMMENTARY

A bitter, **cooling**, "**opening**" herb: a noted **diuretic** (hence *Urinaria*, *piscialletto*, "piss-a-bed"), and a **liver/gall remedy** for jaundice and obstructions of the liver and spleen; the young leaves a salad pot-herb, the milky **latex** dabbed on warts. Reckoned cold and dry.





f. 8r — *Ȝicaro*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 19 · master 0265_0018.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Ȝicaro[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Ȝicaro*[?] — in English, **bindweed**, **withywind**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A plant of **broad arrow/heart-shaped leaves** carried on separate stalks, with a few small white flowers nodding at the top and — most distinctively — a long, smooth **root that curves away sideways like a tail**.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — smooth root that curves away sideways like a tail; *leaves* — A plant of broad arrow/heart-shaped leaves carried on separate stalks; *flower/inflor.* — with a few small white flowers nodding at the top and.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading faded; the plant is the herbal **Convolvulus** / **Volubilis** ("the twiner"), *Smilax lenis*, It. *vilucchio*, *campanella*.
- *Modern accepted:* a **bindweed**, family **Convolvulaceae** — **genus undetermined** from the stylized drawing; the heading is illegible, so **no species or genus can be fixed**.
- *Common:* bindweed, withywind; It. *vilucchio*. — **Tentative** (morphology-based).

COMMENTARY

Bindweed (if so) is **cooling** but its root a **drastic purge** — a milder garden relative of scammony — used to open the bowels and for jaundice; the trailing herb also applied to wounds. (*Inference from the identification; the name could not be read.*)





f. 8v — *Caprifoli* (Honeysuckle)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 20 · master 0265_0019.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Capri folj

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Caprifoli* — in English, **Honeysuckle**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A spreading, much-branched plant strewn with **pink five-petalled flowers** among small oval leaves; a single stem runs down to a slender root. Open and lively, the rose-pink blooms scattered across the crown.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Caprifoli**; classical/medieval **Caprifolium**, **Periclymenon** (Dioscorides), **Matrisylva**, **Lilium inter spinas**; It. *caprifoglio*, *madreselva*, *vincibosco*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Lonicera caprifolium* L.** (or *L. periclymenum* L.), family **Caprifoliaceae**.
- *Common*: honeysuckle, woodbine; It. *caprifoglio*. — **Secure** (by name; the climber is drawn, per convention, as a bush).

COMMENTARY

Warm and dry; the flowers and leaves used as a **gargle for sore throat and mouth ulcers**, for coughs and shortness of breath, to "open" the spleen and liver, and as a wash for the skin; the fragrant flowers went into syrups and oils.





f. 9r — *Mipilis*[?] (Orchid / Satyrion)

[Secure — at genus (by image; the twin tubers); species uncertain]



manuscript leaf img 21 · master 0265_0020.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Mipili[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Mipilis*[?] — in English, **Orchid / Satyrion**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A **bulb plant**: two broad blade-leaves rise from a rounded bulb drawn cut in half to show its layered inside, while slender stalks carry a few small pale flowers above — onion- or crocus-like.

IDENTIFICATION

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): the twin egg-shaped tubers below two broad leaves are diagnostic of an **orchid** (*Orchis* — the “satyrion / testiculus” type). Plant clear; the name *Mipilis* stays unresolved. — **plant moderate-high (orchid)**; name unresolved.

- *Old / historical*: the figure is the herbal **Satyrion**: classical **Satyrion**, **Orchis** (Gr. ὄρχις, “testicle”), **Testiculus** (*canis / leporis / vulpis* — “dog/hare/fox-stones”), **Priapiscus**.
- *Modern accepted*: **Orchidaceae** — an **Orchis-type satyrion** (the twin egg-shaped tubers are diagnostic of the family, but the species is **not determinable** from the drawing; the MS name is corrupt — so no binomial is given here).
- *Common*: orchid, satyrion, dog-stones; It. *satirione, testicolo di cane*. — **Secure at genus** (the twin tubers are diagnostic). Cf. the other orchids, f. 19v and f. 20v.

COMMENTARY

Those paired “stones” made satyrion the great medieval **aphrodisiac and restorative** by the **doctrine of signatures**: the firm (new) tuber, taken in wine, to **provoke desire and aid conception**; the flaccid (old) tuber to **quench** it. A “hot and moist” cordial root (the source of *salep*).





f. 9v — *Eufragia* (Eyebright — by name)

[Probable — by name]



manuscript leaf img 22 · master 0265_0021.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Eufragia

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Eufragia* — in English, **Eyebright** — by name. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bushy, aromatic-looking herb: several upright stems closely set with many small leaves branch into a dense leafy spray (savory/thyme fashion) above a short fibrous root.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Conflicting traditions / possible conflation

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *habit/stem* — A bushy; aromatic-looking herb: several upright stems closely set with many small leaves branch into a dense leafy spray (savory/thyme fashion) above a short fibrous root.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *Eufragia*; medieval *Euphrasia*, *Ocularis* / *Ocularia* ("the eye-herb").

- *Modern accepted (by the name):* *Euphrasia officinalis* L. s.l., family *Orobanchaceae*.

— However, the picture does **not** match eyebright: it shows regular whorls of narrow, needle-like leaves on an erect, branched stem, much more like a horsetail (*Equisetum*), a whorled bedstraw (*Galium/Asperula*), or a young conifer. (A **name/image mismatch**, of the kind the catalogue notes for this herbal; recorded honestly.)

COMMENTARY

Of eyebright (the name): **cold and dry**, the supreme **eye-herb** — for "clearing and comforting the sight," weak and watering eyes, in eye-waters and "eyebright ale." (Whether the medieval compiler intended these uses for the plant actually drawn is doubtful.)



f. 10r — *Esfragia ouer luminela* (Eyebright, alias)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 23 · master 0265_0022.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Esfragia ouer luminela

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Esfragia ouer luminela* — in English, **Eyebright**, alias. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem lined with **paired oval leaflets** (pinnate) and tipped by a small flower, springing from thick, **twisting roots** that snake outward across the ground.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — twisting roots that snake outward across the ground; *leaves* — An upright stem lined with paired oval leaflets (pinnate) and tipped by a small flower.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading re-read as *Esfragia ouer luminela* — i.e. *Eufragia* (*Euphrasia*, eyebright), with the alias *luminela*. The name points to eyebright, but the drawn plant (paired oval leaflets on a twisting root) does **not** match eyebright, so the identification stays open.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — opposite oval leaves in a ladder with spreading roots suggest a *Polygonatum* or a pinnate-leaved herb.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.

Editorial note (native-resolution re-read): the link-word is **ouer** (= *overo*, "otherwise"), not the earlier "o3" — so this is an alias heading, "*Eufragia*, otherwise *luminela*."

f. 10v — Mauffata[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 24 · master 0265_0023.tif — (master 0265_0023.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Mauffata[?]

Layout: **SPLIT-BY-IMAGE** — a single note divided by the large drawn seed/pod; the fragments to the left and to the right of the pod belong to **one** text (not two separate plant-columns). The earlier edition transcribed only the right-hand fragments; the left-hand fragments (a "spirits" charm) are recovered here. Much is faded/abbreviated — marked [...].

Read as **one** text, each line crossing the pod (left fragment + right fragment):

- 1 Erba folio[?] [...] chi à queſta [erba] zegna[?]
- 2 dola[?] [...] no[n] ve pò habitar
- 3 ſpiriti, e a[?] portàdola adoffo, a
- 4 uno [...] [che la] [...] ferà lib[er]ato
- 5 o fulla[?] [...] queſta [erba]
- 6 [de] q[ue]lla caſa, p[er] virtù [de] queſta
- 7 [erba] et co[n]juener[?] [...]]
- 8 p[er]ſona no[n] porrà habitar

Evidence grade (A-D): **A** (direct, incl. 10 expanded abbrev.); **B** (right-hand fragments firmed by enhancement — see note); **C** (6 supplied words); **D** (9 marked [?]); 13x lost [...]. — **Improved 04.07.2026:** re-read from the master with the **CONCULS** decorrelation-stretch + **CLAHE** enhancement. The right-hand fragments are now firm — "**non ve pò habitar**" ("cannot dwell [there]"), "**portandola adosso**" ("carrying it on the body"), "**serà liberato**" ("will be freed") and the closing "**persona non porrà habitar**" — confirming the apotropaic/banishing sense; the left-hand fragments stay faded [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"(An **apotropaic** / **banishing charm**, read as **one** text across the pod, only partly legible.) "... the herb-leaf (folio) ... [against?] **spirits** (spiriti) ...; whoever has [this sign / affliction] ... shall **not** be able to dwell [there]; carrying it on the body ... he will be freed; ... and that house, by the virtue of this herb ... **no** person will be able to dwell [in it]." (The drift appears protective/apotropaic — recurring words for **spirits**, **dwelling/habitation**, and **carrying on the body** — and after enhancement the apotropaic sense is now clear — spirits/persons cannot dwell where the herb is, and carrying it on the body one is freed; it seems related to the **Regina** charm-leaf. The left-hand fragments stay faded, so a few links in the charm remain [...].) (**Improved by enhancement** — the right-hand fragments are now firm; the residual gaps are on the faded left column.)



f. 10v — *Mauffata*[?] (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A branching plant with **divided, parsley-like lobed leaves** and scattered small flowers; drawn separately at the lower left is a large pointed **seed or fruit** (almond-shaped) beside explanatory text — two elements share the leaf.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Image-led (name unresolved)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — A branching plant with divided; parsley-like lobed leaves and scattered small flowers; two elements share the leaf; *fruit/seed* — drawn separately at the lower left is a large pointed seed or fruit (almond-shaped) beside explanatory text.

ID update (batch 2 · image re-read): an airy herb with **finely fan-lobed grey-green leaves** and small nodding flowers — a **fumitory (*Fumaria*)** or columbine (*Aquilegia*)-type divided-leaf herb (umbellifer less likely, given the rounded lobing). Name unresolved. — **tentative (fumitory/columbine type).**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading uncertain/corrupt; no secure classical equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — the main figure is a **finely-dissected-leaf herb**, the habit of an **umbellifer** (parsley/coriander/smallage type) or a **fumitory (*Fumaria*)**; the lower figure is a separate simple leaf.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.





f. 11r — *caualari3a*[?] (Dragon arum / *Serpentaria*)

[Probable — by image (the conventional dragon/serpent-root figure; the heading is uncertain)]



manuscript leaf img 25 · master 0265_0024.tif — (a highlight illustration)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

caualari3a[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *caualari3a*[?] — in English, **Dragon arum / *Serpentaria***. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A thick upright stem carrying leaves and clusters of **golden round fruits**, rising from a remarkable **serpent-like root** drawn as a scaly lizard or dragon stretching across the foot of the page — the legendary 'dragon' rootstock.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — rising from a remarkable serpent-like root drawn as a scaly lizard or dragon stretching across the foot of the page; the legendary 'dragon' rootstock; *habit/stem* — A thick upright stem carrying leaves and clusters of golden round fruits.

Tradition-name: *Herba Canalaritas romana* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 9). (*strong match.*)

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): the **scaly serpent/dragon rhizome** is the classic emblem of **dragon arum (*Dracunculus vulgaris*) / *Serpentaria* (*Dracontea*)**. Plant = serpent-root type (moderate); the name *caualarizas* is a tradition cryptonym. — **morphotype dragon-arum (tentative-moderate)**.

- *Old / historical:* the figure is the herbal **Dragontea / *Serpentaria* (maior)**: classical **Dracontium, Dracunculus, *Serpentaria*, Colubrina**; It. *dragontea, serpentaria, erba biscia*.
- *Modern accepted:* ***Dracunculus vulgaris* Schott (= *Arum dracunculus* L.)**, family **Araceae**.
- *Common:* dragon arum, dragonwort; It. *dragontea*. — **Probable** (the dragon/snake root is the characteristic herbal signature of the herbal *dragontea*; the modern species follows from that iconography).

COMMENTARY

Because of that serpent-marked stem, dragon arum was the remedy "against the bite of serpents and all venom" (hence *Serpentaria*), and carried to drive snakes off. **Hot and acrid**, the root was a caustic for **cancers, fistulas and foul spreading ulcers**, an expectorant to clear the chest, and an emmenagogue; violently acrid and toxic when fresh.





f. 11v — *Centaurea maior* (Greater centaury)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 26 · master 0265_0025.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Layout: TWO-COLUMN — two plants, each with its own name and note: *Centaurea maior* at the left (by the painted bird), *Centaurea minor* at the right. Line numbers restart for each column.

Left column — *Centaurea maior*

(Read with the green leaf-pigment suppressed; ~9 lines — earlier only three were shown.)

- 1 Erba çentaura mazor h[a] [molte virtù]; queſta [...]
- 2 [è] bona al morfo del [fianco?] [...]
- 3 foʒ[?] il morfo [...]
- 4 d[e] ogio; toi lo fugo [...]
- 5 [in] l'ochio, macera[?] [...]
- 6 luce; a tegnir d[e] [...]
- 7 il capo, leua la tegn[a?] [...]
- 8 [naſce] i[n] tereni forti e ſaldi, e p[i]etroſi lochi (line-end recovered under the leaf by red-ink isolation)
- 9 [molte] virtude.

Right column — *Centaurea minor*

- 1 Aqueſia [erba] vale al morene[?] fane criſte[?]-
 - 2 rfe[?]; purga colerici zumori et uride le
 - 3 morene a bever; el fugo agraſimo leua le
 - 4 rotarole[?] et li ocſij[?]; u[?] 25 di del meſe de
 - 5 mazo et a[u]lgno; et fa ſa[?] ogni zumore [vi] del capo;
 - 6 el fuco fecho et fp[ol]uerizato meſo nel lochio[?]
 - 7 rede[?] lo macula et riſchia[ra]r la luce · Data la femenza a
 - 8 bever cū il uino, uridi[?] i ba[?]li del ne[?]tre[?]; et a molte altere u[ir]tu · naſce
 - 9 i[n] terreni fabioſi, mizi[?] e ſaldi[?] (line-end confirmed via red-ink isolation)
- Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 10 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); C (7 supplied words); D (19 marked [?]); 7x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Left column — *Centaurea maior* (greater): "Greater centaury herb [has many virtues]; it is good for the pain of the side; ... with oil, take the juice ... in the eye ... [restoring] light/sight; applied to the head it removes ringworm (*tigna*); it grows in firm and stony soils (*tereni forti e ſaldi, e petroſi*); [it has many] virtues." (partly legible).

Right column — *Centaurea minor* (lesser): "This herb is good for the hemorrhoids; it purges choleric humours and, drunk, treats the hemorrhoids; the very sour juice, and the dried, powdered juice put in the eye, clear the sight and strengthen the light; gathered about the 25th of the month, in May and June; and it heals every humour of the head (*ogni zumore del capo*); the seed drunk with wine ...; and it has many other virtues; it grows in sandy and firm soils (*tereni fabioſi e ſaldi*)."

(Translation provisional — same-ink and partly faded; ~20 words are marked [?].)





f. 11v — *Centaurea maior* (Greater centaury)

(continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Two plants share the leaf: at left a slender stem of **paired leaves** with a small bird sketched at its base, at right a taller stem topped with **clusters of reddish flowers**. Both stand on fine roots, with notes between them.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Centaurea maior**; classical **Centaureum maius**, the herb of **Chiron the Centaur** (who is said to have healed his wound with it), **Rhaponticum**; It. *centaurea maggiore*.
 - *Modern accepted*: **Rhaponticum** / **Centaurea centaurium** L. (greater centaury), family **Asteraceae**. (Distinct from "*centaurea minor*" = **Centaureum erythraea** Rafn, family **Gentianaceae** — the lesser centaury.)
- Caveat**: the historical nomenclature here — *Centaurea maior* / *Centaureum* / *Rhaponticum* — is **notoriously tangled**, and several plants bore these names. The transcription is sound, but **this modern mapping is provisional and should be checked against specialist literature** before being relied on.
- *Common*: greater centaury; It. *centaurea maggiore*. — **Secure** (by name; "maior" specified).

COMMENTARY

The centaur's celebrated **wound-herb** — a famous **vulnerary** ("*salda*," it consolidates wounds) — and a bitter **purge** of thick humours, a **vermifuge**, an eye-remedy, and (the fresh juice) a **caustic** on tumours and ringworm: exactly the uses its two notes record.



f. 12r — *Stomixia*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 27 · master 0265_0026.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Stomixia[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Stomixia*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

From a central stem hang **paired pointed leaves** with round **golden berries** poised at the leaf-tips, all over a dense mass of orange-brown **twisting roots**.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — all over a dense mass of orange-brown twisting roots; *leaves* — From a central stem hang paired pointed leaves with round golden berries poised at the leaf-tips.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading corrupt; no secure classical equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — the **jointed, creeping rhizome** suggests *Polypodium vulgare* L. (polypody) or *Polygonatum* (Solomon's seal).
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.



f. 12v — Mezereon (Mezereon)

[Probable — by name]



manuscript leaf img 28 · master 0265_0027.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Mezereon

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Mezereon* — in English, **Mezereon**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bold, leafy plant of two upright stems densely lined with **paired lance-shaped leaflets** (pinnate), dark green, descending to a single red **taproot**; lush and full.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Name-led (image weak or stylized)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — descending to a single red taproot; *leaves* — leafy plant of two upright stems densely lined with paired lance-shaped leaflets (pinnate).

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Mezireon**; medieval **Mezereon** / **Mezereum**, **Chamelaea**, **Laureola**; It. *mezereo*, *fior di stecco*.
- *Modern accepted:* *Daphne mezereum* L. (or *Daphne gnidium* L.), family **Thymelaeaceae**.
- *Common:* mezereon, spurge-flax/laurel; It. *mezereo*. — **Probable** by name (the foliage is stylised — living *Daphne* is a small shrub with simple leaves and pink flowers).

COMMENTARY

One of the most violently **acrid and caustic** of drugs — hot and dry in the extreme. The bark and red berries are a **drastic purge and vesicant** (blistering), used with great caution as a counter-irritant for dropsy, chronic skin disease and "cold" rheums; **highly toxic** (the berries can kill).



f. 13r — *Lingua di vena*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 29 · master 0265_0028.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

lingua de vena

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Lingua di vena*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A low **rosette of broad, pointed leaves** that curve upward into a loose tulip-like cup, set over a spray of pale, fleshy roots — compact and ground-hugging.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — fleshy roots; *leaves* — pointed leaves that curve upward into a loose tulip-like cup; *habit/stem* — A low rosette of broad; set over a spray of pale.

Tradition-name: *Herba Lingua cornena* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 17). (strong match.)

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): a rosette of broad tongue-like leaves; the name *lingua* marks a “**tongue-leaf**” plant (plantain *Plantago* or hart’s-tongue type). — **tentative (tongue-leaved rosette).**

- *Old / historical:* if *Lingua cervina*, the old name of **hart’s-tongue** (*Scolopendrium*); but the root drawn does not fit a fern.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — a clump of **broad entire leaves over fingered fleshy roots**; candidates include *Arum* (lt. *gigaro*) or a *Helleborus*.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.



f. 13v — *Vita nigra* (Black bryony)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 30 · master 0265_0029.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Vita nigra

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Vita nigra* — in English, **Black bryony**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bold plant with **broad arrow/heart-shaped leaves**, a tall arching stem strung with small **red berries**, and — most striking — a large, dark, **pear-shaped tuber** for its root.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Vita nigra** (the leaf reads *Vita nigra*; cf. *Vitis/Vena nigra*); classical **Vitis nigra**, **Bryonia nigra**, **Tamus**; It. *vite nera*, *tamaro*, *uva di cane*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Dioscorea communis* (L.) Caddick & Wilkin** (= ***Tamus communis* L.**), family **Dioscoreaceae**.
- *Common*: black bryony; It. *tamaro*. — *Secure* (cordate leaves, red berries and the big black tuber confirm the name).

COMMENTARY

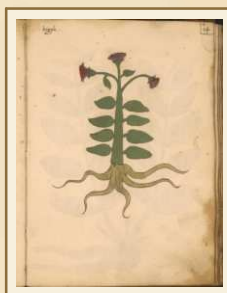
The acrid tuber (toxic raw) was the folk remedy "*that takes away black-and-blue marks*" — grated and laid on **bruises, chilblains, gout and rheumatic joints** as a rubefacient; a **drastic purge** taken internally; the young spring shoots eaten like asparagus once cooked.





f. 14r — *bigola*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 31 · master 0265_0030.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

bigola

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *bigola*[?] — in English, **valerian**, **all-heal**, **setwall**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of **paired oval leaves** (pinnate) topped by a small cluster of **red-pink flowers**, rising from a spread of pale, branching roots.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Image-led (name unresolved)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — branching roots; *leaves* — An upright stem of paired oval leaves (pinnate) topped by a small cluster of red-pink flowers.

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): pinnate leaves with drooping **pink tubular flowers** — a fumitory/*Corydalis* or lousewort (*Pedicularis*) type. Veneto name unresolved. — **tentative**.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading corrupt; if valerian, the old names are **Valeriana**, **Phu**, **Amantilla**, **Nardus agrestis/rusticus** ("wild nard").
- *Modern accepted:* **Valeriana** sp. (valerian), family **Caprifoliaceae** (formerly Valerianaceae) — **genus only**; the **species is not determinable** from the drawing, and the name does not confirm it.
- *Common:* valerian, all-heal, setwall; It. *valeriana*. — **Tentative** (morphology-based).

COMMENTARY

(If *valerian*;) the root — **Phu**, "all-heal" — was the great **nervine and antispasmodic**: for "the mother" (hysteria) and the womb, cramps and epilepsy, to **provoke sleep** and the menses; also an antidote and plague-herb. Its powerful smell made it unmistakable.



f. 14v — *Ceciliana*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 32 · master 0265_0031.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Ceciliana

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Ceciliana*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Two leafy branches carry **paired oval leaves** (opposite), dark green, springing from a horizontal **rootstock with finger-like roots** — a neat twin-stemmed spray.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — springing from a horizontal rootstock with finger-like roots; *leaves* — Two leafy branches carry paired oval leaves (opposite); *habit/stem* — a neat twin-stemmed spray.

ID update (batch 2 · image re-read): opposite, entire, ovate-lanceolate leaves; no flowers drawn — an opposite-leaved herb (swallow-wort *Vincetoxicum*, or a *Gentiana/Hypericum* type), not fixable without flowers. *Ceciliana* is possibly a saint-name folk coinage. — **remains tentative / unresolved.**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading a vernacular/corrupt name; no secure classical equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — an **opposite, oval-leaved herb** (drawn twice), possibly a **St John's wort (*Hypericum*)** or a mint-family plant.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.

f. 15r — *Geantia* (Gentian)

[Probable — by name]



manuscript leaf img 33 · master 0265_0032.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Geantia

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Geantia* — in English, **Gentian**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A highly stylised, almost emblematic plant: a deep-red **four-lobed flower or fruit** (like a clover-leaf) sits at the centre between curving tendrils, crowned above by small pink flowers in a green cup.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — almost emblematic plant: a deep-red four-lobed flower or fruit (like a clover-leaf) sits at the centre between curving tendrils; *flower/inflor.* — crowned above by small pink flowers in a green cup.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *Geantia*; classical *Gentiana* (named for King *Gentius* of Illyria, said to have discovered it), *Basilica*; It. *genziana*.
- *Modern accepted:* *Gentiana lutea* L. (great yellow gentian) or another *Gentiana* sp., family *Gentianaceae* — *probable*, by name and the prominent root.
- *Common:* (yellow) gentian, bitterwort; It. *genziana*. — **Probable.** Cf. the manuscript's other gentian, f. 23v.

COMMENTARY

Gentian root is the supreme **bitter tonic** of the *materia medica* — **warm and dry**; the great **stomachic** and "**opener**" for feeble digestion and obstructions of the liver and spleen, a **worm-expeller** and febrifuge, a wound-cleanser, and a standard ingredient of **theriac** and antidotes.



f. 15v — *Lingua serpentina*
[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 34 · master 0265_0033.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lingua serpentina

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Lingua serpentina* — in English, **adder's-tongue**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A low, bushy plant spreading wide with many **deeply divided, lobed leaves** on lax stems over a brush of fibrous roots — sprawling and finely cut.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Conflicting traditions / possible conflation

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — bushy plant spreading wide with many deeply divided; lobed leaves on lax stems over a brush of fibrous roots.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *Lingua serpentina*; medieval *Ophioglossum*, *Lingua serpentina*/*serpentaria*, *Lancea Christi* — names of **adder's-tongue**.
- *Modern accepted (by the name):* *Ophioglossum vulgatum* L., family *Ophioglossaceae*. — **But the drawing does not match** the single-fronded fern; it shows a **bushy, many-leaved clump**, so the figure may instead be a plantain or bugloss. (*Name/image mismatch — flagged.*)
- *Common:* adder's-tongue; It. *lingua di serpe*. — **Tentative** (name secure, plant doubtful).

COMMENTARY

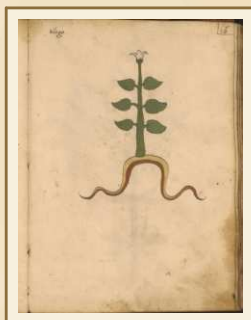
Of adder's-tongue (the name): a **cool vulnerary**; the famous "**green oil**" of **adder's-tongue** (an ointment) for fresh wounds, bruises and ulcers.





f. 16r — *Bilga*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 35 · master 0265_0034.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

[b/f]ilga[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Bilga*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of **paired oval leaves** with a small flower at the tip, growing from a long, **wavy snake-like root** that runs sideways across the foot of the page.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — wavy snake-like root that runs sideways across the foot of the page; *leaves* — An upright stem of paired oval leaves with a small flower at the tip.

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): an emblematic **serpent-root** plant (single sinuous snake-root). Note: the written heading reads more like **·tilogo·** than “*Bilga*” — heading uncertain. A tradition cryptonym. — **emblematic / unresolved.**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading corrupt; no secure classical equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — paired leaves over a wavy, serpentine creeping root; possibly a snakeweed (*Polygonum*) or *Polygonatum*.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.





f. 16v — *Rubia Emtorum*[?] (Madder)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 36 · master 0265_0035.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Rubia Emtorum[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Rubia Emtorum*[?] — in English, **Madder**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall, tiered plant like a little fir or horsetail: a straight central stem carries **whorls of fine needle-like leaves** in stacked tiers, dotted with small dark fruit-bodies, over a red horizontal root.

IDENTIFICATION

ID update (batch 2 · image re-read): the whorled narrow leaves on a square, minutely-prickly stem are classic **Rubiaceae**; the identification as *Rubia* / *Galium* (**madder** / **bedstraw**) is secure to the tribe and fits *Rubia tinctorum* (**dye's madder**) well. "Emtorum" is most likely a garble of *tinctorum*. — **upgraded: secure to genus.**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *Rubia Emtorum*[?] (so written; cf. *Rubia tinctorum*); classical *Rubia*, *Erythrodanum* (Gr.), medieval *Warantia* / *Garantia*; It. *robbia*, *garanza*.
- *Modern accepted:* *Rubia tinctorum* L. (dye's madder) or *Rubia peregrina* L. (wild madder), family **Rubiaceae**.
- *Common:* madder; It. *robbia*. — **Secure** (whorled leaves + the long red dye-root confirm it).

COMMENTARY

The root, **warm and dry**, was an "opener" — a **diuretic and emmenagogue** for jaundice, obstructions of the liver and spleen and "the stone"; famously it **dyed the urine, milk and even the bones red**. Above all it was *the great red textile dye* of the Middle Ages.



f. 17r — *Serpentina* (with a second "Sigillo"
leaf)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 37 · master 0265_0036.tif — (master 0265_0036.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Serp[en]tina · ouer sig[il]lo ferpo[?]

Layout: a SINGLE short caption-line at the foot of the leaf. The large faint leaf-shape behind the writing is show-through from the painted plant on the other side of the folio — not text — which is why no further note is transcribed here.

Re-read against the master TIFF.

1 [l]a dicta è bona[?], metendose sopra; ouer sono olie[?]. (line recovered in full with a Wallis local-contrast filter — see §G)

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 1 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); D (2 marked [?]).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"The said [herb] is good [for ...], **placed on top** [as a poultice]; or [made into] **oils** ..." (A single short caption; the rest of the apparent "writing" is show-through from the verso painting. A few words remain uncertain.)



f. 17r — *Serpentina* (with a second "Sigillo"
leaf) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Two sketches share the leaf — at left a single upright **sword-shaped leaf**, at right a small plant with **paired leaves**, a few flowers and a curling root — with a line of notes beneath.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — a few flowers and a curling root; *leaves* — Two sketches share the leaf; at left a single upright sword-shaped leaf; at right a small plant with paired leaves.

- *Old / historical:* **Serpentina** = the herbal **Serpentaria** (snakeweed): cf. *Bistorta*, *Colubrina*, *Dracunculus* — a "snake-root" plant.
- *Modern accepted:* **tentative** — a snakeweed (*Bistorta* / *Polygonum*) or a dragon-arum relative; the **serpentine root** is the signature. The left figure ("Sigillo") is a separate, simpler leaf.
- *Common:* snakeweed, serpentary. — **Tentative.**

COMMENTARY

As a "snake-root," the plant would be an **astringent** and a remedy **"against venom"** by the serpent-signature; specifics deferred.





f. 17v — *Sanguinaria* · *Enula campana*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 38 · master 0265_0037.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Sanguinaria · *Enula campana*

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Sanguinaria* · *Enula campana*[?] — in English, **elecampane** / "scabwort". No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bold basal **rosette of large, broad lance-shaped leaves** with strong parallel veins, fanning upward from a fibrous base (plantain-like); the leaves dominate, no flower shown.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — broad lance-shaped leaves with strong parallel veins; the leaves dominate; *habit/stem* — A bold basal rosette of large; *flower/inflor.* — no flower shown.

Tradition-name: *Herba Mula campana* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 52) = elecampane. (*near-exact match.*)

ID update (batch 2 · image re-read): the large, broad, strongly-veined basal leaves fit *Inula helenium* (elecampane / *enula campana*), exactly as the heading names; *Rumex* is less likely. — **firmed to elecampane (probable).**

- *Old / historical:* if *Enula campana*, that is elecampane (*Inula*, *Helenium*, *Enula campana*); if *Sanguinaria*, a blood-stancher (plantain/knotgrass).

- *Modern accepted:* **tentative** — the **large, broad, strongly-veined clumped leaves** best fit *Inula helenium* L. (elecampane, Asteraceae) or a **dock** (*Rumex*); the double heading leaves it ambiguous.

- *Common:* elecampane / "scabwort"; It. *enula campana*. — **Tentative.**

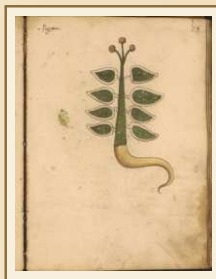
COMMENTARY

(If *elecampane*;) the aromatic root, **warm and dry**, a major **expectorant and stomachic** for chronic cough and weak digestion, and candied as a sweetmeat ("enula"). (If *sanguinaria*;) a **cooling astringent** that staunches bleeding and heals wounds.



f. 18r — *Supafa*[?]

[Unresolved — name uncertain]



manuscript leaf img 39 · master 0265_0038.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Supafa[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Supafa*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A stylised plant: an arching stem hung with **paired dark leaf-pods** set like a row of little green slippers, round buds clustered at the top, and a curving **tail-like root** below.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — round buds clustered at the top, and a curving tail-like root below; *leaves* — A stylised plant: an arching stem hung with paired dark leaf-pods set like a row of little green slippers.

Tradition-name: *Herba Superna* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 20). (plausible match.)

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): stylized **crescent-pod leaves** in rows over a single horn-shaped root — an emblematic tradition plant, not a botanical portrait. — **emblematic / unresolved**.

- **Correction (heading re-read):** an earlier draft read this heading as *Pigamo* and so identified the plant as *Thalictrum* (meadow-rue). At high resolution the heading instead reads «*Supafa*[?]» (or *fupasa*) — a word that does **not** match a standard plant-name, so that identification is **withdrawn**.
- *Old / historical:* the name *Supafa*[?] is unidentified; no secure classical or vernacular equivalent is known.
- *Modern accepted:* **unidentified** — the schematic drawing (an arching stem of paired leaf-pods over a curving tail-root) and the corrupt name do not allow a species to be assigned.
- *Status:* **Unresolved** (name and plant both uncertain).

COMMENTARY

(Of meadow-rue:) the root a mild **purge** and "cleanser," used for jaundice and skin eruptions.

f. 18v — *Lattuca agrestis* (Wild lettuce)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 40 · master 0265_0039.tif — (master 0265_0039.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lattuca agrestis vel asprine[?]

Layout: **SPLIT-BY-IMAGE** — the (Latin) note runs in 7 lines across the foot of the leaf, divided by the central stem (left + right fragment per line). Re-read with decorrelation stretch (which restored the opening eagle line and gave mixtum in ampulla vitrea), then **Kraken** + **CATMuS-Medieval HTR** corrected three readings to match the translation: *prospicere rerum naturas* (L1), *claritudine accipere* (L3, “clearness of sight”), and *medicina experieris* (L7, “you will prove the medicine”).

- 1 L Dicūt aquila[m], cū in altū volauer[it], R prospicere rer[um] naturas
- 2 L Lactuca filvatica [...] R ... et fi vis eius sibi oculos ti-
- 3 L -gere, et maxima ide[?] R ... et claritudine accipere. Herbe
- 4 L igitur lactuce filvatice R ... fuco i[n] vino optimo vetere[?]
- 5 L e mele et acapno[?] R ... fiat fumo coll[ecto]? et
- 6 L mixtū i[n] ampula vitrea[?] R condito, et eo uteris fumo[?]
- 7 L medicina experieris.

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 21 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); D (9 marked [?]); 1x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"They say that the eagle, when it [rises] on high [and wishes] to discern things, [touches] its eyes with wild lettuce — with its juice it anoints its eyes and so gains clearness of sight. Therefore [take] of wild lettuce, honey and acapnon (smoke-free honey), duly mixed in a glass phial — thus you will prove the medicine. To gain clearness of sight, use the herb's juice with the best wine; [the honey] is gathered without smoke; preserve it and use it ..." (The classical eagle-and-lettuce eyesight legend — the eagle was said to sharpen its sight with wild lettuce — framing an eye-recipe of lettuce juice with honey and good wine. Re-read at master resolution; the opening sentence about the eagle, dropped from the earlier reading, is now restored.) (Translation provisional — the underlying transcription is substantially uncertain; 9 words are marked [?].)



f. 18v — *Lactuca agrestis* (Wild lettuce) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall, wispy, much-branched plant with small leaves and scattered tiny flowers/fruits along airy twigs, descending to a red **taproot**; notes fill the lower left.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Lactuca agrestis et asinine*; classical *Lactuca sylvestris / agrestis* (and *Lactuca asinina*, "ass's lettuce"), Greek θρίδαξ (*thridax*); It. *lattuga selvatica*.
 - *Modern accepted*: *Lactuca virosa* L. (or *Lactuca serriola* L.), family Asteraceae.
 - *Common*: wild / prickly lettuce ("lettuce-opium"); It. *lattuga selvatica*.
- *Secure* (by name; the bolted, branching, small-flowered habit fits).

COMMENTARY

Cold and moist; the milky latex (*lactucarium*, "lettuce-opium") is a mild **narcotic, sedative and anodyne** — for **insomnia**, coughs and pain, "to cool heat and quench lust"; the juice was also dropped for the **eyes** (exactly the recipe below).



f. 19r — [Sigillo di Salomone] (Solomon's-seal)

[Secure — by image]



manuscript leaf img 41 · master 0265_0040.tif — (master 0265_0040.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

[sine titulo; segno ·F·]

1 La [erba] [...] è bona spolverizata, fritó[?] e[t] cū la pasta [in] una fugaza nel
2 forno data a magiar fi fa molto dormir; poſe uol tuor uigor[e], ch[e] fe caſtra, fi uol
3 no[n] zaiair e dormir, e no fi ſente, ma da[?] ne pocha; e l'ideſe tropo [im]p[er]f[?] con
4 [...]. La fo[i]a poſta a i maſoni fi trage e ſolda, et ha molte altre uertu, e nui
5 tacemo p[er] me[gl]io; naſce i[n] tereni e mō[n]tagne fabionife e humidi e freſdi, e ſa[?]
6 fiori biā[n]chi. A far el feolar[?] e 3 oneſte [...] o bento[?], et queſta ſ[emen]za; toi[?] [con]
7 acez be[n] forte e ma[cinal]a, fu p[er] lo naſo, e bagna be[n] forte i poſi, e dargene a bever;
8 et ſubito ſe[rà] guarit[?] : —

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 19 expanded abbrev.); B (whole note recovered by enhancement — see note); C (9 supplied words); D (7 marked [?]); 3x lost [...]. — Improved 04.07.2026: re-read from the master with the CONCULS decorrelation-stretch + CLAHE enhancement; the eighth line and the whole recipe-tail (nose / pulses / "give it to drink" / "at once will be healed"), previously lost, are now recovered; ~9 words firmed and the count of doubtful readings sharply reduced.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf bears no title (only a small ·F· mark); the 8-line note at the foot now reads, as far as it can be made out: "The herb is good powdered [and] fried[?], and [worked] into the dough as a flatcake (fugaza) baked in the oven and given to eat it makes one sleep deeply; [and] it is meant to give vigour — for whoever is gelded wishes neither to fret nor to sleep, and feels nothing but gives [him] little [rest?] ...; its [juice], applied to the temples (maſoni), draws out [the matter] and heals, and it has many other virtues which we pass over for brevity; it grows in sandy, humid and cold soils and mountains and bears white flowers. To make ...[?] ... this seed[?]; take[?] [it] with strong vinegar and grind it, [put it] up the nose, and bathe the pulses well, and give some of it to drink; and at once [he] will be healed." (Translation still partly provisional — but far fuller than before: the recipe-tail and the closing "will be healed" are now recovered by enhancement. ~11 words remain uncertain [?]; lines 1-2 & 5 additionally corroborated by Kraken + CATMuS-Medieval HTR. The content is a sleep-and-healing / wound-sealing recipe.)



f. 19r — [Sigillo di Salomone] (Solomon's-seal)

(continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Two versions side by side — a faint **outline sketch** of a berried plant at left (with a yellow lizard-like root at its foot) and a fuller painted stem of **pinnate leaves with red berries** at right on a red root; notes run beneath.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: the figure is **Sigillum Salomonis** ("Solomon's seal," from the round scars on the rhizome), **Polygonatum**, *Frassinella*.
- *Modern accepted*: **Polygonatum odoratum** (Mill.) Druce or **P. multiflorum** (L.) All., family **Asparagaceae**.
- *Common*: Solomon's-seal; It. *sigillo di Salomone*. — **Secure** (the jointed, scarred rhizome, the white flowers and the wound-healing note all agree).

COMMENTARY

Solomon's-seal root is the classic **vulnerary** that "seals" wounds and bruises — proverbially it "takes away the black-and-blue marks gotten by falls or women's wilfulness," knits broken bones, and (per the note) is taken **eaten or drunk**.





f. 19v — *Testiculus* (Orchids: fox-, dog-stones)

[Secure — at genus (by name + image; paired tubers); species uncertain]



manuscript leaf img 42 · master 0265_0041.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Testiculus vulpis · *Testiculus* [canis?]

Layout: the leaf carries **two captions** (two orchid names), left and right; plant-name only — no prose note.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Testiculus* — in English, **Orchids: fox-, dog-stones**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Three tall leafy stems in a row, orchid-fashion: the central one crowned with a dense **reddish-purple flower spike**, flanked by two with green buds, each rising from a rounded **paired tuber**.

IDENTIFICATION

- Old / historical: *Testiculus* (*vulpis* / *canis*), **Satyrium**, **Orchis**, **Cynosorchis** ("dog-orchid").
- Modern accepted: three *Orchis* / *Dactylorhiza* spp., family **Orchidaceae**.
- Common: orchids, dog-stones; It. *testicolo di volpe/cane*. — **Secure at genus** (the paired tubers + names). Cf. f. 9r and f. 20v (the other orchids).

COMMENTARY

As **satyrium**: the paired tubers were the great **aphrodisiac and restorative** (firm tuber to provoke desire, soft to quench it); the source of nourishing *salep*.



f. 20r — [unlabeled]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 43 · master 0265_0042.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

[no written heading on the leaf]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

(no written heading; see Identification)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Two plants, each a tuft of **pinnate leaves** topped by a dense **reddish-purple flower spike** and standing on a fibrous, bulbous root — a matched orchid-like pair.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — bulbous root; *leaves* — each a tuft of pinnate leaves topped by a dense reddish-purple flower spike and standing on a fibrous.

- *Old / historical:* n/a (unlabeled).
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — a dense reddish **flower-spike** over strap leaves and a fringe of fibrous "bearded" roots; possibly a **marsh-orchid** (*Dactylorhiza*) continuing the orchid sequence, or a bistort.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.



f. 20v — *Palma [Christi]* (Hand-orchid)

[Secure — at genus (by name + image; hand-shaped tuber); species uncertain]



manuscript leaf img 44 · master 0265_0043.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Palma [Christi]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Palma [Christi]* — in English, **Hand-orchid**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A single tall stem with **paired narrow leaves** and a slender **spike of pink-purple flowers** at the top, on a thin root — a slim, upright orchid.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: **Palma Christi**, *Satyrium basilicum*, *Testiculus palmatus* — the palmate-tubered orchid.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Dactylorhiza maculata* (L.) Soó** (or another *Dactylorhiza*), family **Orchidaceae**.
- *Common*: spotted/marsh orchid, "hand-orchid"; It. *palma di Cristo*. — **Secure at genus** (the hand-shaped tuber). Cf. f. 9r and f. 19v (the other orchids).

COMMENTARY

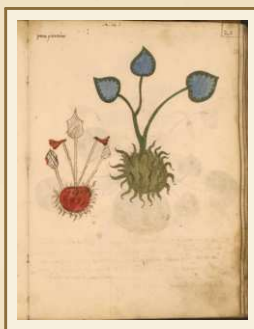
A **satyrium**: the tuber a restorative and aphrodisiac (as f. 9r/f. 19v); by the doctrine of signatures the "hand" was also linked to the strengthening of the limbs.





f. 21r — *Pan porcino* (Cyclamen — "fantastic" version)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 45 · master 0265_0044.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

pan porcino

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Pan porcino* — in English, *Cyclamen* — "fantastic" version. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A stylised, two-part image: a clump of jagged spiky leaves carrying blue heart-shaped flowers on stalks above, and at the lower left a separate red bulb sprouting white florets.

IDENTIFICATION

- Old / historical: *Pan porcino* / *Panis porcinus* ("sowbread," as pigs root up the tubers), *Cyclaminus*, *Arthanita*, *Terrae rapum*.
- Modern accepted: *Cyclamen hederifolium* Aiton / *Cyclamen purpurascens* Mill., family *Primulaceae*.
- Common: cyclamen, sowbread; It. *pan porcino*, *ciclamino*. — *Secure* (cordate leaves + tuber + name).

COMMENTARY

The tuber, hot and dry, is a drastic purge and emmenagogue — famously hung over the door to speed (or, removed, to prevent) birth — used for dropsy, jaundice and, the juice snuffed, for the head and sinuses; toxic in quantity.



f. 21v — *Ciclamen · pan porcino* (Cyclamen —
naturalistic)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 46 · master 0265_0045.tif — (master 0265_0045.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Ciclames vel pan porcino · [vell] pate3o[?]

The note is a 6-line block below the plant (same ink; earlier the leaf showed only the heading + an English paraphrase — the manuscript lines are given here).

- 1 Herba pane-terreni[?], [c]octo i[n] oleo, et q[ui]to oio meffo fu la
- 2 orechia afordo[?], fubito rende lo audire; et leva il dolore. La radife
- 3 fua cota cū il mele et data a magnare, fubito aiuta lo [i]utropico(idropico)
- 4 et foie magnade crude leva la fete a li utropico; lo letuario ha molte
- 5 virtude medicine; la forma[?] colta[?] a ogni luna fe trova; nafce i[n]
- 6 moti fredti, loghi et humidi.

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 7 expanded abbrev.); C (2 supplied words); D (4 marked [?]).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"The herb cyclamen ... **cooked in oil; this oil, put on a deaf ear, at once restores hearing and eases the pain;** its [root], cooked with honey and given to eat, ... the dropsical; the leaves, eaten raw, remove the thirst of the dropsical; the electuaries have many medicinal virtues; it stops the colic; gathered at every (new) moon; it grows in humid mountain places." (A fuller reading — the classic cyclamen ear-oil for deafness alongside its anti-dropsical uses, with a lunar gathering-time. The facsimile gave only the dropsy clause; the fuller text appears at master resolution.)



f. 21v — *Cyclamen · pan porcino* (Cyclamen —
naturalistic) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A sprawling plant with rounded, ivy-like **lobed leaves** and nodding **pink-red bell flowers** on slender stalks, all springing from a large round brown **tuber/corm** with roots — cyclamen-like; notes below.

IDENTIFICATION

- Old / historical: as f. 21r — *Cyclaminus* / *Pan porcino* / *Arthanita*.
- Modern accepted: *Cyclamen* sp., family *Primulaceae*. — *Secure*.

COMMENTARY

Its note (below) records the cooling, anti-dropsical use; cf. f. 21r for the purgative/obstetric reputation of the root.





f. 22r — *Ariftołja* (*Aristolochia* / Birthwort)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 47 · master 0265_0046.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Ariftołja

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Ariftołja* — in English, *Aristolochia* / *Birthwort*. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of **paired oval, lightly toothed leaves** rising from a thick, **twisting orange-brown rhizome** that sprawls across the base.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Aristologia**; Greek ἀριστολογία (*aristolochia*, "best for childbirth/the lochia"), *Aristologia longa* / **rotunda**; It. *aristolochia*.
- *Modern accepted*: *Aristolochia longa* L. / *A. rotunda* L. / *A. clematidis* L., family **Aristolochiaceae**.
- *Common*: birthwort; It. *aristolochia*, *strallogi*. — **Secure** (by name; the knobby tuberous root fits).

COMMENTARY

The **birth-herb** *par excellence* — given to **expel the afterbirth or a dead child and cleanse the womb** (the very meaning of its name); a wound-cleanser that "draws out" splinters, thorns and venom, for **snakebite** and foul ulcers; bitter, **hot and dry**. (Now known to be toxic/nephrotoxic — not for use.)



f. 22v — *Luminela*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 48 · master 0265_0047.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Luminela

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Luminela*[?] — in English, **larkspur** / **love-in-a-mist**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A broad, airy bush of many thin branching stems scattered with **small star-shaped blue flowers** and tiny leaves, on a single slender root — delicate and open.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — on a single slender root; *habit/stem* — airy bush of many thin branching stems scattered with small star-shaped blue flowers and tiny leaves.

Tradition-name: *Herba Luminellas* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 76). (near-exact match.)

- *Old / historical:* MS heading corrupt; the blue, finely-cut flower recalls **Consolida regalis** (forking larkspur) or **Nigella** (love-in-a-mist). It. *fior cappuccio, fanciullaccia*.
- *Modern accepted:* family **Ranunculaceae** — a **larkspur** / **love-in-a-mist** type (*Consolida* or *Nigella*), but the **genus is undetermined** from the stylized drawing.
- *Common:* larkspur / love-in-a-mist. — *Tentative*.

COMMENTARY

(If larkspur:) the seeds were used **against lice and parasites**; (if *nigella*:) the seeds a **carminative and vermifuge**, and a spice.



f. 23r — [Serpentaria?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 49 · master 0265_0048.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

[sine titulo] (no written heading on the leaf; *Serpentaria* is an editorial conjecture from the snake-root drawing)

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

(no written heading; see Identification)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall, slender stem set with **small paired leaves** and a short top spike, growing from a long, curving **snake-like root**.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — curving snake-like root; *leaves* — slender stem set with small paired leaves and a short top spike.

Tradition-name: *Herba Serpentina* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 63) = dragon arum. (*near-exact match*.)

- *Old / historical:* if a "serpentaria," a snake-root plant.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — a tall **flower-spike** with narrow clasping leaves over a long **serpentine root**; possibly a snakeweed or asphodel-relative.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.





f. 23v — *Genciana* (Gentian)

[Probable — by name]



manuscript leaf img 50 · master 0265_0049.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

genciana

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Genciana* — in English, **Gentian**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A clump of **broad lance-shaped leaves** with a central stem of paired leaves and a green spike above, springing from a thick pale stem-base — bold, fleshy foliage.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Name-led (image weak or stylized)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — A clump of broad lance-shaped leaves with a central stem of paired leaves and a green spike above; *habit/stem* — springing from a thick pale stem-base.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Genciana**; **Gentiana** (after King Gentius), **Basilica** (cf. f. 15r).
- *Modern accepted:* ***Gentiana lutea* L.** or another ***Gentiana* sp.**, family **Gentianaceae**. — **Probable** (a second gentian in the book).
- *Common:* gentian, bitterwort; It. *genziana*. — **Probable**. (MS heading **genciana** — the Veneto c-spelling of *gentiana*.) Cf. f. 15r (the other gentian).

COMMENTARY

The supreme **bitter tonic** root — a **stomachic** and **"opener"** for weak digestion and obstructed liver/spleen, a **vermifuge** and febrifuge, and a standard **theriac** ingredient (as f. 15r).





f. 24r — *pepyko*[?] (Peony — recto)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 51 · master 0265_0050.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

pepyko[?] (*corrupt for Peonia; the plant is securely peony — cf. f. 24v*)

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *pepyko*[?] — in English, **Peony** — **recto**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A much-branched leafy plant with **divided leaves** and **small reddish flowers** at the twig-tips, over a tuft of fibrous roots — open and spreading.

IDENTIFICATION

Tradition-name: *Herba Pionia* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 96) = peony. (*near-exact match.*)

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Peonia**; classical **Paemonia** (after **Paemon**, physician of the gods), **Glycyside**; It. *peonia*, *rosa di Santa Maria*; the "male" and "female" peony of the herbals.
- *Modern accepted:* ***Paeonia officinalis* L. / *P. mascula* (L.) Mill.**, family **Paeniaceae**.
- *Common:* peony; It. *peonia*. — **Secure.**

COMMENTARY

The classic remedy for the **brain** and the "**falling sickness**" (**epilepsy**), especially in children — the **root or seeds worn as an amulet** about the neck; also for the womb, nightmares and "the mother."



f. 24v — *Peonia* (Peony — verso, flowering)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 52 · master 0265_0051.tif — (master 0265_0051.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Peonia

Layout: **SPLIT-BY-IMAGE** — the three-line note at the foot of the leaf is crossed by the peony's central stem; each line is read **across** the stem (left fragment + right fragment), and two words are split by it (fem·ena, cele·bro).

- 1 Erba peonia, aquesta vertù: piliála et pestíla, spolueriza[la?], et dali a bereve
- 2 meza octava p[er] ·xx· fere a[...]^o e femena et haueffe mal d[e] **migrania** o de fe[...]
- 3 matura d[e] testa et confortar lo cerebro, ferà guarito.

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 3 expanded abbrev.); D (1 marked [?]); 2x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"Peony herb — this is its virtue: take it, pound it, powder it, and give it to drink ..., for half a measure, for 20 evenings ...; [whether] man or woman; and if one had migraine pain (*mal de migrania*) or [pain] of ... it ripens [the matter] of the head and comforts the brain (*lo cerebro*), [and] will be cured." (Read **across** the central stem — a three-line **SPLIT-BY-IMAGE** note; line 1 is the standard recipe opening (take · pound · powder · give to drink — identical to f.1r), confirmed by Kraken+CATMuS HTR; the firmly legible sense is the migraine / head-and-brain cure, peony's classic sphere against the "falling sickness.") (**Translation provisional** — much of lines 1-2 is obscure; several words are marked [?].)



f. 24v — *Peonia* (Peony — verso, flowering)

(continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall plant of **divided (pinnate)** leaves bearing a **red peony-like flower** on the stem and a butterfly poised at the top, over a dark horizontal root; notes beneath.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical:* as f. 24r — **Paeonia** / **Glycyside**.
- *Modern accepted:* ***Paeonia officinalis* L.**, family **Paeoniaceae**. — **Secure**.

COMMENTARY

Peony's note (below) is, fittingly, about the **head and brain** — its great sphere of use against epilepsy and disorders of the head.





f. 25r — *Paris* (Herb Paris / True-love)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 53 · master 0265_0052.tif — (master 0265_0052.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Parif

- 1 Erba paris [vale] a fanar uno offo rotto[?] (or *frā[c]te*), [per] febre o
p[er]
- 2 altra malatia; tira il fango, cū olio dolce mefe[?] data et 3[?] il loffo[?];
fiā-
- 3 te; et nā miꝯando se uno fufee [...]
- 4 p[er]cuffa[?] ifirma[?], miza[?] la dat[?] [...]
- 5 i menestra[?] cū libere[?] p[er] spazio et [...]
- 6 libera et ritornera i[n] f[uo] stato; la nafce
- 7 [in luoghi] fredī et lochi ofcūri —

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 7 expanded abbrev.); C (8 supplied words);

D (10 marked [?]); 3x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Herb-Paris note: its juice with sweet oil, given for a wound/blow; over a space of time one is freed and returns to one's [former] state; the herb grows in cold and dark places — consistent with Paris quadrifolia of shady woods. Partly legible. (*Translation provisional — the underlying transcription is substantially uncertain; 9 words are marked [?].*)





f. 25r — *Paris* (Herb Paris / True-love) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A central stem ringed by a **whorl of broad pointed leaves**, with small reddish buds on thin stalks above and a thick pale root below; a faint outline of the same plant stands at the left, with notes.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Paris**; **Herba Paris**, **Uva lupina/vulpina** ("wolf-grape"), **Aconitum pardalianches**(?); It. *uva di volpe*, *erba paris*, "true-love," "one-berry."
- *Modern accepted*: ***Paris quadrifolia* L.**, family **Melanthiaceae** (formerly Trilliaceae).
- *Common*: herb Paris, true-love; It. *erba paris*. — **Secure** (the single whorl of net-veined leaves + berries is diagnostic).

COMMENTARY

A **narcotic**, **cooling** woodland plant; the berries and root were used against **frenzy and madness**, as an **antidote** to plague and poison, and for inflammations and wounds — but the plant is **toxic**.





f. 25v — *Saponaria* (Soapwort)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 54 · master 0265_0053.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Saponaria

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Saponaria* — in English, **Soapwort**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A branching plant of **paired oval leaves** topped by clusters of **small white-pink star flowers**, growing from a long curving root — airy sprays of bloom above.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Saponaria*; *Herba fullonum* ("fuller's herb"), *Struthium*; It. *saponaria*, *erba da sapone*.
- *Modern accepted*: *Saponaria officinalis* L., family *Caryophyllaceae*.
- *Common*: soapwort, bouncing-Bet; It. *saponaria*. — *Secure*.

COMMENTARY

The saponin-rich root and leaves **lather like soap** (used by fullers to scour wool); medicinally a "**cleanser of the blood**" for skin diseases (scabies, "leprosy," eruptions), a sweat-promoter, and for the liver, spleen and chest.





f. 26r — *Trifolio* (Clover)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 55 · master 0265_0054.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

trifolio

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Trifolio* — in English, **Clover**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem set with **paired rounded leaves in tiers** and crowned by a single dark-red bud, over a spread of pale fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Trifolio**; **Trifolium**, **Trifolium pratense**; It. *trifoglio*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Trifolium pratense* L.** (red clover) or another ***Trifolium***, family **Fabaceae** (Leguminosae).
- *Common*: clover, trefoil; It. *trifoglio*. — **Secure**.

COMMENTARY

Cooling; the flower-heads in a poultice or wash for inflammations and skin complaints, a mild "cleanser" and expectorant, and prime fodder; the trefoil long a symbol of the **Trinity**.





f. 26v — *Bistorta* (Bistort — with note)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 56 · master 0265_0055.tif — (master 0265_0055.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Bistorta

- 1 Erba bistorta, la sua radice [vale a] ogni dolor de corpo et [a la sfrectura?] de
stomacho;
- 2 pestandola e [darla a bere] cū vino, la libera; et cū a ogni dolor sia p[er]
ventosità;
- 3 le fue foie polverizate guariffe ogni male; questa erba nasce [in] lochi alpi[ni]
4 et petr[osi]; nasce i[n] quel d[e] nov[?] [...]

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 7 expanded abbrev.); C (5 supplied words); D (2
marked [?]); 1x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Bistort note: its **root** [avails for] **every pain of the body** and [the constriction?] **of the stomach**; **pounded and given to drink with wine**, it **frees** [the patient]; and likewise for **any pain that comes from flatulence** (*ventosità*); **its leaves, powdered, cure every ill**; the herb **grows in alpine and rocky places** — followed by a final, uncertain phrase (*nasce in quel de nov[?]* — "it grows in those of ...", unclear). Partly legible (the note runs over the twisted root). (*Translation provisional* — several words remain uncertain and marked [?]. Note: the earlier "theriac / against every ill" reading is withdrawn — high-res recovery + HTR show the text is the stomach/body-pain and flatulence note given here.)





f. 26v — *Bistorta* (Bistort — with note) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bold marsh plant: **broad lance-shaped leaves** and a tall stem bearing a thick brown **cattail-like spike** (bulrush/Typha), with a curling root at the base; notes beneath.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Bistorta** ("twice-twisted"); **Serpentaria**, **Colubrina** (cf. f. 5r).
- *Modern accepted*: ***Bistorta officinalis* Delarbre** (= *Polygonum bistorta* L.), family **Polygonaceae**. — **Secure** (the twisted rhizome confirms it; a second, fuller bistort after f. 5r).
- *Common*: bistort, snakeroot; It. *bistorta*.

COMMENTARY

A powerful **astringent** (as f. 5r); the note rehearses its use for the stomach and pains, pounded and drunk in wine, as a cure-all powder.



f. 27r — *ariola* / *oriola*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 57 · master 0265_0056.tif — (master 0265_0056.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

oriola · *oriola mazor*

Layout: SPLIT-BY-IMAGE — a dense ~13-line note in the upper right, each line divided by the thin stem of the small drawn plant into a left and a right fragment (read across). Same ink, partly faded; earlier only four lines were shown.

- 1 Herba oriola a[?] lipidido[?] trovasse
- 2 in terreni [montofl][?] silvestri et
- 3 humidi e fredii lochi. La femēza fua
- 4 et letuarij [da] purgare fono bone; fa-
- 5 tene erbol[?]; li fugo cū la farina[ta]
- 6 [et] cortelij[?] a bon; et la polvere
- 7 et le foie e pu[?] fono bone da purgā[r]
- 8 data a bere co[n] il vino; etiā e bona
- 9 la polver data ut sup[ra] ala febre 4^a [quartana];
- 10 ·3· dade [dofl], ·3· volte et 3[?] [...]
- 11 fer[a?] ne ogni autuno[?];
- 12 ogni volta iij [tre] foie o piu, e piu [volte]
- 13 et meno, fecondo la etade et la p[er]fona;
- 14 [?] et egual[?]; e alela fegondo
- 15 il regno, il dito fegno de fagittario[?] [(Sagittarius) = Sagittarius]

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 8 expanded abbrev.); B (top nine lines firmed by enhancement — see note); C (12 supplied words); D (14 marked [?]); 1x lost [...]. — Improved 04.07.2026: re-read from the master with the CONCLUS decorrelation-stretch + CLAHE enhancement; the upper nine lines are now firm and the doubtful count is roughly halved (29 -> 13). New: the note closes with an astrological attribution — the sign of Sagittarius and a dosing rule "by the age and the person."

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Oriola note (~13-15 lines, read across the small stem): "The herb *oriola* is found in mountainous, wild, humid and cold places. Its seed and electuaries are good to purge; make ... of it; the juice with flour ..., and the powder and the leaves are good to purge, given to drink with wine; also, as above, [it is] good for the quartan fever — 3 doses, 3 times ...; gather it every autumn; each time three leaves or more, more or fewer times, according to the age and the person; ... and equally; and give it according to the reign of the said sign of Sagittarius ((Sagittarius))." (Translation provisional for the lower third — the plant's painted root crosses those lines; the upper part is now firm. New: the note ends with an astrological sign, Sagittarius.)



f. 27r — *ariola* / *oriola*[?] (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A stem of **paired leaves** topped by a **purple flower spike**, with a small detail-sketch and notes alongside, and a curling root below.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — with a small detail-sketch and notes alongside, and a curling root below; *leaves* — A stem of paired leaves topped by a purple flower spike.

Tradition-name: *Herba Ariola* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 19). (*near-exact match.*)

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): this leaf is **better-evidenced** — it carries a medicinal note and a comparison sketch labelled *oriola magore* (greater oriola). Pinnate leaves, red flowers, a snaky root; the name *oriola* / *ariola* may be *Aristolochia* (birthwort) or a local coinage. — **tentative (has text; possibly Aristolochia).**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *ariola* / *oriola* — a vernacular/corrupt name, no secure classical equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — paired leaves, purple flowers and a serpentine root, on an **alpine** plant (per its note); candidates include a *Valeriana*, *Veratrum* or *Gentiana*.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.





f. 27v — *Spargula maggiore* (Spurrey)

[Probable — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 58 · master 0265_0057.tif — (master 0265_0057.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Spargula mazor · ouer minor[?]

- 1 Erba spargula mazor è bona a [chi è] frafione[?] di popa[?] o d'altro [membro?];
- 2 et al uino subito mi ziga il dolor;
- 3 de afta spargola, cota i[n] aqua d'orzo mendiata[?] et i[m]piastrata ala gola, subito libera;
- 4 et al mal de la migrana, cota i[n] aceto et i[m]piastrata al corpo, subito libera dal dolor;
- 5 el fugo fuo [...] i bocha fa spuntare la rema[?]; etiā [vale] ali dolori de denti [...] e a li occhi

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 6 expanded abbrev.); C (4 supplied words); D (7 marked [?]); 2x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Spurrey note: with wine it soothes pain; the herb cooked in barley-water and applied to the throat frees it; cooked in vinegar and applied for migraine; the juice in the mouth draws out rheum; also good for toothache and the eyes. Partly legible (one note, flanking the stem — read across).





f. 27v — *Spargula maggiore* (Spurrey) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A whorled plant (bedstraw-fashion): slender stems carry rings of narrow leaves and tiny flowers, all rising from a dense mat of red fibrous roots; notes at the side.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Name-led (image weak or stylized)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — all rising from a dense mat of red fibrous roots; *leaves* — A whorled plant (bedstraw-fashion): slender stems carry rings of narrow leaves and tiny flowers.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *Spargula mazor* (= *Spergula maior*), the whorled "star" plant of the herbals; cf. *Aparine*, *Asperula*; It. *spergola*, *attaccamani*, *stellaria*.
- *Modern accepted:* *Spergula* sp. (spurrey), family *Caryophyllaceae* — by the name and the whorls of narrow leaves. (*The same whorled-star habit also fits the bedstraws — Galium / Asperula, Rubiaceae — with which these plants were grouped; so a bedstraw cannot be excluded on the drawing alone, but the heading favours Spergula.*)
- *Common:* spurrey (or bedstraw); It. *spergola*. — **Probable** (name + whorled-leaf habit).

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 28r — *Sigillo di Santa Maria* (Solomon's-seal)

[Secure — by image (the drawing is Solomon's-seal); the heading is the Marian *Sigillo di Santa Maria*]



manuscript leaf img 59 · master 0265_0058.tif — (master 0265_0058.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

figilo santa maria

- 1 Erba sigili sâc[ta] mǎ[ria] · [a]lstring[er?] li orpb[?] dali mizo[?] la radice de effa cǔ ani p[er] 3o[?]
- 2 guarifi · et una fufa frigida[?] o de stomato tolea de [a]fta radi[ce] et cofi le [g]uino[?] et
- 3 poi to[?] çen[?] [con] d[e] garofoli et 3 · 6 · et metelle[?] · fa como fyropo et tor[?]
- 4 la matina aftoda[?]mo de[?]urno et g[ua]rin[?] [...]

figilo santa maria

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 10 expanded abbrev.); C (6 supplied words); D (13 marked [?]); 1x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

A recipe using the *sigillo santa maria* (Solomon's-seal) root: it is astringent; for a cold/frigid stomach take the root prepared with cloves (*garofoli*, 6 drams), made like a syrup and taken in the morning. (*Translation provisional* — the underlying transcription is substantially uncertain; 12 words are marked [?].)



f. 28r — *Sigillo di Santa Maria* (Solomon's-seal)

(continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An **arching stem** hung along its curve with paired oval leaves and a row of **dark purple berries**, springing from a tuft of fibrous roots — a bow-shaped, berried branch; notes below.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Sigilo santa maria** (*Sigillum Sanctae Mariae*, a **Marian variant of the sigillo / "seal" name** used for this herb-group, alongside *Sigillum Salomonis*); **Polygonatum**. (Historically the "seal" name also wandered to black bryony, *Tamus*, but the drawing here is plainly Solomon's-seal.)
- *Modern accepted*: ***Polygonatum odoratum* (Mill.) Druce** (or *P. multiflorum*), family **Asparagaceae** — a second Solomon's-seal (cf. f. 19r), identified from the drawing.
- *Common*: Solomon's-seal; It. *sigillo di Salomone / sigillo di Santa Maria*. — **Secure** by image (arching berried stem + jointed rhizome).

COMMENTARY

The vulnerary that "seals" wounds and bruises (cf. f. 19r); the note gives a dosing instruction.



f. 28v — *Camepiteos*

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 60 · master 0265_0059.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Camepiteof

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Camepiteos* — in English, **ground pine, yellow bugle**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall, straight stem closely set its whole length with **paired oval leaves** and a few small yellow flowers, on a fibrous root — a full, ladder-leaved column of foliage.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Conflicting traditions / possible conflation

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — on a fibrous root; *leaves* — straight stem closely set its whole length with paired oval leaves and a few small yellow flowers.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *Camepiteos*; Greek χαμαίπυτος (*chamaipitys*, "ground pine"), *Iva arthritica*; It. *iva*, *camepizio*.
- *Modern accepted:* *Ajuga chamaepitys* (L.) Schreb., family *Lamiaceae*. — Name secure, but the **broad ovate-leaved** drawing does not match ground pine's small, pine-scented, divided leaves — a likely **name/image mismatch**.
- *Common:* ground pine, yellow bugle; It. *iva artetica*. — **Tentative** (name vs. image).

COMMENTARY

(Of ground pine:) **warm and dry**, the celebrated remedy for **gout, sciatica and all diseases of the joints** (*Iva arthritica*), an emmenagogue and diuretic, and a wound-herb.



f. 29r — *Dittamo bianco* (White dittany)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 61 · master 0265_0060.tif — (master 0265_0060.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

.d[i]ttam[o] biā[n]zo[?].

- 1 Erba ditamo bianco è bono a chi fufe morfum di ferpe[n]te: toi la fua radice
2 fpolverezata, data a bere co[n] il vino vecchio, fubito geta fora el veneno.
3 A femina 3(che) avefe creatura morta i[n] corpo, dage a beber il fuco d[e] le foglie:
4 fubito la fa parturire. Etiā havendone adoffo, è feguro 3(che) niuna ferpe no fe
5 [li] pò aproximare; et come fente lo odore [...] e more e fuge donde nafce [l'erba];
6 [...] havendo[fe] adoffo fa la p[er]fona fegura d[e] ogni fporco[?] [...]]
7 durante[?] [...] i[n] meffe; ogni dì una[?] et poi il tene adoffo fa
8 feguro da ogni infegure[?] e male, dogie; el dotore Macrobio[?] [...]]
9 la ferma[?] [...] el longo nafce i[n] tereni forti e priti(prati), et i[n] li prati fi di mo-
10 ragna molto fe ne trova i[n] Cicilia(Sicilia), et li refa d[e] fua natura, ma i[n] molti logi
fe-
11 ne trova i[n] Italia, i[n] Tofcana e Romagna [...] nafce [...] e afpri orbi[?].

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 15 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); C (2 supplied words); D (7 marked [?]); 8x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"The herb **white dittany** is good for one who has been **bitten by a serpent**: take its root, powdered, given to drink with old wine — at once it **drives out the venom**. For a **woman who has a dead child in her body**, give her the **juice of the leaves** to drink: at once it **makes her give birth**. And worn on the body, one is safe — **no serpent can come near**; and when [the serpent] **smells its odour**, it **flees and dies** where the herb grows. ... The **physician Macrobius[?]** confirms it. ... It grows in strong soils and meadows; much of it is **found in Sicily**, and it is **found in Italy — in Tuscany and Romagna ...**" (Best-effort native-res reading of a cramped ~11-line note: snakebite antidote + childbirth use + serpent-repellent amulet + a cited authority + Italian provenance. Words marked [?] remain uncertain.)





f. 29r — *Dittamo bianco* (White dittany) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall, much-branched plant of **many small oval leaves** with little flowers at the top, standing over a distinctive **blue wavy band** (the ground/water line) and roots; the long note fills the lower half of the leaf.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **dittamo biango** (= *dittamo bianco*, white dittany); **Dictamnus** / **Dictamnium** (Greek δίκταμνον), **Fraxinella**; It. *dittamo bianco*, *frassinella*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Dictamnus albus* L.**, family **Rutaceae** (white dittany / burning-bush). The serpent- and childbirth-lore in the note is the **Cretan-dittany** tradition (*Origanum dictamnus*), which the medieval herbals merged with *Dictamnus*.
- *Common*: white dittany, burning-bush, gas-plant; It. *dittamo bianco*. — *Secure* (by name); pairs with f.29v *Diptamus*.

COMMENTARY

Dittany lore (Dioscorides / Pliny / Virgil tradition): the root powdered in old wine is an **antidote to snakebite**; the leaf-juice **expels a dead fetus** and hastens delivery; **worn as an amulet** it keeps serpents away — they are said to **flee and die from its smell**. The note cites a "**dottore Macrobio**" as authority and gives an Italian provenance (Sicily, Tuscany, Romagna).

Editorial note (native-resolution re-read): read in three strips at master resolution; refinements vs the earlier block: line 1 **biango**, line 4 "**niuna serpe no se li pò aproximare**", line 5 **odore** not "**dolore**", line 10 adds **Cicilia/Sicilia**.



f. 29v — *Diptamuf* (Dittany / Burning-bush)

[Probable — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 62 · master 0265_0061.tif — (master 0265_0061.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Diptamuf

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Diptamuf* — in English, **Dittany / Burning-bush**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of **pinnate leaves** (paired leaflets) topped by a small **pink flower spike**, on a fibrous root — slender and erect.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Name-led (image weak or stylized)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — on a fibrous root; *leaves* — An upright stem of pinnate leaves (paired leaflets) topped by a small pink flower spike; *habit/stem* — slender and erect.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Dictamum**; **Dictamnus / Dictamnium** (Greek δίκταμνον, of Mt Dikte in Crete), **Fraxinella**; It. *dittamo*, *frassinella*.
- *Modern accepted:* ***Dictamnus albus* L.**, family **Rutaceae** (or, if Cretan dittany, *Origanum dictamnus*).
- *Common:* (false) dittany, burning-bush, gas-plant; It. *dittamo*. — **Probable** (pinnate leaves + pink star-flowers).

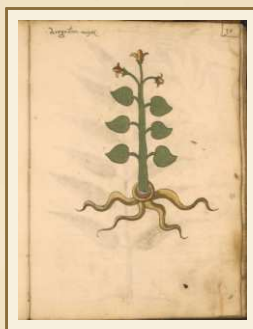
COMMENTARY

Dittany was the classical **wound-herb and antidote** that "draws out" arrows and splinters and counters venom (the dittany of Crete that healed wounds and expelled the dead child); an emmenagogue. The living plant (*Fraxinella*) exudes a flammable oil — hence "burning-bush."



f. 30r — *Dragontia mazor* (Dragon arum /
Serpentaria)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 63 · master 0265_0062.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

drago[n]ea mazor[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Dragontia mazor* — in English, **Dragon arum / Serpentaria**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of **paired leaves** crowned with small flowers, rising from a striking tangle of **twisting, snake-like roots** spread across the base.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **dregodra mazor** (written form; = *Dragontea / Serpentaria maior*); classical **Dracontium, Dracunculus, Colubrina**; It. *dragontea, serpentaria, erba biscia* (cf. f. 11r, f. 93v).
- *Modern accepted*: ***Dracunculus vulgaris* Schott** (= *Arum dracunculus* L.), family **Araceae**.
- *Common*: dragon arum, dragonwort, snakewort; It. *dragontea*. — **Secure** (by name; the writhing roots are the dragon/serpent iconography).

COMMENTARY

A **dragon/snake herb**: by the doctrine of signatures the serpentine roots marked it as a remedy **against snakebite and venom**, and as a wound-cleanser; **hot and dry**. The third dragontea in the book (cf. f. 11r, f. 93v). (*Acrid and irritant — not for casual use.*)





f. 30v — *Roondenina*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 64 · master 0265_0063.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Roondenina

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Roondenina*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bold spray of large **paired lance-shaped leaflets** (pinnate), dark green, on a single arching stem — ash-like and luxuriant.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — A bold spray of large paired lance-shaped leaflets (pinnate); *habit/stem* — on a single arching stem.

Tradition-name: *Herba Rondella* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 89). (*plausible match*.)

ID update (batch 2 · image re-read): a pinnate frond of paired lanceolate leaflets. The name may echo *rondinina* ("little swallow" = a swallow-herb, cf. *Chelidonium/Vincetoxicum*), but the pinnate leaf better fits a **fern** (*Polypodium*) or a **legume**. — **tentative / unresolved**.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading uncertain/corrupt.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — pinnate compound leaves suggest a **leguminous herb (vetch)** or an ash-like plant.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified**.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.



f. 31r — *Regaliçia* (Liquorice)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 65 · master 0265_0064.tif — (master 0265_0064.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

regaliçia

The note is a dense ~12-line block in the same ink, partly crossed by the root; line-breaks follow the manuscript as closely as the abrasion allows.

- 1 Erba regaliçia [nafce ...] marina di fena[?], et [...] ha molte virtude. La p[rim]a è
- 2 bona al cataro et ogni [con]stretura di pecto, et vsope(ifofo) [...] et fiele[?] [...].
- 3 Governarla i[n] gfito(questo) modo: toi la radice di gfito(questa) 3erba, [et] barbe
- 4 d[e] fenochi(finocchio), et anefi(anife), et cubebe, et cubita[?], et [...]
- 5 minuta, et melle(miele), et [...] et barbe et borbe[?] di furfure[?], i[n] aqua et ordeo(orzo), et
- 6 fa fyropo [...]; et metti melle[?] [...]; et digito[?]
- 7 fyropo da abere · 6 · di; al i[n]fermo la fera et la matina. Questa fyropo
- 8 purga il corpo, et i[n] gfito(questo) modo guarife il mal del cataro, et è d[e] pete3e[?]
- 9 d[e] pecto; et è bona ala nofeula[?] [...] diftefa[?] p[er] freo, et de fubito fera
- 10 liberato. Et [el] doctore inferma[?]; ha molte virtude bone al corpo 3umano(humano).
- 11 [...] el mazo(maggio) et el 3ugno(giugno) et el fo[?] tempo [...]
- 12 fe trova, et è bona.

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 10 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); C (2 supplied words); D (12 marked [?]); 11x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"The herb liquorice ... has many virtues. The first: it is good for catarrh and every tightness of the chest — with hyssop ... Prepare it this way: take the root of this herb, and fennel roots, anise, cubeb ... minced, and honey ..., in water and barley, and make a syrup ... A syrup to drink for six days — to the sick person, evening and morning. This syrup purges the body, and in this way cures catarrh and the phlegm[?] of the chest; it is good for [the chill] ... and at once one is freed. And the physician affirms: it has many virtues good for the human body. ... [it grows / is gathered in] May and June ... and it is good." (Native-res reading: a sweet pectoral/laxative liquorice syrup compounded with fennel, anise, cubeb and honey — the classic liquorice cough-and-chest indication, with May/June harvest. Words marked [?] uncertain.)



f. 31r — *Regaliça* (Liquorice) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of **pinnate leaves** (paired leaflets) with small flower-clusters, growing from a thick, **twisting brown root** that snakes across the base; the note fills the lower left.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **regaliça** (Veneto for *liquirizia*); Lat. **Liquiritia** / **Glycyrrhiza**, Greek γλυκύρριζα (*glykyrrhiza*, "sweet root"); It. *regolizia*, *liquirizia*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Glycyrrhiza glabra* L.**, family **Fabaceae** (**Leguminosae**).
- *Common*: liquorice; It. *liquirizia* / *regolizia*. — **Secure** (heading + drawing: odd-pinnate leaves, pea-family flower-tuft, and the long sweet **taproot** that is the drug; the note's chest-syrup use is the classic liquorice indication).

COMMENTARY

Liquorice root — a **demulcent and expectorant** for chest-tightness and cough, and a sweet base/sweetener for syrups; mildly laxative. This matches the note exactly: a **syrup with fennel and honey** that "heals the chest." (Formerly catalogued here as *polypody*; corrected to liquorice on the re-read of the heading and the drawing.)

Editorial note (native-resolution re-read): 12 lines read in strips at master resolution; refinements vs the earlier block: **virtude** (not "bontà"), **ogni constretura di pecto**, the added spices **anesi/cubebe**, the dosing "**la sera et la matina**", and the closing harvest months **mazo/zugno** = **maggio/giugno**.





f. 31v — *Celidonia* (Greater celandine)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 66 · master 0265_0065.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Celidonia

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Celidonia* — in English, **Greater celandine**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A low, bushy plant with **deeply lobed, oak-like leaves** spreading on short stems, over a tuft of fibrous roots — broad and ground-hugging.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Celidonia**; Greek χελιδόνιον (*chelidonium*, "swallow-wort," for blooming when the swallows return), **Hirundinaria**; It. *celidonia*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Chelidonium majus* L.**, family **Papaveraceae**.
- *Common*: greater celandine, swallow-wort; It. *celidonia*. — **Secure**.

COMMENTARY

The orange **latex** was famous for the **eyes** — to "clear the sight," remove films and spots (by the legend that swallows restore their nestlings' sight with it) — and for **jaundice** (yellow sap for the yellow disease), warts and tetters; **hot, dry and acrid**.



f. 32r — jzolavičas[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 67 · master 0265_0066.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

jzolavičas[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *jzolavičas*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A central stem of **broad paired leaves** with small **blue flowers** on thin stalks above, rising from a **coiled red serpent-root** at the base.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — rising from a coiled red serpent-root at the base; *leaves* — A central stem of broad paired leaves with small blue flowers on thin stalks above.

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): an emblematic **coiled serpent-root** with heart leaves and blue tubular flowers — a tradition cryptonym plant. — **emblematic / unresolved.**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading corrupt; no secure equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — broad paired leaves with **blue flowers**; possibly a **lungwort** (*Pulmonaria*), **comfrey** (*Symphytum*) or **borage** (*Borago*).
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.



f. 32v — *Esula mazoro* (Spurge)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 68 · master 0265_0067.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Efula mazora

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Esula mazoro* — in English, **Spurge**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A low, spreading plant of many **small narrow leaves** tipped with **yellow flower-clusters**, on a single root — dense and mounded.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Efula mazoro* = *Esula maggiore* ("greater spurge"); *Esula* / *Euphorbia*, *Tithymalus*, *Lactaria* ("milk-herb"); It. *esula*.
- *Modern accepted*: *Euphorbia esula* L. (leafy spurge) or another *Euphorbia*, family *Euphorbiaceae*.
- *Common*: spurge; It. *esula*, *euforbia*. — *Secure* (linear leaves + yellow-green cyathia + the name).

COMMENTARY

The acrid **milky latex** is a **drastic purgative and caustic** — **hot and dry** in the extreme — used to "purge the watery humour" in dropsy and to burn off **warts and corns**; violently irritant and toxic.



f. 33r — *Folegos*[?] (drawing: Dropwort / *Filipendula*)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 69 · master 0265_0068.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Folegos[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Folegos*[?] — in English, **drawing: Dropwort / *Filipendula***. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A slender stem of **pinnate leaves** topped by a flower, springing from a cluster of **red bulblets and roots** at the base; notes alongside.

IDENTIFICATION

Tradition-name: *Herba Foleas* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 38). (strong match.)

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): pinnate compound leaves and a reddish head over **three tubers drawn with human faces** = morphotype **dropwort** (*Filipendula vulgaris*) (pinnate leaves + root-tubers), rendered emblematically. — **tentative (dropwort morphotype).**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *Filipendula* ("hanging on a thread," for the tubers strung on the roots); *Oenanthe*, *Saxifraga rubra*; It. *filipendola*.
- *Modern accepted:* *Filipendula vulgaris* Moench (= *Spiraea filipendula* L.), family Rosaceae.
- *Common:* dropwort; It. *filipendola*. — *Secure* (pinnate leaves + the strung tubers).

COMMENTARY

The tuberous root, **warm and dry**, a **diuretic and "stone"-breaker** for gravel, the bladder and **strangury**, and an astringent for fluxes; the tubers were also eaten.



f. 33v — *Cyperis* (Galingale / Sedge)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 70 · master 0265_0069.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Ciperif

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Cyperis* — in English, **Galingale / Sedge**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall, slender plant with **grass-like narrow leaves** and an **umbel of small white flowers** at the top, on a thin root — an airy, grass-like sedge (*Cyperus* has an umbel-like cluster of spikelets, not a true umbel).

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Cyperis**; Greek κύπειρος (*kypeiros*), **Cyperus**; It. *cipero*, *zigolo*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Cyperus longus* L.** (sweet galingale) or ***C. rotundus* L.**, family **Cyperaceae**.
- *Common*: galingale, sweet sedge; It. *cipero*. — **Secure** (grassy habit + umbel + aromatic root).

COMMENTARY

The aromatic **tuberous root**, **warm and dry**, was a **diuretic, emmenagogue and stomachic** — for "the stone" and the womb — and a perfume/aromatic.



f. 34r — *angalos*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 71 · master 0265_0070.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

angalos[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *angalos*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A stylised, emblematic plant: red-pink **striped pointed leaves** radiate around a central **red four-lobed flower**, with small blue flowers on stalks above — decorative rather than naturalistic.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — emblematic plant: red-pink striped pointed leaves radiate around a central red four-lobed flower; *habit/stem* — with small blue flowers on stalks above.

Tradition-name: *Herba Angalles* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 13). (*near-exact match*.)

ID update (batch 3 · image re-read): **purely emblematic** — striped red-and-gold lance-leaves and blue bell-flowers over a geometric **quatrefoil root**. A fantastic tradition plant with no real botanical referent. — **emblematic / fantastic (n/a)**.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading corrupt; no secure equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — pinnate leaves with blue flowers over an **ornamental red quatrefoil root-crown** (a "fantastic" element, cf. f. 15r).
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified**.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.

f. 34v — *Erba fanula*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 72 · master 0265_0071.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Erba fanula[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Erba fanula*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bold, tree-like spray of large **pinnate leaves** (paired leaflets) on a central stem, dark green, over fibrous roots — ash- or walnut-like foliage.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — over fibrous roots; *leaves* — tree-like spray of large pinnate leaves (paired leaflets) on a central stem.

ID update (batch 2 · image re-read): the name *erba sanula* ~ “little heal-herb” (from *sanare*); the pinnate compound leaves fit a **wound-herb of the burnet/agrimony group** (*Sanguisorba* / *Agrimonia*) or **sanicle** (*Sanicula*). Name supports a “heal-all.” — **tentative (heal-herb / burnet group)**.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading corrupt; no secure equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — a bushy plant with **pinnate compound leaves**; possibly a **goat's-rue** (*Galega*) or a vetch.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.



f. 35r — .tilel[?].

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 73 · master 0265_0072.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

.tilel[?].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name .tilel[?].; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A row of upright **pointed leaves** with small flowers on stalks, all growing along a **horizontal wavy blue rhizome** — a waterside plant laid out left to right.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — all growing along a horizontal wavy blue rhizome; *habit/stem* — A row of upright pointed leaves with small flowers on stalks.

Tradition-name: *Herba Tilles* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 42). (*near-exact match*.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — lance leaves rising from a blue serpent/eel root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved**.

- *Old / historical:* heading illegible.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — strap leaves and flower-stalks from a **creeping horizontal rhizome**; possibly **sweet flag** (*Acorus calamus*) or an *Iris*.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified**.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.





f. 35v — *Efula F[efinuali?]* (Spurge)

[Probable — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 74 · master 0265_0073.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Efula F[efinuali?] (second word obscure — clearly not “minore”)

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Efula F[efinuali?]* — in English, **Spurge**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A plant of finely cut, **feathery leaves** topped by a **yellow umbel** of flowers (fennel/dill fashion), on a thick root; notes alongside.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Name-led (image weak or stylized)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — on a thick root; *flower/inflor.* — feathery leaves topped by a yellow umbel of flowers (fennel/dill fashion).

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Esula**; **Euphorbia**, **Tithymalus** (cf. f. 32v).
- *Modern accepted:* a **Euphorbia** sp. (a lesser spurge), family **Euphorbiaceae**.
- *Common:* spurge; It. *esula*. — **Probable** (by name; glaucous leaves + yellow cyathia).

COMMENTARY

As f. 32v — the acrid milky latex a drastic purge and caustic; hot and dry, toxic.





f. 36r — *Mandragora* (Mandrake) — the manuscript's signature image

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 75 · master 0265_0074.tif — (master 0265_0074.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Luciana mandragora

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Mandragora* — in English, **Mandrake**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A mandrake: a crown of round fruits and a fan of leaves above a large pale **forked, man-shaped root** trailing fine whisker-roots — the famous anthropomorphic rootstock.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: **Mandragora** (Greek *μανδραγόρας*), **Anthropomorphon** ("man-shaped"), **Circaea**, "apple of love" / "Satan's apple"; the **male and female** mandrake (*mas / femina*) of the herbals; the *dudaim* of Genesis — Rachel and Leah's "mandrakes."
- *Modern accepted*: ***Mandragora officinarum* L.** (and *M. autumnalis* Bertol.), family **Solanaceae**.
- *Common*: mandrake; It. *mandragora*. — **Secure** (the most recognisable plant in the book).

COMMENTARY

Mandrake is a powerful **narcotic and anaesthetic** of the nightshade family. The root, steeped in **wine**, was the classic **soporific given before surgery or cautery** so that the patient "should sleep and feel no pain" — the ancestor of anaesthesia — and a remedy for **insomnia, pain and melancholy**; **cold and narcotic**, and **toxic** in excess. It was equally a famed **aphrodisiac and fertility charm** (the biblical love-apples). Its lore is unmatched: shaped like a man or woman, said to grow beneath the gallows, and to **shriek fatally when uprooted** — so it was loosened and pulled with a **dog** tied to it. (*Genuinely toxic — not for use.*)





f. 36v — *Tamarisco* (Tamarisk)

[Probable — by name]



manuscript leaf img 76 · master 0265_0075.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Tamarifço

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Tamarisco* — in English, **Tamarisk**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A dense **rosette of feathery fronds** springing from a thick, scaly trunk-base — fern- or young-palm-like, full and plume-shaped.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Name-led (image weak or stylized)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — A dense rosette of feathery fronds springing from a thick.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Tamarisco**; **Tamarix**, **Myrica** (Greek μυρίκη), **Tamariscus**; It. *tamerice*, *tamarisco*.
- *Modern accepted:* **Tamarix gallica** L. (or another *Tamarix*), family **Tamaricaceae**.
- *Common:* tamarisk; It. *tamerice*. — **Probable** (by name; the foliage is drawn rather fern-/palm-like).

COMMENTARY

Tamarisk was *the* classic remedy for the **spleen** — **cold and dry** and astringent, used for splenic obstruction and "hardness of the spleen" (drinking-cups were even turned from its wood for the splenetic to use); also for the liver, dropsy, and as an astringent wash.



f. 37r — *Botrus*

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 77 · master 0265_0076.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

botruf

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Botrus* — in English, **Jerusalem-oak**, **feathered geranium**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A small plant of **broad blue-green pointed leaves** with two **red flowers** on stalks above and a long, curving **tail-like root** below.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Conflicting traditions / possible conflation

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — curving tail-like root below; *leaves* — A small plant of broad blue-green pointed leaves with two red flowers on stalks above and a long.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Botrus**; Greek βότρυς (*botrys*, "grape-cluster"), **Chenopodium botrys**, "oak of Jerusalem/Cappadocia," **Ambrosia**.
- *Modern accepted (by name):* **Chenopodium botrys** L. (= *Dysphania botrys*), family **Amaranthaceae**. — The broad-leaved, red-flowered drawing does **not** match the aromatic, finely-divided *Botrys* — a likely **name/image mismatch**.
- *Common:* Jerusalem-oak, feathered geranium. — **Tentative** (name vs. image).

COMMENTARY

(Of *Botrys*;) an aromatic **chest-herb** for coughs, catarrh and asthma, and a sweet-smelling moth-/perfume-herb.



f. 37v — *Giranio* (Cranesbill)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 78 · master 0265_0077.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Giranio

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Giranio* — in English, **Cranesbill**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bushy, much-branched plant of rounded, lobed **geranium-like** leaves with tiny flower-tips, spreading from a thick **horizontal brown root**.

IDENTIFICATION

Tradition-name: *Herba Giralia* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 93). (*strong match.*)

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Geranio**; Greek γεράνιον (*geranion*, "crane," for the beaked fruit), **Rostrum gruis/ciconiae**, **Herba Roberti**; It. *geranio*.
- *Modern accepted:* **Geranium** sp. (e.g. *Geranium robertianum* L. or *G. molle*), family **Geraniaceae**.
- *Common:* cranesbill, herb Robert; It. *geranio*. — **Secure** (palmate leaves + pink flowers).

COMMENTARY

An **astringent vulnerary** — to staunch bleeding and heal wounds, for fluxes and "the stone"; herb Robert was a kidney- and wound-herb.



f. 38r — *Stolaria*[?] (faded notes)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 79 · master 0265_0078.tif — (master 0265_0078.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

stolaria

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Stolaria*[?] — in English, **faded notes**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A central stem of **lobed, fig/ivy-shaped leaves** with small white flowers at the top, over a large **red kidney-shaped tuber** — the swollen root the eye-catcher.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — over a large red kidney-shaped tuber; the swollen root the eye-catcher; *leaves* — A central stem of lobed; fig/ivy-shaped leaves with small white flowers at the top.

Tradition-name: *Herba Stellaria* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 5). (*strong match*.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — three-lobed (hepatica-like) leaves over a red amoeboid root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved**.

- *Old / historical:* heading too faded to read.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — trifoliate/lobed leaves with small white flowers over a large red **ornamental ("fantastic") tuber**; possibly an *Asarum* or a wood-sorrel relative.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified**.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 38v — *Mandragora Femina* (Female mandrake, with the dog) —
a second masterpiece

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 80 · master 0265_0079.tif — (master 0265_0079.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Herba mandragora femina

- 1 Herba mandragora femina nasce i[n] mo[n]ti
- 2 alpeftri, lochi i prati faxofi [...]; q[ua]n[do] la acolj, api[?] di l[?]m
- 3 al colo, et fta da [...] lpong[?]; vi et no[n] aldi lo r[u]more[?],
- 4 ne le strade e fra le spine, impero [...]; et moriresti subito, come tu oldiffi
- 5 el tempore. Quefta madra-gora, tolle la fua radice, e bona
- 6 a dar mangiar a femina [che] poteffe generar fioli; et p[er] fredegga — oflo dico p[er] colteza —
no[n]
- 7 [puol]; quefta radice alegrarebe, ouer porta-
- 8 be fiole femine, ftato vivende[?]; la creatura quando tempo haveffe la radice,
- 9 e no[n] piu. La folia e la femenchà fon bone; el fugo d[e] loro ad ogni macula de
- 10 ochio erode; et cum pano catino[?] et fuffe [...], de niga la luce d[e] l'ogio. Etiam la
- 11 fua ftatura e facta a modo d[e] femina; e chi la portaffe adoffo, havere lo
- 12 [a]more, et tute le femine che te vedeffeno; et i[n] ogni honore e gratie, et inbafi-
- 13 mandoli te farebe. Per quefta cafon, et ego dito: coluela a fegno d[e] gemini
- 14 e portala teco. El doctore la ferma: ha [...] vertude efficibile e bone;
- 15 erba miracolofa. Beneditto[?] Coniella[?] confeffo et gufto.

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 16 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); C (2 supplied words); D (8 marked [?]); 5x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Female-mandrake note. It opens with where the plant grows (in alpine places, fields and thorny/stony ground) and a gathering-warning: when you pull it up *do not hear its noise* (no[n] aldi lo romore) — *et moriresti subito, come tu oldiffi* — “you would die at once, as soon as you heard it” (the classic mandrake uprooting danger; the text says *romore*, “noise/din,” not literally “scream”). Then the virtues: the root given to a woman to eat helps her conceive children and counters cold/barrenness; the leaf and seed are good, and their juice removes every blemish of the eye and restores its sight; the root’s figure is shaped like a woman, and carried on the body it draws love — every woman who sees you would favour you. Gather it under the sign of Gemini and carry it with you; the doctor confirms it: a miraculous herb. It closes with what may be a name/signature: “Beneditto[?] Coniella[?] confeffo et gufto.”



f. 38v — *Mandragora Femina* (Female mandrake, with the dog) — a second masterpiece (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

The female mandrake as legend: a nude female figure forming the root, with leaves and round yellow fruits sprouting from her head, and a dog at the right (set to drag the root from the earth); the note fills the left and foot of the leaf.

IDENTIFICATION

- Old / historical: *Mandragora femina* (the female mandrake — pair to the "male" of f. 36r); *Circaea*, *Anthropomorphon*.
- Modern accepted: *Mandragora officinarum* L., family *Solanaceae*. — *Secure*.
- Common: (female) mandrake; It. *mandragora*.

COMMENTARY

As f. 36r — narcotic, anaesthetic, soporific and aphrodisiac. The note (below) emphasises the **fertility** use (a woman eats it to bear children — the biblical "love-apples"), the **human/female form**, the wearing of the root as an **amulet**, and calls it a "**miraculous herb**."

Editorial note (native-resolution re-read): **layout confirmed SPLIT-BY-IMAGE**: each line runs **across**, interrupted by the central mandrake figure (left fragment + right fragment = one line), NOT two independent columns. The gathering-warning is verified at master resolution: «si [che] no[n] aldi lo r[u]more ... et moriresti subito, come tu oldifi» — romore = "noise/din". Transcription and translation below confirmed.

f. 39r — *tortorelis*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 81 · master 0265_0080.tif — (master 0265_0080.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

tortorelif

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *tortorelis*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall stem of **paired oval leaves in tiers** topped by a single **red flower**, ending below in a long, curving **snake-tail root**.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — curving snake-tail root; *leaves* — A tall stem of paired oval leaves in tiers topped by a single red flower.

Tradition-name: *Herba Tortorellis* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 16). (*near-exact match.*)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — ladder-like leaflets over a forked antler/leg root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading corrupt; no secure classical equivalent.
- *Modern accepted: unresolved (tentative)* — pinnate "ladder" leaves with red flowers and a forked root; possibly a **burnet** (*Sanguisorba*) or *Pimpinella*.
- *Common:* n/a. — *Tentative / unidentified.*

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 39v — *Mandragora Maschio* (Male mandrake, with the dog)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 82 · master 0265_0081.tif — (master 0265_0081.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Herba mandragora mafchio

- 1 Herba mandragora mafchio. Sono d[e] due generatione: mafchio
- 2 e femina; e il mafchio fo[?] piu bian3o(bianco) 3(che) la femina; et
- 3 i[n] modo d[e] latuga[?] [...] tu nol op[?] [...] e no fa
- 4 la femina. A acioer [...]
- 5 [per] dolore [e] p[er] macula: pestala [...]
- 6 pomila[?] alo 3io(ogio), i 7 d[e] [luna] [...] luce [...] amore
- 7 ogni pomaimel[?] e rede[?] [...] la foia(foglia) pofta a ogni [forte ferita]
- 8 El fugo ou[er] el melle [...] ad tumori et altre[?] [...] rupe(rompe) ogni poftema d[e] pecto
- 9 [...] a credere. Sapi qn(quando) tu la [vai cavar], no la vol3er(volger) ultra, ouero [fe] desparirebe
- 10 fuo olio[?] qn tu vedi [...] 3ogil[?] dati, et no la vederesti poi; et fcolueta[?] fi no la tut[a]
- 11 e qn lai defcal3ada?, apicala il nano[?] a li piedi, et fta da longi, fi3(fi che)
- 12 no aldi el romore, et g[o]dete bene orefte[?]; et fapi 3 qn ti refu mole[?]
- 13 [...] co[n] fuo maligno [fon] 3 fubito moriresti. Afcoditi. E fapa[?] 3 molte virtut[e]
- 14 ha gra[n] medicina; 3 fe la adofo(addoffo) niuno no te po cavar [...] p[er]lo forte
- 15 ogni vol[?] homo fu3e dina3i(dinanzi); da3il[?] Anchora; fi feguro da ogni cofa fpe[...]
- 16 el dotore la ferma [...].

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 14 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); C (7 supplied words); D (17 marked [?]); 15x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"The male mandrake. There are two kinds: male and female; the male is whiter than the female, and shaped like a lettuce ... For pain and for a blemish, crush [the leaf] ... apply it to the eye ... [restores] light/sight ... and love. The leaf laid on every grave wound [heals it]; the juice or honey ... for tumours and other [swellings]; it breaks every abscess of the chest. — Know that when you go to dig it up, do not turn it, or it would vanish; ... once you have bared [the root], tie the little [man-root] by the feet [to a dog] and stand far off, so that you do not hear the noise (no aldi el romore); for with its malign sound you would die at once. Hide yourself. And know it has many virtues, great medicine: if you wear it, no one can take [anything] from you ... every man flees before you; so you are secure from everything ... the physician confirms it." (Native-res reading, ~16 lines across the figure: the male/female distinction, a practical materia medica, and the full dog-and-noise uprooting legend with an amulet of power/protection. Words [?] uncertain; the dog overlaps part of the right column.)





f. 39v — *Mandragora Maschio* (Male mandrake,
with the dog) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

The male mandrake: a **nude male figure forming the root**, leaves and **yellow fruits** rising from his head, with a **dog** at the right tethered to pull him up; dense notes flank and follow.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: **Mandragora mas** (the **male** mandrake — the pair to the female of f. 38v); cf. f. 36r.
- *Modern accepted*: **Mandragora officinarum L.**, family **Solanaceae**. — **Secure**.
- *Common*: (male) mandrake; It. *mandragora*.

COMMENTARY

As f. 36r/f. 38v (narcotic, anaesthetic, aphrodisiac); the note here is practical — the crushed leaf as a **wound-poultice**, and the juice or honey for **swellings, pain and blemishes** and the head.

Editorial note (native-resolution re-read): layout SPLIT-BY-IMAGE: each line runs across, broken by the central male figure + dog (left fragment + right fragment = one line). This recovers the opening "two kinds" passage and the full uprooting legend that the earlier fragmentary block had lost; the right column is partly obscured where the dog drawing overlaps the same-ink text — those gaps are the documented RGB limit. Words [?] uncertain.



f. 40r — *bolotelis*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 83 · master 0265_0082.tif — (master 0265_0082.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

bolotelis[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *bolotelis*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A rosette of broad blue-green pointed leaves with small red flowers on thin stalks, set over a red horizontal tuber-root — bold leaves, low habit.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — set over a red horizontal tuber-root; *leaves* — bold leaves; *habit/stem* — A rosette of broad blue-green pointed leaves with small red flowers on thin stalks.

Tradition-name: *Herba Belletollis* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 59). (strong match.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — broad leaves over a red amoeboid root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *bolotelis*[?] (so written, top-left) — an opaque vernacular name; possibly a corruption of an orchid-name (cf. the Satyrion group, f. 9r/f. 19v), but unresolved.

- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — broad leaves with yellow flowers over a large red **ornamental tuber** (a "fantastic" element); possibly an orchid.

- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.

f. 40v — *Reubarbaro* (Rhubarb)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 84 · master 0265_0083.tif (provisional — read from PDF)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Caption on the drawing (across the soil-line): *Herba Reubarbaro* (the second word is inked over the brown rootstock and is easily overlooked)

Foot-note (opening): *Herba reubarbaro turchio*

- 1 [caption on the drawing, at the soil-line] *Herba Reubarbaro*
 - 2
 - 3 *Herba reubarbaro turchio nafse i[n] farraini(Saraceni) 3(et) e quelle pu3[?] d'oref[?].*
 - 4 *La cafon p[er] 3(che) questa herba fe 3iama reubarbaro: fie 3(che) [...] p[er] il nafse*
 - 5 *fra le barbe d[e] uno alboro(albero), e p[er]ò fe 3iama reubarbar[o] [...]*
 - 6 *p[er] il nafse i[n] barbaria(Barbary) nel tereno di barbari. La ter3a(terza) cafon p[er] 3 fe 3iama*
 - 7 *reobarbaro fie p[er]ò [...] d[e] tute le altere medicine 3 d[e] herbe p[er] purgare;*
 - 8 *et questo reubarbaro, 3oe la mihor(miglior) d[e] tute le altere purgative; e p[er]ò*
 - 9 *[è] tra i molti electuari(elettuari) purgativi d[e] f[?]ciarie(fpezierie), d[e] f[?]ciali e mede3i a*
 - 10 *purgare;*
 - 11 *questo 3e af[?] el fiore d[e] ogni medicina. El doctore aprua(approva) cofe[?] e me-*
 - 12 *de3ine[?] la dipieta[?] fua; 3(et) chi la t[?]uo[?] [...] medici [...].*
- Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 18 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); C (2 supplied words); D (8 marked [?]); 5x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"Turkish rhubarb grows in Saracen lands ... The reason this herb is called *reubarbaro*: it grows among the roots of a tree, and because it grows in Barbary, in the soil of the Barbary [people] ... rhubarb [is the best] of all the other medicines and herbs for purging; this rhubarb is the best of all purgatives, and so it is set among the many purgative electuaries of the apothecaries ... it is the very flower of every medicine. The physician approves it ..." (Native-res reading: the names "Turkish," "Saracen" and "Barbary" are trade-route labels, not the plant's botanical origin — true rhubarb (Rheum) is native to Central Asia (China, Tibet) and reached Europe overland via Turkey/the Levant and by sea via North-African ports, which the scribe takes for its homeland. The note gives a folk etymology — "rha-barbaro" — from its growing among a tree's roots in Barbary. The genuine etymology is different: rha is the classical name of the Volga (Rha) river, on whose banks the plant was gathered, + Latin barbarum "foreign," hence rha barbarum = rheubarbarum.)



f. 40v — *Reubarbaro* (Rhubarb) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A diagrammatic image of the prized drug-root: several leafy sprigs and reddish leaves rise from a brown **horizontal ground-band**, beneath which hangs a row of fat yellow-gold **root-fingers** — the rhubarb rootstock displayed rather than a living plant.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **reubarbaro**; **Rha barbarum** / **Rhabarbarum** (from the river *Rha* = Volga), "Turkish" and "East-Indian" rhubarb; It. *reubarbaro*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Rheum* sp.** (***R. officinale* Baill.**, *R. palmatum* L., *R. rhabarbarum* L.), family **Polygonaceae**.
- *Common*: rhubarb; It. *reubarbaro*, *rabarbaro*. — **Secure** (named in the note).

COMMENTARY

A leading imported purgative of the medieval pharmacy — a reliable but gentle **purge of bile, the liver and stomach**, and (paradoxically) an **astringent** that binds after purging; a costly drug compounded into many electuaries.

*Editorial note (native-resolution re-read): the plant is named twice — by a caption written across the soil-line of the drawing, «Herba Reubarbaro» (its second word inked over the brown rootstock, so it half-vanishes into the paint and was missed in the first pass), and then in the full-width 9-line note at the foot whose opening words repeat the title. Refinements vs the earlier block: line 1 «nasse in Sarraini» (in Saracen lands), not "in vera mente"; line 4 «nasse in barbaria nel tereno di barbari»; the name is given **three reasons**; and the purge is set among the **electuari purgativi de spiciarie** (apothecaries' electuaries). Words [?] uncertain.*



f. 41r — *mercoris*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 85 · master 0265_0084.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

mercori[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *mercoris*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A central stem of **paired leaves** carrying **red flowers**, spreading below into a forked **red root** — upright and trim.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — spreading below into a forked red root; *leaves* — A central stem of paired leaves carrying red flowers; *habit/stem* — upright and trim.

Tradition-name: *Herba Metries* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 60) (so *not* *Mercurialis*). (plausible match.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): ovate toothed leaves, small red flowers, a red tentacle root. The name *mercoris* echoes *Mercurialis* (**mercury herb**) — a plausible name-lead; the root is emblematic. — **tentative (name-echo *Mercurialis*)**.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading corrupt; no secure equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — cordate leaves with red flowers over a red serpentine forked root.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal commentary is offered, as the plant is not securely identified; see the Identification section.

f. 42r — [i]statoris[?] (a blue face-root)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 87 · master 0265_0086.tif — (a "face-root"; Brassicaceae, with wood suggested by an unverified 2024 thesis)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

ifstatoris[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name [i]statoris[?] — in English, a **blue face-root**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Broad blue-green pointed leaves gathered upright above a pale, curling **tail-root** — a simple leaf-and-root study.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — curling tail-root; a simple leaf-and-root study; *leaves* — Broad blue-green pointed leaves gathered upright above a pale.

Tradition-name: *Herba Ystatoris* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 61). (*near-exact match.*)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — lance leaves rising from a blue human-faced mandrake root (anthropomorphic); a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading [i]statoris[?], which reads plausibly as a form of **Isatis** (woad); also *Glastum* (the classical/Celtic name for woad).

- *Modern accepted:* family **Brassicaceae**; the species ***Isatis tinctoria* L.** (woad) is **suggested but not adopted by this edition**. The *Isatis* reading was proposed in an **unpublished M.A. thesis** (B. Beasley, Univ. of Oklahoma, 2024) that the **present editors have not been able to verify**; it is recorded here as that source's proposal — consistent with the **blue-painted root** and the heading-reading (*istatoris* ~ *Isatis*) — but, like other single-strand calls, the leaf is **held at family level only**. — **Tentative.**

- *Common:* woad, dyer's woad; It. *quado*. — **Tentative** (iconography + name; identification based primarily on the drawing and the corrupt heading).

COMMENTARY

If woad (tentative): chiefly the great **blue dye-plant** of antiquity and the Middle Ages; medicinally a cooling **astringent**, the bruised leaves laid on wounds, ulcers and "hardness of the spleen." The emphasis here is iconographic — a blue, faced root keyed to woad's dye — so any medicinal reading is secondary to the identification, which remains tentative.



f. 42v — *Apios* (tuberous plant)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 88 · master 0265_0087.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Apios

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Apios* — in English, **tuberous plant**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A faint, lightly sketched plant: a small wispy outline of thin leaves and fine roots, barely painted — an unfinished or ghostly drawing.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — lightly sketched plant: a small wispy outline of thin leaves and fine roots.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *Apios* · *Ap[?]of* (re-read at master resolution; **not** "Aspera"); classical *Apios* (ἄπιος), a **tuberous purgative plant** of the herbals — variously equated with a tuberous spurge (*Euphorbia apios*) or a tuberous umbellifer (*Oenanthe / Filipendula*).

- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved** — the drawing shows a large rounded **tuber** with feathery leaves and a small umbel, matching the classical tuberous *Apios*; the precise modern species is debated. (Earlier guessed *Asparagus* from the misread heading — corrected.)

- *Common:* (classical *apios*). — **Tentative** (name now legible as *Apios*; tuber confirms the type, species debated).

COMMENTARY

(If *asparagus*;) the root a noted **diuretic "opener"** for the kidneys, "the stone" and obstructions of the liver and spleen.



f. 43r — *polovinas*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 89 · master 0265_0088.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

polovina[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *polovinas*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Archiving stems of **pinnate leaves** spring from a vivid **red, octopus-like root** whose many tendrils splay across the base — the scarlet root the focal point.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — octopus-like root whose many tendrils splay across the base; the scarlet root the focal point; *leaves* — Archiving stems of pinnate leaves spring from a vivid red.

Tradition-name: *Herba Polexinas* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 62). (strong match.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — pinnate leaves over a red octopus/tentacle root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading corrupt; if *Polipodio*, polypody fern.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — three pinnate fronds radiating from a centre over red serpentine roots; a **fern (polypody-type)** by habit.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.

f. 43v — *OFRI*[?] (display-capital heading)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 90 · master 0265_0089.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

O·F·R·I

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *OFRI*[?] — in English, **display-capital heading**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A faint, unfinished sketch of a **bulb topped by a feathery spike**, lightly outlined — barely more than a ghost on the page.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — unfinished sketch of a bulb topped by a feathery spike.

ID update (batch 2 · image re-read): the ink-outline plate shows an **arching orchid-like flower-spike over a layered bulb/tuber**. *OFRI* = *Ophrys*, the classical orchid-name (Dioscorides *ophrys*); the drawing fits an **orchid**. — **tentative-moderate (orchid / *Ophrys*)**.

unresolved (tentative) — an **uncoloured ink-outline** drawing (one of the rougher "second-campaign" sketches): a feathery flower-spike over a round, spiky/hairy bulb (cf. f. 42v).

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.

f. 44r — *angaels[?]* (faint heading)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 91 · master 0265_0090.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

angaels[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *angaels[?]* — in English, **faint heading**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A **rosette of broad pointed leaves** rising above a large, round **red tuber** ringed in grey — the bold red root dominating below.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — round red tuber ringed in grey; the bold red root dominating below; *leaves* — A rosette of broad pointed leaves rising above a large.

Tradition-name: *Herba Angalles* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 39). (*near-exact match.*)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — broad leaves over a geometric red-and-blue disc root (pairs with f.34r *angalos*); a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — a fan of broad pointed leaves over a round **red ornamental tuber** (the recurring "fantastic" tuber motif).

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 45r — *corso amoroso*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 93 · master 0265_0092.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

corfo amorofo

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *corso amoroso*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Archiving stems of **pinnate leaves** with small **blue flowers** at the tips, springing from a **red forked root** — a symmetrical, two-armed spray.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — springing from a red forked root; *leaves* — Archiving stems of pinnate leaves with small blue flowers at the tips; *habit/stem* — two-armed spray.

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — pinnate leaves and blue flowers over a red tentacle root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **corfo amorofo** (re-read; "love's course", a vernacular name — **not** *coda cavallina*); no secure classical equivalent.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — three pinnate fronds with blue flowers over a red serpentine root.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

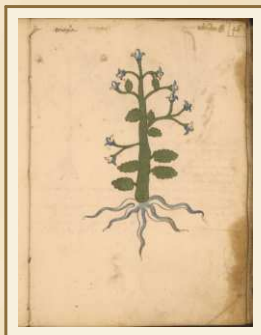
COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 46r — *Trinefza*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 95 · master 0265_0094.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Trinefza[?] (a heading is written at the top of the leaf — read *Trineza* / *Trinefza*; obscure)

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Trinefza*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall stem of **paired leaves** dotted with small **blue flowers**, over a spreading **blue-grey fibrous root**.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — over a spreading blue-grey fibrous root; *leaves* — A tall stem of paired leaves dotted with small blue flowers.

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — blue star-flowers (borage-like) over a white claw root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — pinnate leaves with **blue flowers** over a mass of spreading roots; possibly a *Jacob's-ladder* (*Polemonium*) or a vetch.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 46v — *Branca ursina* (Bear's-breech — greater & lesser)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 96 · master 0265_0095.tif — (master 0265_0095.tif)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Layout: TWO-COLUMN — two bear's-breeches side by side, *Branca mazor* (greater, left) and *Branca minor* (lesser, right), each with its own note. Line numbers restart per column.

Left column — *Branca mazor* (greater)

- 1 [...] no[?] legno et la came mette[?]
- 2 folia fufo peſta i[n] ·3· ore[?]; el[?]
- 3 fora; etiã fe uno haueffe
- 4 par[o] fracto[?], [toi] la folia [e] la rad[ice]
- 5 et peſtila, en[?]ila[?] fufo; pi[?]
- 6 fe d'oue[?] [a] magnare, fubito gua[rifce]
- 7 Naſce in moti, i[n] poſta de fole;
- 8 trovaſe i[n] la motagna d[e]
- 9 vedore[?].

Right column — *Branca minor* (lesser)

- 1 Erba braca minor è bona da dolor de
- 2 teſta, portandola ſopra la teſta; ne de
- 3 ocſi(occhi), ne de calor de ſole no li nocera
- 4 havendola i[n] capo. L'aquila, q[ua]n[do] la va i[n]
- 5 alto, la porta fe[?]o(seco) p[er] cõferuare il veder;
- 6 naſce i[n] mote alpeſtri et a[ltri] a[fa]i luogi.

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 14 expanded abbrev.); C (5 supplied words); D (9 marked [?]); 1x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Left — *Branca* (maior, greater): "... the crushed leaf ...; that is, if one had a broken bone ...; the leaf, pounded [and applied] ...; it grows in the mountains."

Right — *Branca* (minor, lesser): "The lesser bear's-breech is good for headache, worn upon the head; nor will the heat of the sun (sunstroke) harm one who keeps it on the head; ... one carries it to preserve the eyesight; it grows in the high mountains."

(Two clean readings — bear's-breech as a bone/wound-herb on the left, and a headache-and-eyesight amulet of the uplands on the right.)



f. 46v — *Branca ursina* (Bear's-breech —
greater & lesser) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Two small sketches side by side, each a little plant of **divided, palmate leaves** with star-shaped flowers, accompanied by notes.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Branca ursina** ("bear's paw/claw"); **Acanthus**, **Sphondylium**, *Spina alba*; It. *branca orsina*, *acanto*.
- *Modern accepted*: **Acanthus mollis** L. (bear's breech, Acanthaceae) and/or **Heracleum sphondylium** L. (hogweed, Apiaceae).
- *Common*: bear's breech, branca ursina; It. *branca orsina*. — **Secure** (by name; the "greater/lesser" pair).

COMMENTARY

A classic **vulnerary** ("**consound**") — the leaf for broken bones, sprains and burns; the lesser kind worn on the head for headache and against sunstroke, and carried to preserve the eyesight; an alpine plant.

f. 47r — *bifolef vel basofilef*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 97 · master 0265_0096.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

bifolef vel basofilef[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *bifolef vel basofilef*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

On a single stem, **pinnate leaves** with a row of **red bead-like berries** clustered at the base; spare and upright.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — pinnate leaves with a row of red bead-like berries clustered at the base; *habit/stem* — On a single stem; spare and upright.

Tradition-name: *Herba Bososilles* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 12). (near-exact match.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): two sprays of pinnate leaflets over a beaded/segmented rhizome. The Latin heading *bifolef* = 'two-leaved'; the beaded root is emblematic. — **emblematic / unresolved (name = 'two-leaf')**.

- *Old / historical:* if *Sigillo*, *Sigillum Salomonis* (Solomon's-seal); the beaded root also recalls *Dentaria* (coralwort).
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — pinnate fronds over a **red beaded/jointed (coral-like) root**; a coralwort (*Cardamine/Dentaria*) or Solomon's-seal type.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.

f. 48r — *iliborif* (elleborus / hellebore — by name)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 99 · master 0265_0098.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

iliborif

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *iliborif* — in English, **elleborus / hellebore** — **by name**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A simple plant of **two broad pointed leaves** flanking **two red bean-shaped pods** at the base, on a short root.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Name-led (image weak or stylized)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — on a short root; *leaves* — A simple plant of two broad pointed leaves flanking two red bean-shaped pods at the base.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *iliborif* (re-read) = **elleborus / elleboro**, i.e. **hellebore** — classical *Elleborus* (black hellebore *Helleborus*, or white hellebore *Veratrum*).
- *Modern accepted:* ***Helleborus / Veratrum*** (elleboro), **by the heading**; the stylized drawing (broad leaves) is not diagnostic. (Earlier guessed an orchid from "paired tubers" — superseded by the legible name.)
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified.**

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 49r — *corbealif*[?] (a serpent-root)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 101 · master 0265_0100.tif — (a fantastic dragon-root)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

corbealif[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *corbealif*[?] — in English, a **serpent-root**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A small **rosette** of **broad pointed leaves** with little reddish flowers and a curling **tail-root** below.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — A small rosette of broad pointed leaves with little reddish flowers and a curling tail-root below.

Tradition-name: *Herba Corporelis* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 44). (strong match.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — broad leaves over a blue serpent/dragon root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved**.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *corbealif* (re-read; also *corboalif* — obscure, **not** "corbutis"); the **serpent-form root** recalls *Serpentaria* / *Colubrina* (cf. f. 11r).
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved (tentative)** — broad leaves over a root drawn as a scaly **dragon/serpent**; another "fantastic" leaf, plausibly a *Dracunculus* / *Arum*.
- *Common:* n/a. — **Tentative / unidentified** (a highlight dragon-root).

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 50r — *bistana*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 103 · master 0265_0102.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

biftana[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *bistana*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Feathery, pinnate leaves spreading above a tangle of red snake-like roots at the foot.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): leaves — pinnate leaves spreading above a tangle of red snake-like roots at the foot.

Tradition-name: *Herba Bustania* — the standard name in the alchemical-herbal canon (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 73). (strong match.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — feathery fronds with a red serpent coiled round the stem; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — emblematic / unresolved.

unresolved (tentative) — feathery whorled leaves over a red serpentine ribbon-root (decorative); possibly a spurge/fennel type.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 51r — *zapelaria*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 105 · master 0265_0104.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

zapelaria[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *zapelaria*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A single curving stem topped by a red **mushroom- or axe-shaped flower-head**, growing from a looping, **heart-shaped root** — an unusual, almost emblematic form.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — heart-shaped root; *flower/inflor.* — A single curving stem topped by a red mushroom- or axe-shaped flower-head.

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — a single drooping flower-head on a bent stalk over a blue coiled serpent root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — a minimal sketch: a curved stem with a small terminal cluster and a coiled serpentine root.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.





f. 52r — *feudaria* / *fendaria*[?] (heading; not Gentian)

[Tentative — heading re-read; gentian ID withdrawn]



manuscript leaf img 107 · master 0265_0106.tif — (a face-root highlight)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

feudaria[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *feudaria* / *fendaria*[?] — in English, **heading; not Gentian**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tuft of **pinnate leaves** with small flowers, springing from a blue-and-yellow **diamond-shaped root-base**.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — springing from a blue-and-yellow diamond-shaped root-base; *leaves* — A tuft of pinnate leaves with small flowers.

Tradition-name: *Herba Scudaria* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 78) (confirms the “scudaria” reading). (*near-exact match*.)

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *feudaria* / *fendaria* (re-read at master resolution — **not** “Genciana”); an obscure vernacular name.
- *Modern accepted:* **unresolved** — three stems of **pinnate compound leaves** over a lozenge motif and radiating roots; pinnate leaves do **not** fit gentian, so the earlier *Gentiana* identification is **withdrawn** pending a better reading.
- *Common:* (uncertain). — **Tentative / unidentified** (name corrected from “Genciana”; the genuine gentians are at f. 15r and f. 23v).

COMMENTARY

The supreme **bitter tonic** root (as f. 15r) — a stomachic and “opener,” vermifuge and febrifuge, and a theriac ingredient.



f. 53r — *engalias*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 109 · master 0265_0108.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

engalia[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *engalias*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall thin stem of **small paired leaves** with round buds at the top and a curling **tail-root** below.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — A tall thin stem of small paired leaves with round buds at the top and a curling tail-root below.

Tradition-name: *Herba Capalias* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 57). (plausible match.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — pinnate leaves with gold berries over spreading roots; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — a plant with small flowers over a red serpentine root.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.

f. 54r — *Nasturcio* (Cress / Watercress)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 111 · master 0265_0110.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

nasturcio

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Nasturcio* — in English, **Cress / Watercress**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A stem of **paired leaves** bearing round green fruits above, set on a **wavy horizontal root** strung with small flowers.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Nasturcio**; **Nasturtium**, **Cardamum**; *Nasturtium aquaticum* (watercress), *N. hortense* (garden cress); It. *nasturzio*, *crescione*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Nasturtium officinale* W.T.Aiton** (watercress) or ***Lepidium sativum* L.** (garden cress), family **Brassicaceae**.
- *Common*: cress, watercress; It. *crescione*. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

A pungent, **hot-and-dry** salad herb — a noted **antiscorbutic** ("cleanses the blood"), **diuretic** and chest-clearer for coughs, and a scalp stimulant against hair loss.



f. 55r — *antolus*[?] (a face-root)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 113 · master 0265_0112.tif — (a face-root)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

antolus[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *antolus*[?] — in English, **a face-root**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of grey, **star-shaped (maple-like) leaves** with small white flowers, growing from a coiled, **looping root**.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — looping root; *habit/stem* — An upright stem of grey; *flower/inflor.* — star-shaped (maple-like) leaves with small white flowers.

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — purple geometric star-flowers over a blue coiled/knotted root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — another "fantastic" **face-root**: broad leaves over a blue diamond-shaped root.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.





f. 56r — *ontola lupinaria*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 115 · master 0265_0114.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

ontola lupinaria

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *ontola lupinaria*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A slender stem of **paired leaves** with **blue flowers**, rising from a blue-grey wavy **serpent-root**.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — rising from a blue-grey wavy serpent-root; *leaves* — A slender stem of paired leaves with blue flowers.

Tradition-name: *Herba Antolla lupanas* — the standard name in the alchemical-herbal canon (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 25). (strong match.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — vine-lobed leaves and yellow flowers over a blue ground-band ('lupinaria' = a wolf/lupin by-name); a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — an erect plant over a serpentine root.

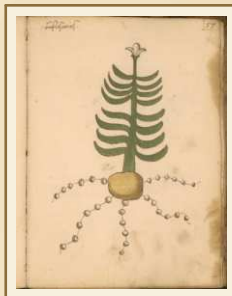
COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 57r — .euflesoviris[?].

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 117 · master 0265_0116.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

.euflesoviris[?].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name .euflesoviris[?].; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tiered, fir-tree-like plant of **whorled needle-leaves**, with a round yellow **fruit/bulb** at the base from which bead-tipped roots radiate.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — with a round yellow fruit/bulb at the base from which bead-tipped roots radiate; *leaves* — fir-tree-like plant of whorled needle-leaves.

Tradition-name: *Herba Cofflesanas* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 26). (*plausible match.*)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — a fir-tree fern-frond over a beaded radiating root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — most consistent with **dropwort**, *Filipendula vulgaris* Moench (syn. *Spiraea filipendula* L., *F. hexapetala* Gilib.; Rosaceae), the diagnostic being the **bead-like root tubers** "dropping" on string-like roots that give the plant its name.

COMMENTARY

Dropwort root was a medieval **astringent and lithontriptic** ("breaks the stone"), used for urinary gravel and for fluxes; the tubers were also eaten in scarcity.

f. 58r — *zincavolis*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 119 · master 0265_0118.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

zincavolis[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *zincavolis*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

On a single stem, **feathery leaves** with small flowers, on a **red wavy root** spreading at the foot.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — on a red wavy root spreading at the foot; *leaves* — feathery leaves with small flowers; *habit/stem* — On a single stem.

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — fern fronds with round berries over a red tentacle root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — a "fantastic" plant: curling pinnate fronds tipped with round beads over a vivid **red, tentacle-like serpentine root**. The bead-frond form recalls a fern (e.g. *Polypodium* or *Asplenium*), but the painted red octopus-root is decorative rather than diagnostic.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.

f. 59r — *tofanus*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 121 · master 0265_0120.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

tofanu[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *tofanus*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A stem of **lobed, vine-like leaves** with small **blue flowers** at the top, growing from a brown, **log-like horizontal root**.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — log-like horizontal root; *leaves* — A stem of lobed; vine-like leaves with small blue flowers at the top.

Tradition-name: *Herba Toffanas* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 28). (*near-exact match.*)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — lobed vine leaves and blue flowers over a horizontal log/ground-band; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — an erect herb with **pale blue, star-shaped flowers** in a terminal cluster and a pair of large, opposite, **lobed-and-toothed leaves**, set on a decorative mossy mound. The blue stellate flowers suggest a borage relative or a bell-flower, but the corrupt name prevents a secure call.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 59v — *vngula chaballina* (Coltsfoot) — with
note

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 122 · master 0265_0121.tif — (note block lower margin)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

vngula chaballina

- 1 $\square$ (recipe): li fiori et fave[?], aqua distilata, et aqua [la]vatorio, et la
polver di fiori
- 2 de questa herba: ongi(ungi) lo fegato et vifo[?] [...] l'altro[?]; et fe fufe
palido(pallido)
- 3 li fa tornar il colore; etiã[m] toli la radice de questa herba, et fala
- 4 bulire cū la liscia(liscia) et lavate la [testa] [...] fa li capilli longhi et
bio[ndi]

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 3 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by
enhancement — see note); C (1 supplied word); D (3 marked [?]); 2x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

A recipe (□, "take"): the **flowers** of this herb, **distilled water** and
washing-water, and the **flower-powder** — **anoint the liver and the face**
...; and **if one were pale**, it **restores the colour** (complexion). Also **take**
the root of this herb and **boil it in lye** (*liscia*), and **wash the head** with it:
it makes the **hair long and blonde**. (A double cosmetic/medicinal recipe
— a complexion remedy for pallor and a hair-wash; a few words [?].)





f. 59v — *ungula chaballina* (Coltsfoot) — with
note (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Large, rounded **heart-shaped leaves** on long stalks spread from a central crown over a horizontal root — broad, bold foliage (coltsfoot); the note runs beneath.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Ungula chaballina** (so spelt, with Venetian *ch*-; classical **Ungula caballina**, "horse-hoof," from the hoof-shaped leaf); also *Ungula cavallina*, *Farfara*, *Bechion*, *Tussilago*, *Pes pulli*/*Pes equinus*; It. *unghia cavallina*, *farfaro*, *tossilaggine*.
- *Modern accepted*: **Tussilago farfara** L., family **Asteraceae** (**Compositae**).
- *Common*: coltsfoot, coughwort; It. *farfaraccio* / *tossilaggine*. — **Secure** (by name and by the diagnostic kidney/hoof-shaped leaves).

COMMENTARY

Coltsfoot is the great classical **cough remedy** (Gr. *bēchion*, "cough-plant"; Pliny and Dioscorides smoked the leaves for cough and asthma). The MS note is unusual in giving a **cosmetic recipe** — a flower-distillate liver tonic to restore colour, and a lye-and-root **hair rinse to make the hair long and fair** — a well-attested Renaissance Italian beauty use.

Editorial note (native-resolution re-read): confirmed. Layout SPLIT-BY-IMAGE: the recipe lines wrap around the leaf-stems and root, reading across. Native res adds «ungi lo fegato et viso» — anoint the liver and face (for a pale face) — and «aqua distilata ... aqua lavatorio».



f. 60r — *branca lupina*

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 123 · master 0265_0122.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

branca lupina

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *branca lupina* — in English, **wolf's-claw**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of **lobed leaves** topped by a **pink-red flower**, rising from a round white **bulb (radish-like)** fringed with roots.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — rising from a round white bulb (radish-like) fringed with roots; *leaves* — An upright stem of lobed leaves topped by a pink-red flower.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Branca lupina** ("wolf's claw"); the medieval name was applied variously — to a buttercup (*Ranunculus*), to *Chenopodium*, and (by some herbals) as a counterpart to *branca ursina*. Companion to f. 60v *branca ursina*.
- *Modern accepted:* **uncertain** — most often glossed today as a *Ranunculus* sp. (*Ranunculaceae*); other authorities read *branca lupina* as *Lycopus* or *Chenopodium*.
- *Common:* wolf's-claw. — **Tentative** (name secure, plant disputed).

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 60v — *Branca ursina* (Bear's-claw / Acanthus)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 124 · master 0265_0123.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Branca ursina

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Branca ursina* — in English, **Bear's-claw** / **Acanthus**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A leafy plant of **divided, celery/parsley-like leaves** on an upright stem, over a single pale root.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Branca ursina** ("bear's claw," from the clawed leaf); *Acanthus*, *Acanthium*, *Melamphyllon*; It. *branca orsina*, *acanto*.
- *Modern accepted*: in the Mediterranean tradition *Acanthus mollis* L. (Acanthaceae); but the **broad, 3-5-lobed, toothed leaves** drawn here also match the northern apothecary's *branca ursina* = *Heracleum sphondylium* L. (hogweed, Apiaceae), the plant northern herbals actually sold under the name.
- *Common*: bear's-breech / acanthus, or cow-parsnip. — **Secure by name; species per the two traditions.**

COMMENTARY

Branca ursina was a chief **emollient** and "**mucilaginous**" wound herb, the leaves boiled into soothing poultices and clyster-decoctions for burns, dislocations and the bowels; *Acanthus* leaves are also the model for the Corinthian capital.



f. 61r — *follificza*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 125 · master 0265_0124.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

follificza[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *follificza*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bold fan of broad pointed leaves forming an upright cup above forked brown roots — simple and striking.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — A bold fan of broad pointed leaves forming an upright cup above forked brown roots.

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — a broad fan of veined leaves over a spreading root ('foll-' ~ leaf/foglia); a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — a basal **rosette/fan of broad pointed leaves** over thick, fanning fleshy roots; the rosette habit is consistent with a plantain (*Plantago*), a gentian, or a *Veratrum*, but the corrupt name prevents a secure call.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 62r — *Salua herba çoe sanguiforbula* (Burnet)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 127 · master 0265_0126.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Salua herba çoe sanguiforbula

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Salua herba çoe sanguiforbula* — in English, **Burnet**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bushy plant of **pinnate leaves** on branching stems with small fruits, over a **blue-grey spreading root**.

IDENTIFICATION

- Old / historical: MS gloss **sanguisorbula** (*Sanguisorba*); also *Pimpinella*, *Bipennula*, *Pampinella*, *Sorbastrella*; It. *salvastrella*, *pimpinella*, *sanguisorba*.
- Modern accepted: ***Sanguisorba minor* Scop.** (salad burnet, syn. *Poterium sanguisorba* L.) or ***Sanguisorba officinalis* L.** (great burnet), family **Rosaceae**.
- Common: burnet, salad burnet; It. *salvastrella*, *pimpinella*. — **Secure** (by the gloss and the pinnate-leaved habit).

COMMENTARY

Burnet is a classic **astringent and vulnerary** ("staunches blood," hence *sanguis-sorba*) for wounds, fluxes and excessive menstruation; the cucumber-scented young leaves were a salad and cordial herb "to make the heart merry."



f. 63r — *dagaio*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 129 · master 0265_0128.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

dagaio[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *dagaio*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A slender stem of **paired pointed leaves** with small flowers, springing from a vivid red, **octopus-like root** spreading across the base.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — octopus-like root spreading across the base; *leaves* — A slender stem of paired pointed leaves with small flowers.

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — toothed leaves and yellow flowers over a red tentacle root; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — emblematic / unresolved.

unresolved (tentative) — an erect herb with whorls of toothed lance-shaped leaves, small yellow terminal flowers, and a vivid red, tentacle-like serpentine root (the same decorative red root drawn at f. 58r).

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.

f. 64r — *feras*[?] — with note

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 131 · master 0265_0130.tif — (three text blocks: habitat note, Trinity charm, cross-reference)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

feras[?]

Layout: **THREE** same-ink text blocks, partly abraded — (A) a 9-line habitat/keeping note to the left of the plant; (B) a ~6-line charm said over the herb, below the root; (C) a short 3-line note at the lower right. Block B and block C were omitted from the earlier edition and are recovered here.

A — left of the plant (gathering & keeping):

- 1 [er]ba due folia[?], queſta naſ[ce] [fota] albari
- 2 grandi et [in] lochi ad[?] ombroſi et fereni[?] [...]
- 3 [...] tereni faldi [...]
- 4 [...] cavando queſta [...]
- 5 [...] guarda et l'erba ſia[?]
- 6 et frefca, et p[er] [...] t[em]p[o] [...]
- 7 q[ue]llo [...] ſta-
- 8 ra tuto l'an[no?][...] [...]
- 9 digillo p[ro]te[?]a [...] bever[?] [...]

B — below the root (a charm to say over the herb):

- 1 Naſce in tereni frigidì, in [m]ati[?] alti et p[er]uſi[?]
- 2 et p[er] la qual diſi queſte parole fo[bra] l'erba
- 3 *feras*[?]: «vt foras viene aut p[er] pacte[?] et [patre?]
- 4 et fiolo et ſp[irit]u ſ[an]c[t]o, li quali fono uniti i[n] trinità,
- 5 i[n] una ſuſtantia»; et guarda et l'alma ſia
- 6 fe[m]p[er] et fe[m]p[er] [...] i[n] fe[m]p[er] [...]

C — lower right (another kind / cross-reference):

- 1 Alia forte [...] et a[co?]te[?]
- 2 [fe/p]edefe[?] ut · 80 ·, fecu[n]do le
- 3 carte d[e]l libro, coſ[i] il numero.

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 28 expanded abbrev.); C (2 supplied words); D (15 marked [?]); 15x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

A — gathering & keeping: "This two-leaved herb grows under large trees, in shady, sheltered places ... on firm ground ... when digging it up ... keep it, and let the herb be fresh ... and [so kept] it will last all year ..."

B — the charm said over the herb: "[It grows] in cold ground, in high ... places; and this is why I say these words over the herb *feras*: «... come forth ... by the [Father] and the Son (*fiolo*) and the Holy Spirit (*ſp[irit]o ſanto*), who are united in Trinity, in one substance»; and keep [it], and may the soul be for ever and ever ..." — an apotropaic Trinitarian charm to be recited as the herb is gathered.

C — another kind: "Another sort ... as 80, according to the leaves of the book, thus the number." — an obscure cross-reference (perhaps to a foliation or recipe-count).

(Translation provisional — same-ink and abraded; many words are marked [?]/[...]. Blocks B (the Trinity charm) and C were not present in the earlier edition and are recovered here at the RGB legibility limit.)



f. 64r — *feras*[?] — with note (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A basal **rosette of toothed leaves** with a tall flowering stem of small flowers and a fibrous root; a small root-detail sketch and a long note share the leaf.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — a small root-detail sketch and a long note share the leaf; *leaves* — A basal rosette of toothed leaves with a tall flowering stem of small flowers and a fibrous root.

Tradition-name: *Herba Forus* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 74). (*plausible match.*)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): better-evidenced — carries a medicinal note and the **Trinitarian gathering-charm**. Finely-divided leaves fit *Ferula* (**giant fennel**), echoing the name *feras*; the serpent-headed root is emblematic. — **tentative (possibly *Ferula*; has text).**

unresolved (tentative) — an erect plant with a tall stem, **whorled/pinnate narrow leaves**, a terminal bud-flower and side flowers; a fibrous root. Identification is unresolved (corrupt name), but the **note** is unusually informative about its habitat.

COMMENTARY

The interest of this leaf is its **charm**: the gatherer is told to speak a **Trinitarian formula over the plant** ("Father, Son and Holy Spirit, united in Trinity in one substance") — a typical medieval blending of herb-gathering with prayer/apotropaic ritual, of a piece with the moon-herb and *Lucia* charm-notes elsewhere in the book. No specific cure is named.





f. 65r — *Sancta Maria* (Costmary)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 133 · master 0265_0132.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

fancta maria

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Sancta Maria* — in English, **Costmary**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A dramatic plant: a large fan of broad, **spotted pointed leaves** over a mass of curling **tentacle-roots** writhing across the foot.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading (**herba**) *Sancta Maria*; *Balsamita*, *Costus hortorum*, *Mentha Graeca*, *Salvia Romana*; It. *erba di Santa Maria*, *erba amara*, *costo*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Tanacetum balsamita* L.** (syn. *Balsamita major* Desf., *Chrysanthemum balsamita* (L.) Baill.), family **Asteraceae**.
- *Common*: costmary, alecost, balsam-herb; It. *erba di Santa Maria*. — **Secure** (by name; the standard "Santa Maria" herb).

COMMENTARY

Costmary is a warm, bitter-aromatic **digestive** and "**stomachic**", a vermifuge and emmenagogue; the fragrant leaves flavoured ale ("alecost") and were laid in Bibles as a bookmark (hence "Bible-leaf").





f. 65v — *Pulmonaria* (Lungwort)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 134 · master 0265_0133.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Pulmonaria

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Pulmonaria* — in English, **Lungwort**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A **rosette of broad, ribbed lance-shaped leaves** with spotted surfaces (plantain-like), on fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Pulmonaria**; *Pulmonaria maculosa*, *Symphytum maculatum*; It. *polmonaria*, *erba dei polmoni*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Pulmonaria officinalis* L.**, family **Boraginaceae** (the apothecary's lungwort; the name was also applied to the lichen *Lobaria pulmonaria*).
- *Common*: lungwort, Jerusalem cowslip; It. *polmonaria*. — *Secure* (by name).

COMMENTARY

By the **doctrine of signatures** the lung-shaped, lung-spotted leaves marked it as the great **pulmonary herb** — a demulcent pectoral for coughs, consumption and "ulcerated lungs," also astringent for wounds.





f. 66r — .lavdela[?]. (corrupt heading)

[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 135 · master 0265_0134.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

.lavdela[?].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name .lavdela[?]. — in English, **corrupt heading**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A stem crowned with a **candelabra of round green berries** on branching stalks, over a blue-grey spreading root.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — over a blue-grey spreading root; *habit/stem* — A stem crowned with a candelabra of round green berries on branching stalks.

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): a candelabra of round berries over a blue tentacle root — emblematic. (NB the heading reads .lavdela, a berry-plant — not 'lunaria' as some external notes claim.) — **emblematic / unresolved**.

unresolved — an umbel-like plant of whorled small leaves over a small root.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 67r — *teodorse*[?] (checkered cones)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 137 · master 0265_0136.tif — (a striking checkered-cone plate)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

teodorfe[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *teodorse*[?] — in English, **checkered cones**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A row of conical **checkered, lattice-patterned flower-heads** on upright stalks — the chequered snake's-head look — rising from a horizontal root.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — rising from a horizontal root; *habit/stem* — lattice-patterned flower-heads on upright stalks; *flower/inflor.* — the chequered snake's-head look.

Tradition-name: *Herba Tedorixe* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 33). (*strong match.*)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — **checkerboard-patterned** heart-leaves over a blue ground-band (purely fantastic); a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — five tall stalks each topped by a pointed, **green-and-yellow checkered (tessellated) conical head**, rising from a wavy painted ground. The tessellated pattern recalls the **snake's-head fritillary**, *Fritillaria meleagris* L. (Liliaceae), famous for its checkered petals — but the upright cones may equally be stylized cones/seed-heads. Tentative.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.

f. 67v — *Lucia maggiore* (the luminous herb, greater) — with note + zoomorphic figure

[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 138 · master 0265_0137.tif — (note + golden animal figure)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lucia maggiore

Layout: a ~15-line note wrapping around and below the drawn salamander, in the same ink as the figure. Re-read here with a decorrelation stretch (DStretch-style, in LAB colour) — this exaggerates the slight colour difference between the writing ink and the figure's wash, so the text that crosses the salamander separates out (the writing turns dark-red, the figure orange). That recovered the enumerated-virtue structure and several words the plain scan could not give; the hand is still fast and abbreviated, so residual gaps stay [...].

- 1 Herba [lucida] maiore nafce i[n] moti alpeftri; [3i]nventi[?] la[?] hauer[?] no[n] [p]erdoſi mantener [in] loghi
[non] humidi;
- 2 ma herba lucida p[er] ·4· rafone; [...]
- 3 Diuote[?] poſſe[?] dia[?] [...] p[er] valor[e]
- 4 la[pī] [...] p[er] ſalamandra[?] [...] omori[?] a peſte
- 5 luſe[?]; la ·2^a· p[er] veluce[r] la note [...] come ſtela
- 6 la ·3^a· ſi vede ogni folia [...] come ſtela
- 7 quelī p[er] veluceno de note [...]; p[er] illumina ogni ochio cripto[?]
- 8 di prima ipſiſtina[?] [...] p[er] b ·3·6· 3·20· a leze[r] mete[r] [...]
- 9 luce; etiā ha q[ue]ſta [vertū] et folda ogni infermitā [...] folamente peſta[r]
- 10 roſta[?] [...] et folu[er]e cō maria et vino [...]
- 11 etiā folo bolire [...]; nafce [...] la folia [...] lunarie [...]
- 12 man dure[?]; et poi tornar de q[ue]ſti i[n] nido, et bolire [...]
- 13 tene offi[?] inti i coruati[?] [...] li ſe[u]a nafudi[?] in q[ue]ſto
- 14 et frauçā[?] q[ue]ſto nido [...]; et por[r]a[?] le ·27· d[e] [...]
- 15 era prima; et q[ue]ſto zonto[?]; et fin ſe coleſe la folia freſca q[ue]ſti
- 16 alle pianeto d[e] Jupiter; et mefedula la [...] cōpo[?] [...]
- 17 recordo de tuti li o[?]ſeli[?] et dicono[?]; Anchora [...]; à veſt[er] [...] fuge[?]

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 28 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); C (4 supplied words); D (26 marked [?]); 24x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Luminous-herb lore: "The herb *lucida maiore* grows in alpine mountains; it does not keep [well] in humid places; but herb *lucida* [has virtue] in four ways (·4· *raſone*):" — then the virtues, set out as numbered items around the drawn salamander: the 2nd — [the herb / its water] shines at night like a star; the 3rd — every leaf is seen [to glow] at night, like a star; the 4th — it serves to illuminate every eye ... It has this virtue and heals every infirmity ... boil it in water ... (a recurring "nest" motif — the leaves returned to / boiled in the nest) ... gather the fresh leaf ... under the planet Jupiter ... and mix it ...; a closing line appears to record "all the birds[?] and what they say" (*oſeli[?]*, *dicono[?]*) — wholly uncertain. A long luminous-herb gathering-charm linking the night-glow to the salamander, the "nest"/birds motif, and an astrological gathering-time. (Translation provisional — ~15 same-ink lines, heavily faded/abraded; the decorrelation stretch recovered the structure and many words; the remaining gaps ([...]) would need multispectral (MSI) imaging to close.)



f. 67v — *Lucia maggiore* (the luminous herb,
greater) — with note + zoomorphic figure

(continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A fan of **pointed leaves** with small flowers and buds on stalks above, set over a yellow-orange, **grub/caterpillar-like horizontal root**; the note fills the lower left.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — grub/caterpillar-like horizontal root; *flower/inflor.* — A fan of pointed leaves with small flowers and buds on stalks above.

unresolved — a "fantastic"/magical herb. Paired with *Lucia minore* (f. 68r). The drawing shows a rosette of pointed, **red-eye-spotted leaves** with a spray of round **yellow berries/buds**, and — embedded in the text — a **golden zoomorphic figure** (a beetle/boar-like creature). The "*Lucia / Lucida*" ("the shining one") that **glows at night** belongs to the medieval lore of luminous, planet-gathered magical plants (cf. the moon-herb / *Lunaria* tradition); no secure botanical identification is possible.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.





f. 68r — *Lucia minore* (the luminous herb, lesser) —
with note + animal-root

[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 139 · master 0265_0138.tif — (note + animal-shaped root)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lucia minore

- 1 .Luca dale noue lune ouer lucia minor, la qual guariffi li o[c]3ij(occhi) maculati,
 - 2 fa3endone aqua a labioca[?]; [con]se ve la[...] 3endose guariffe. Questa erba
3oe la cura[?]
 - 3 et veda lacre[?] fa [...] et levare [...] p3[?]. Ma qn(quando) la voi avere
 - 4 pone[?] fufo m[ar]telo[?] et cavala, et no tocar [...] xp3[?] pp[?]. La fua
radife(radice) fie to-
 - 5 me pefe[?]; la fa la foia como fava grafa[?], 3(et) lufe(luce) la note. □
- Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 3 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); D (10 marked [?]); 4x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"Luca of the nine moons, or lucia minor, which heals spotted/diseased eyes: make a water from it [to bathe the eyes] ... and it heals. ... But when you want to gather it, set [a marker] and dig it up, and do not touch [it] ... Its root is like ...; its leaf is like a fat bean — and it shines at night (luse la note)." (Native-res reading: the note now yields both a medicinal use (an eye-water) and the luminous folklore that gives this and the other Lucia leaves their name — see f.67v Lucia maggiore and f.77r Lucia dale noue lune. Several words remain [?].) (Translation provisional — the underlying transcription is substantially uncertain; 10 words are marked [?].)





f. 68r — *Lucia minore* (the luminous herb, lesser) — with note + animal-root (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A stem topped by a single **yellow flower**, with **paired blue-green leaves** below and a brown **horizontal root** beside which a small animal is drawn; notes surround it.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure
Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — with paired blue-green leaves below and a brown horizontal root beside which a small animal is drawn; *habit/stem* — A stem topped by a single yellow flower.
unresolved — the "fantastic"/magical companion to *Lucia maggiore* (f. 67v). The plant has broad blue-green leaves, a single yellow flower, and a remarkable **white zoomorphic root shaped like a finned, snouted animal** (a fish/boar form, in the mandrake tradition of animate roots).

COMMENTARY

The note records **both** a use and a piece of folklore. Medicinally it is an **eye-water** to clear "spotted"/diseased eyes. The name *Lucia* ("light, luminous") is explained by the claim that **the leaf shines at night** — a luminous-plant motif that ties together the book's *Lucia* group (f.67v *Lucia maggiore*, f.68r *Lucia minore*, f.77r *Lucia dale noue lune*). The white **animal-shaped root** belongs to the same animate-root tradition as the mandrakes (f.38v-f.39v).

Editorial note (native-resolution re-read): the previously near-blank note now reads as a 6-line eye-remedy + luminous-plant note. Key recoveries: the alias «Luca dale noue lune» (Luca of the nine moons), the eye cure «la qual guarissi li occhi maculati, fazendone aqua», a gathering instruction, and — decisively — «la foia como fava grasa, et luse la note» (the leaf is like a fat bean, and it shines at night). Words [?] uncertain.





f. 69r — *Ruta salvatica* (Wild rue)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 141 · master 0265_0140.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Ruta falvaticza

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Ruta salvatica* — in English, **Wild rue**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A single **pinnate frond** of paired leaflets rising from a curved, pale **sheath-root** at the base.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Ruta salvatica* / *sylvestris* ("wild rue"); *Ruta montana*, *Harmala*; It. *ruta salvatica*.
- *Modern accepted*: the wild rue of the herbals = *Ruta montana* (L.) L. or *Ruta chalepensis* L. (Rutaceae); some authorities read *ruta sylvestris* as *Peganum harmala* L. (Nitrariaceae). Cf. the garden rue overleaf.
- *Common*: wild rue; It. *ruta salvatica*. — **Secure at genus** (*Ruta*); species per "wild" tradition.

COMMENTARY

Rue is the great **hot-and-dry "herb of grace"** — antispasmodic, emmenagogue and a famed **antidote/theriac** against poisons and plague; the wild kind was held the more drastic. Handling it can blister the skin.





f. 69v — *Ruta ongrese*[?] (Garden / "Hungarian"
rue)

[Secure — by image]



manuscript leaf img 142 · master 0265_0141.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Ruta ongrese[?] · *falva*[tica] *domesti*[ca][?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Ruta ongrese*[?] — in English, **Garden / "Hungarian" rue**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An airy, much-branched plant of **finely divided leaves** sprinkled with tiny **yellow flowers**, over fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

ID update (batch 2 · image re-read): heading "Hungarian rue." Divided lower leaves, small flowers and round green fruits also recall **figwort** (*Scrophularia*); kept as rue per the heading, with figwort noted as an alternative. — **tentative**.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Ruta ortense / ongrese** ("garden rue," possibly "Hungarian rue").
- *Modern accepted:* **Ruta graveolens L.** (common/garden rue), family **Rutaceae**.
- *Common:* garden rue, herb-of-grace; It. *ruta domestica*. — **Secure at genus;** heading reading uncertain.

COMMENTARY

Garden rue is the milder, culinary-medicinal rue — a digestive, eye-strengthenener ("clears the sight"), vermifuge and the chief ingredient of *aceto dei quattro ladri* (Four-Thieves vinegar) against plague.





f. 70r — *Spica nardo* (Spikenard)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 143 · master 0265_0142.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

ſpica nardo

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Spica nardo* — in English, **Spikenard**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

On a single stem, grey, **star-shaped (maple/ivy) leaves** on a curving yellow **horizontal root**.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Spica nardi** / **Spiconardo**; *Nardus Indica*; It. *spigonardo*, *nardo*. (The apothecary's "spica" was sometimes substituted by *Lavandula spica*.)
- *Modern accepted*: ***Nardostachys jatamansi* (D.Don) DC.** (true spikenard, Caprifoliaceae/Valerianaceae); the European substitute is ***Lavandula latifolia* Medik.** (spike lavender).
- *Common*: spikenard, nard; It. *spigonardo*. — **Secure by name** (the drawing's lobed-leaf vine diverges from life, a common name/picture mismatch).

COMMENTARY

Spikenard is the precious aromatic **nard** of Scripture — a warming **cordial**, **stomachic and nervine**, an ingredient of costly unguents and the *nardinum* oil; "the alabaster box of ointment of spikenard."





f. 70v — *Salvia filvestrif* (Wild sage)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 144 · master 0265_0143.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Salvia filvestrif

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Salvia filvestrif* — in English, **Wild sage**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Two upright stems of **pinnate leaves** with small flowers, on pale roots — a sage-like, twin-stemmed spray.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Salvia sylvestris*; *Salvia agrestis*; It. *salvia salvatica*.
- *Modern accepted*: *Salvia pratensis* L. or *Salvia nemorosa* L. (wild/meadow sage), family **Lamiaceae**; *Salvia sclarea* L. (clary) was also sold as a "wild sage."
- *Common*: wild / meadow sage; It. *salvia selvatica*. — **Secure at genus** (*Salvia*).

COMMENTARY

Sage is the "**saving**" herb (*salvia*, "to save") — a warm astringent tonic "good for the head and nerves," a gargle for the mouth and throat, and a famed longevity herb (*Cur moriatur homo cui salvia crescit in horto?*).





f. 71r — .lambrab[?]. (corrupt heading)

[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 145 · master 0265_0144.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

.lambrab[?].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name .lambrab[?]. — in English, **corrupt heading**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A stem of **paired oval leaves** with small **white flowers** at the top, on a brown, curving root.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — curving root; *leaves* — A stem of paired oval leaves with small white flowers at the top.

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — pod-like leaves and white flowers over spreading roots; a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved**.

unresolved — a toothed-leaved flowering herb with a root.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.





f. 72r — *Eufrasia* (Eyebright)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 147 · master 0265_0146.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Eufrasia

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Eufrasia* — in English, **Eyebright**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of **lobed, divided leaves** topped by a broader leaf, growing from a curving root.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Eufrasia**; *Euphrasia*, *Ocularia*, *Herba ocularis*; It. *eufrasia*, *erba degli occhi*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Euphrasia officinalis* L.** (s.l.; incl. *E. rostkoviana* Hayne), family **Orobanchaceae** (formerly *Scrophulariaceae*).
- *Common*: eyebright; It. *eufrasia*. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

Eyebright is the **eye herb** ("*Euphrasia* clears the sight"): an astringent-aromatic wash and "eye-water" for inflamed, weeping or dim eyes, and a head-and-memory tonic — Milton's herb to purge Adam's vision.





f. 73r — *rigamo* (Oregano)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 149 · master 0265_0148.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

rigamo

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *rigamo* — in English, **Oregano**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A slender stem of **paired leaves** with small **white flowers** on branching tips, over a brown curving root.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **rigamo / origano**; *Origanum*, *Cunila*; It. *origano*, *rigano*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Origanum vulgare* L.**, family **Lamiaceae**.
- *Common*: oregano, wild marjoram; It. *origano*. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

Oregano is a warm, dry **carminative and pectoral** — an infusion "comforts the stomach," eases coughs and the *mother* (uterus), and the steam was inhaled for colds; a standard kitchen-physic herb.





f. 74r — [*Herba*] *trinitas*, *çoe epatica nobilis*
(Liverleaf)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 151 · master 0265_0150.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

[*herba*] *trinitas* · *çoe epatica* · [*nobilis/Robertis*][?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name [*Herba*] *trinitas*, *çoe epatica nobilis* — in English, **Liverleaf**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

On a single stem, **broad arrow/ivy-shaped leaves** over a deep brush of fibrous roots; lightly drawn, with notes.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Herba Trinitatis** (from the three-lobed leaf) = **Hepatica nobilis** (from the liver-shaped leaf); *Trifolium hepaticum*, *Herba trinitatis*; It. *erba trinità*, *epatica*, *erba della Madonna*.
- *Modern accepted*: **Hepatica nobilis** Schreb. (syn. *Anemone hepatica* L.), family **Ranunculaceae**.
- *Common*: liverleaf, liverwort, noble hepatica; It. *erba trinità*, *epatica*. — **Secure** (the gloss names both traditions).

COMMENTARY

By the **doctrine of signatures** the liver-shaped leaf made it the chief **hepatic herb** — a mild astringent "opener" for the liver and jaundice, and a vulnerary; the trinity name gave it a Marian, devotional aura.



f. 74v — *Torza*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 152 · master 0265_0151.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Torza

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Torza*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Two very large, rounded **kidney/heart-shaped leaves** form a broad pad, with small flowers on slender stalks above and a small tuft of roots — the great round leaves dominate.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Conflicting traditions / possible conflation

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — rounded kidney/heart-shaped leaves form a broad pad; the great round leaves dominate; *habit/stem* — with small flowers on slender stalks above and a small tuft of roots.

ID update (batch 2 · image re-read): a single large **cordate, serrate leaf** with yellow flowers on separate thin stalks — a **coltsfoot-type** (*Tussilago*). The Veneto name *torza/torsa* usually means a leafy brassica (cabbage/chard), so **name and image may come from different sources**. — **tentative (coltsfoot-type)**.

unresolved (tentative) — broad, rounded (**reniform**) leaves over a bulbous root; the kidney-leaved, bulb-rooted habit suggests *asarabacca*, *Asarum europaeum* L. (Aristolochiaceae), though the name *torza* would rather point to a **cole/colewort** (*Brassica* sp.).

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 75r — *Rubichana*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 153 · master 0265_0152.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Rubichana

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Rubichana*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A **rosette of broad leaves** with arching stalks carrying round **white berries**, over fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — over fibrous roots; *habit/stem* — A rosette of broad leaves with arching stalks carrying round white berries.

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): more naturalistic — two large lanceolate leaves with round berries on stalks over a forked root. Possibly a real plant; name *Rubichana* (~'reddish?') unresolved. — **tentative / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — a fern-like, pinnately divided plant over a serpentine root.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 75v — *Regina* (x3) — with magical/astrological note

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 154 · master 0265_0153.tif — (note block; the text shows through onto f. 76r)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Regina · Regina · Regina · Herba a[va]lca[?] (arara[?]) magore

Layout: the three left/centre plants are each captioned *Regina*; the fourth plant at the right carries a separate caption read «*Herba avalca / arara[?] magore*». One running note (below) describes them.

1 Herba regina fono d[e] 3 rafone: è una minore 3erba 3(che) la vefe[?]
2 adoffo no farfia[?] mal vedato[?]. Nafce i[n] molti lochi faxofi 3 fechi(fecchi), trovas
3 i[n] [...] e poi i[n] moti(monti) alpini nafce; et è picola(piccola) erba, alta uno dito
4 da tera; et ha i fiori 3aleti(gialli). ¶ Herba avalea[?] magore, a-
5 rif 3ala: 3direto: iftiparmo: 3oragio: orto: arif 3ala: feraria; hau-
6 endola adofo, e fe la porti, fuga i ladroni dina3i(dinanzi); 3 no[n]
7 li temi[?]; 3 è figuro da ogni fuo inimico; ma i[n] prima li fai dire
8 fufo una meffa; e pigla d'luna crefcente i[n] fegno d[e] tauro,
9 et poi la tene i[n] 3endado(zendado) bia3o(bianco); et no[n] poteve cū effa i[n] peccato
10 d[e] luxuria. El fu3o(fuco) meffo cū il late(latte) [...] leva le magie,
11 fotile[?] [...] incorporat[o] cū il melle(miele). Nafce i[n] tereni e monti marini
12 e faxofi lochi; et ha lo odore bono como menta(menta) odorifera.

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 14 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); D (6 marked [?]); 3x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"Herb regina is of three kinds: there is a lesser herb ... worn on the body it does no harm[?]. It grows in many stony and dry places, found ... then it grows in the alpine mountains; it is a small herb, a finger tall from the ground, and it has yellow flowers. — Herba avalca [the greater]: [its secret names are] aris zala, zdireto, istiparmo, zoragio, orto, aris zala, feraria. Having it on you, and if you carry it, it puts thieves to flight before you; ... you do not fear them; and you are safe from every enemy — but first have a Mass said over it, and gather it at the waxing moon in the sign of Taurus, then keep it in white silk (zendado bianco); and with it one could not [commit] the sin of lust. The juice mixed with milk ... removes spells (magic); ... incorporated with honey. It grows in coastal/mountain and stony places, and it smells sweet, like fragrant mint." (Native-res reading of a dense magico-medical note. Words [?] uncertain.) (Translation provisional — the underlying transcription is substantially uncertain; 8 words are marked [?].)

f. 75v — *Regina* (x3) — with
magical/astrological note (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Three tall stems of **pinnate leaves** stand over a row of gold **roots**, with a fourth plant added at the right; the long note fills the lower half (the 'Regina' herb).

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — Three tall stems of pinnate leaves stand over a row of gold roots.

unresolved (tentative) — *herba regina* ("queen-herb") was applied to several plants (meadowsweet *Filipendula ulmaria*, "queen of the meadow," among them); the triple labelling over three flowers is unusual. The interest of the leaf is its **magical note**.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.

Editorial note (native-resolution re-read): captions confirmed *Regina · Regina · Regina* over the three small plants, plus a fourth *Herba avalca [magore]* (the dandelion-like plant at right) — so the leaf carries **two entries**. The ~12-line note now opens cleanly («sono de 3 rasoni» — "is of 3 kinds"), and the ending is recovered («incorporato cun il melle ... ha lo odore bono como menta odorifera»). Words [?] uncertain.



f. 76r — *Antola minor*[?]

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 155 · master 0265_0154.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Antola minor

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Antola minor*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A stem of **paired oval leaves** with small flowers and buds, on a brown **forked root**.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — on a brown forked root; *leaves* — A stem of paired oval leaves with small flowers and buds.

Tradition-name: *Herba Antolla minor* — the standard name in the **alchemical-herbal canon** (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 1). (near-exact match.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): emblematic tradition plant — oak-lobed leaves and small buds over a red root (pairs with the *ontola/antola* group); a fantastic/cryptonymic figure with no securely determinable species (comparative-manuscript work only). — **emblematic / unresolved.**

unresolved (tentative) — a plant over a bold **serpentine/tentacle root**; heading-only. (The faint "text" at this leaf's foot is **bleed-through from the heavy note on f. 75v**, not writing on f. 76r — a clear instance of the show-through problem.)

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 76v — *herba Origano* (Oregano)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 156 · master 0265_0155.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

herba Origano

- 1 Herba origano è caldo e feco nel ·3·o grado, ha molte virtù, coctandolui
- 2 data a bere è bona a chi aveſe preſo veneno; et al veneno [3e uno] fuſſe
- 3 morſo da ſerpe o da cane rabido; è bona p[er] fatigar il venere[?];
- 4 et oltri[?] [...], p[er] bocha. Etiam el fugo a beber è bono ale doie(doglie), cioè
- 5 raduto[?] o dabuto[?], p[er] altra caſone. Ancora è bon fuco da a bere
- 6 [a] idropici, p[er] refrigerar i foi humori e fiatrie. Et la ſua medicina, colta
- 7 a luna crefcente fia [migliore]; ·12· [...] mora; ogni
- 8 di ·15·[?] [...] [incenſar?] a ſcazar i demoni e ogni mala umbra da doſſo a li [...]
- 9 et far fanelare[?]; ſubito, ponendola adoffo cū reverentia, [che] queſta herba
- 10 aveſſe adoffo, ogni caſa no ge potrebe intrare, ne ſtrighe ne ſpi[riti?] ne
- 11 [ria umbra] [...]; et è pronto[?]

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 4 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); C (5 supplied words); D (9 marked [?]); 5x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"Herb oregano is hot and dry in the third degree and has many virtues: cooked and given to drink, it is good for one who has taken poison; and if one were bitten by a snake or a rabid dog [it is good]; it is good to stir Venus (*fatigar il venere* — as an aphrodisiac/emmenagogue) ... by mouth. Its juice, taken, is good for the pains (*doglie*) ... Also its juice is good to drink for the dropsical, to cool their humours and winds (*fiatrie*). Its medicine, gathered at the waxing moon, is best; ... Burned [as incense] it drives demons and every evil shadow off the body ...; and at once, carried on the body with reverence, [so that] whoever has this herb upon them — no [evil] can enter any house, neither witches (*strighe*) nor spirits nor evil shadow; and it is proven." (This much fuller reading — recovered by decorrelation stretch + HTR — replaces the earlier "partly-legible" note; the medicinal profile (hot/dry, antidote, snake/dog bite, dropsy) plus the moon-gathering and demon-banishing amulet match oregano's reputation. Several words remain [?].)



f. 76v — *herba Origano* (Oregano) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A lightly drawn, much-branched plant of small leaves, mostly in **outline**, with a red pod at the right and a yellow flower at the base; a long note beneath.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **herba Origano**; *Origanum*, *Cunila*; It. *origano*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Origanum vulgare* L.**, family **Lamiaceae**.
- *Common*: oregano, wild marjoram. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

As f. 73r — a warm carminative and pectoral; the doubling (two oregano plates a few leaves apart) shows the compilation drew on **more than one exemplar**.





f. 77r — *Lucida da le nocte lumina* (the
night-shining herb)

[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 157 · master 0265_0156.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lucida da le nocte lumina

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Lucida da le nocte lumina* — in English, **the night-shining herb**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A **rosette of broad pointed leaves** rising above a round, blue-grey **bulb** with spreading roots.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — blue-grey bulb with spreading roots; *leaves* — A rosette of broad pointed leaves rising above a round.

unresolved — a "fantastic"/magical luminous herb of the *Lucida* group; no secure botanical identity. A tufted plant with blue flowers over a root.

COMMENTARY

Its name encapsulates the lore — the herb that *gives light by night*; such "lucernaria" plants were sought for invisibility-, treasure- and lock-opening charms in the magical herbals.





f. 77v — *herba Bianca · overo Momoralia*[?]
(red-berried)

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 158 · master 0265_0157.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

herba Biancha overo Momoralia[?]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *herba Bianca · overo Momoralia*[?] — in English, **red-berried**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A climbing **vine** of lobed grape/ivy-like leaves with curling tendrils and hanging **red fruits/pods** — the manuscript's signature night-herb, lush and trailing.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — A climbing vine of lobed grape/ivy-like leaves with curling tendrils and hanging red fruits/pods.

ID update (batch 2 · image re-read): the heading reads *herba benedetta overo Momordica*, and the drawing is a tendrilled climber with lobed leaves and a **warty orange fruit splitting to reveal red seeds** — diagnostic of *Momordica balsamina* (balsam apple). The earlier bryony/bittersweet/herb-bennet guess is **withdrawn**. — **corrected: secure (balsam apple)**.

unresolved (tentative) — a branched leafy plant bearing **red berries** over a root; if *herba benedetta*, then herb-bennet (*Geum urbanum*), but the red berries fit a bryony/bittersweet better. **Tentative**.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 78r — *Lucida minor*

[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 159 · master 0265_0158.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lucida minor

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Lucida minor*; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of fine, **comb-like pinnate leaves** in red and green topped by a **red flower**, with a **crescent moon** drawn at the upper left and roots spreading below — a night/moon motif.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

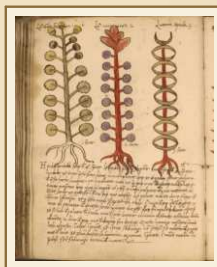
Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — with a crescent moon drawn at the upper left and roots spreading below; *leaves* — comb-like pinnate leaves in red and green topped by a red flower; *habit/stem* — An upright stem of fine.

unresolved — *Lucida* group (luminous moon-herb). A single spike over a serpentine root.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.

f. 78v — *Lucida prima* ·1· · *Lu[cia] minore* ·2· · *Lunaria tonda* ·3·
— with note
[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 160 · master 0265_0159.tif — (note block)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lucida prima ·1· · *Lu[cia] minore* ·2· · *Lunaria tonda* ·3·

Layout: **three captioned plants** in a row, numbered 1-2-3 (*Lucida prima* · *Lu[cia] minore* · *Lunaria tonda*); one running note below describes the "lunarie" group.

The running note below the three plants is a single dense block of ~10 lines (same ink, partly faded); re-segmented to the manuscript's lines (earlier it was given as two long run-on lines).

- 1 [...] lunarie, et tute q[ue]ste sono bone a **multiplicar l'oro et l'ar'gento**; fa[r] fine polvere
- 2 d[e] q[ue]ste herbe lunarie; poi la polvere meti [...] o ne zerdof[e] [...]
- 3 tanto creferan[o] [...]; aut la a[r]gento [...] q[ua]nta polvere zu ne meterai di
- 4 [...] fino i[n] fiorini[?]; et a q[ue]sto [...] la polvere ad[i]cto[?] do[r]e fa[r] [...]
- 5 una [parte] di polvere d[e] q[ue]ste herbe lunarie, çoe ·1· [...] al p[ri]mo [...] orespito[?]
- 6 et fa [...] di polvere; et q[ue]sta erba vuol [...] herbe lunarie olivina[?], diftincto, a solu[er]e [...]
- 7 [...] aut ardofe[?] [...]; Queste lunarie nascono i[n] multi
- 8 loghi alpeftri, falve, i[n] prati [...] moti [marini] [...]; et q[ue]sti fabionizi no[n] p[er]dof[?]
- 9 aut la luna[?]; et etià nase la lunaria azurina i[n] prati, q[ue]sti i[n] moti marini, no[n]
- 10 p[er]dof[?], fed fabionizi tereni di mare.

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 28 expanded abbrev.); C (2 supplied words); D (6 marked [?]); 17x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"... and all these (the moon-herbs, lunarie) are good to **multiply gold and silver**: make a fine powder of these moon-herbs, then put the powder into ... of silver ... and it will grow so much ..., up to [the value of] florins ... one [part] of the powder of these moon-herbs ... These lunarie grow on mountains, in alpine places, in woods and sandy meadows, not [in marsh]. And also the **blue lunaria** (*lunaria azzurina*) grows in meadows and in seaside mountains, on the sandy soils of the sea." — this is an **alchemical recipe**: the "lunarie" (moon-herbs) are claimed to **multiply gold and silver** (their powder added to silver makes it grow), followed by a **habitat key** distinguishing the lunarie (including a **blue** one). The reading "**multiplicar l'oro et l'argento**" (not the earlier "moltissime cose") is confirmed on the master TIFF and independently by CATMuS HTR. (Plant identity remains **Unresolved**; the note's content, however, is now legible as the medieval *lunaria*/moonwort precious-metal alchemy tradition.)



f. 78v — *Lucida prima* ·1· · *Lu[cia] minore* ·2· ·
Lunaria tonda ·3· — with note (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Three tall **red-stemmed plants** side by side, each with paired blue-purple leaves and a top strung with round **berries**, rising from bulbous roots; the note fills the lower third.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — rising from bulbous roots; *leaves* — each with paired blue-purple leaves and a top strung with round berries; *habit/stem* — Three tall red-stemmed plants side by side.

unresolved — *Lucida/Lunaria group*; pinnate, bead-flowered plants of the moonwort type.

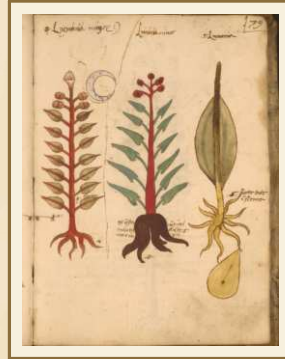
COMMENTARY

No **medicinal claim** is recorded. The note is instead **alchemical**: "lunaria" (moonwort) belonged to a well-known medieval tradition in which the moon-herbs were held to **multiply gold and silver** — their powder, added to silver, was said to make it "grow." This places f.78v with the book's other charm/operative material (cf. the Trinity charm, f.64r) rather than its *materia medica*.



f. 79r — *Lunaria maior*[?] · *Lunaria minor*

[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 161 · master 0265_0160.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lu[naria] maior[?] · *Lunaria minor* · [terza, senza nome chiaro]

Layout: *THREE captioned plants in a row, each with its own short note written beside its root (the third, right-hand plant has a pear-shaped tuber). The root-side notes are faint and largely covered by the painted roots — only fragments are legible.*

- 1 [left plant — Lu(naria) maior[?] [...]
- 2 [middle plant — *Lunaria minor*] et q[ue]sto[?] vuel[?] [...] et q[ue]st[a]
· 5 · [...]
- 3 [right plant] [...] (largely illegible — covered by the painted root)
Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 3 expanded abbrev.); D (3 marked [?]); 4x
lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Lunaria maior*[?] · *Lunaria minor*; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

f. 79r — *Lunaria maior*[?] · *Lunaria minor*

(continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Tall red-stemmed plants with paired green leaves and red berry-spikes, beside a separately drawn bulb with roots and a pear-shaped tuber at the right; notes between.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — beside a separately drawn bulb with roots and a pear-shaped tuber at the right; *leaves* — Tall red-stemmed plants with paired green leaves and red berry-spikes.

Tradition-name: *Herba Lunaria tertia* — the standard name in the alchemical-herbal canon (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 86). (strong match.)

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): the legendary alchemical *Lunaria* (greater & lesser) — a fantastic moon-plant of the alchemical tradition, drawn here with the alchemical moon symbol and paired maior/minor figures. This is **not** the real honesty/*Lunaria annua* (that is f.80v). — fantastic tradition plant (alchemical lunaria).

unresolved — *Lucida/Lunaria* group; fern-like pinnate fronds over a colored root.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.

f. 79v — *Lunaria*

[Probable — by name]



manuscript leaf img 162 · master 0265_0161.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lunaria

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Lunaria* — in English, **moonwort**, **honesty**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A single tall stem of **paired green leaves** topped by a **beaded berry-spike**, on a fibrous root.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — on a fibrous root; *leaves* — A single tall stem of paired green leaves topped by a beaded berry-spike.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading *Lunaria* (the moon-herb of the magical tradition).
- *Modern accepted (tradition):* *Botrychium lunaria* (L.) Sw. (moonwort fern, Ophioglossaceae) and/or *Lunaria annua* L. (honesty, Brassicaceae) — the two plants that carried the name; **emblematic** here.
- *Common:* moonwort, honesty; It. *lunaria*, *erba lunaria*. — **Probable** (the name is secure; the plant is drawn emblematically).

COMMENTARY

Lunaria is the supreme **magical moon-herb** — credited in the lapidary/herbal tradition with opening locks, "drawing" silver, and shining in the dark; medicinally moonwort was a vulnerary "for ruptures and wounds."



f. 80r — *Lunaria mazor* (greater moonwort)

[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 163 · master 0265_0162.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lunaria mazor

- 1 La v[er]tude questa herba: pilia, pestala, spolverizala, et dali a bere
cu[m] vino poço
- 2 e vino caldo, miza ottava p[er] volta; açò o femina che ne fuste frigida
- 3 del corpo o de tuto il corpo, et farali calida la natura et tirila[r]po[?]
- 4 Et stia questa altra forte dove trovarai questo signo et queste litere ¶ ch'd
dife[?]
- 5 et questa no è itel numero. —

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 4 expanded abbrev.); D (2 marked [?]).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"The virtue of this herb: take it, pound it, powder it, and give it to drink with weak wine and warm wine, half an eighth (of an ounce) per dose; for a man or a woman who were **cold** in the body, or in the whole body — it will make their **nature (genitals/vigour)** warm [and [?]]. And let this other kind be where you find **this sign** ¶ and these letters [which say [?]]; and this is not in the count." — a **warming aphrodisiac/fertility tonic** of the lunar herb, keyed to an astrological **sign** ¶ drawn on the leaf (5 lines, now read in full at master resolution; a few words remain [?]).





f. 80r — *Lunaria mazor* (greater moonwort)

(continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A **red-stemmed plant** with paired blue-green leaves and a red beaded top, on a bulbous root; a small moon is sketched beside it, with a note below.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — on a bulbous root; *leaves* — A red-stemmed plant with paired blue-green leaves and a red beaded top.

unresolved — *Lunaria* group; tall bead-flowered spike over a serpentine root.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 80v — *Lunaria, çoe la brifa[?]* (moonwort)

[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 164 · master 0265_0163.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lunaria · çoe la brifa[?]

- 1 Erba lunaria et sterdria[?] sono de
- 2 due rafoni; ma questa è la milior:
- 3 la foia di fopra verde e di foto pap-
- 4 paraga[?]; el botonzin[?] verde. Questa
- 5 erba apre ogni stritura[?]; et uno
- 6 tondo[?] la pafte fa[?] lo ftera[?]. Alcuni
- 7 dice effer lunaria mazor; nafce apreffo[?]
- 8 [?] et in fuia[?]. Et in molte caufe
- 9 et in molti altri modi.

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 0 expanded abbrev.); B (re-read by enhancement — see note); C (0 supplied words); D (10 marked [?]); 0x lost [...]. — Improved 04.07.2026: re-read from the master with the CONCULS decorrelation-stretch + CLAHE enhancement; the note is now nearly continuous (doubtful count 16 -> 8, no fully-lost stretch). New firm content: the leaf is "green above and pale beneath," and "this herb opens every obstruction" (apre ogni stritura).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

"The herb lunaria and sterdria[?] are of two kinds, but this is the better one: its leaf [is] green above and pale beneath; the bud[?] green. This herb opens every obstruction (stritura) ...; some say it is the greater lunaria; it grows near[?] ...; and [it serves] in many cases and many other ways." — a botanical-and-use note pairing with the greater *Lunaria* on f. 80r (~9 lines). (Much improved by enhancement — was nearly illegible; now only ~8 words remain uncertain.)



f. 80v — *Lunaria*, *çoe la brifa[?]* (moonwort)

(continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A red-stemmed plant strung with paired round green berries, accompanied at the right by a compass-rose-like diagram; notes beneath.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — A red-stemmed plant strung with paired round green berries.

Tradition-name: *Herba Bruza* — the standard name in the alchemical-herbal canon (the tradition studied by Segre Rutz, whose ~98 plants run in a fixed order; № 85). (strong match.)

ID update (batch 2 · image re-read): round, coin-like silicles paired up the stem, beside a drawn lunar/alchemical symbol — *Lunaria annua* (honesty / moonwort), as the heading names. “la brisa” is a local vernacular by-name. — secure (honesty).

unresolved — *Lunaria* group; the lesser counterpart to f. 80r.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.





f. 81r — *Martagon* (Turk's-cap lily)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 165 · master 0265_0164.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Martagon

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Martagon* — in English, **Turk's-cap lily**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A leafy stem of **paired lance-shaped leaves** rising from a brown **onion-like bulb**.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Martagon**; *Lilium silvestre*, *Hemerocallis*; It. *martagone*, *giglio salvatico*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Lilium martagon* L.**, family **Liliaceae**.
- *Common*: *martagon* / Turk's-cap lily; It. *giglio martagone*. — *Secure* (by name; whorled leaves + bulb).

COMMENTARY

The lily bulb was an **emollient and maturative** — roasted and pounded into poultices "to ripen and break" boils and swellings, and a cosmetic for the skin; *martagon* also carried alchemical-astrological associations.





f. 81v — *Galega* (Goat's-rue)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 166 · master 0265_0165.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Galega

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Galega* — in English, **Goat's-rue**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of **fern-like pinnate leaves** on a single root — feathery and symmetrical.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Galega**; *Ruta capraria*, *Herba galega*; It. *galega*, *capraggine*, *ruta caprara*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Galega officinalis* L.**, family **Fabaceae**.
- *Common*: goat's-rue, French lilac; It. *galega*. — **Secure** (by name; pinnate leaves).

COMMENTARY

Goat's-rue was a **diaphoretic** and "**pestilential**" **antidote** (sudorific in fevers and plague), a galactagogue for nursing, and a fodder said to increase milk in goats — hence the name.





f. 82r — *Eleboro nero* (Black hellebore)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 167 · master 0265_0166.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Eleboro nero

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Eleboro nero* — in English, **Black hellebore**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A plant of **palmate, five-lobed leaves** on stalks with a yellow flower, rising from a red-purple root-crown and fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Elleboro nero**; *Helleborus niger*, *Melampodium*; It. *elleboro nero*, *rosa di Natale*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Helleborus niger* L.** (and *H. viridis* in the broad sense), family **Ranunculaceae**.
- *Common*: black hellebore, Christmas rose; It. *elleboro nero*. — **Secure** (by name; palmate leaves).

COMMENTARY

Black hellebore was the classical **drastic purge for melancholy and madness** ("hellebore for the mad"), an emmenagogue and abortifacient — **violently toxic**, and dosed with great caution.



f. 82v — *Faua lupina*

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 168 · master 0265_0167.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Faua lupina

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Faua lupina*; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A slender stem of **hand-shaped (palmate) divided leaves** with small flowers, over a fibrous root.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — over a fibrous root; *leaves* — A slender stem of hand-shaped (palmate) divided leaves with small flowers.

unresolved (tentative) — *faba lupina* / *faba lupi* was applied both to the **lupin** (*Lupinus albus* L., Fabaceae, palmate leaves) and, in some herbals, to **henbane** or a **hellebore**. The drawing's **palmate, hand-like leaves** fit lupin or hellebore. **Tentative.**

COMMENTARY

If lupin: a bitter, "cleansing" seed — decocted against worms and applied for skin eruptions, the meal a face-wash; the bitterness had to be steeped out before eating.



f. 83r — *Eleboro Bianco* (White hellebore)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 169 · master 0265_0168.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Eleboro Bianco

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Eleboro Bianco* — in English, **White hellebore**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bold **rosette of broad lance-shaped leaves** springing from a thick brown **bulb/leek-base** with a long trailing root.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Elleboro bianco**; *Veratrum album*, *Helleborus albus*; It. *elleboro bianco*, *veratro*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Veratrum album* L.**, family **Melanthiaceae** (formerly **Liliaceae**).
- *Common*: white hellebore, false helleborine; It. *veratro bianco*. — **Secure** (by name; broad pleated leaves).

COMMENTARY

White hellebore was the great **errhine and emetic-purge** (sneezing-powder and violent vomit) for mania and "cold" diseases — **highly poisonous**; the root powder was also an insecticide. (A crucial point of medieval pharmacy: "white hellebore" (*Veratrum album*, **Melanthiaceae**) and "black hellebore" (*Helleborus niger*, f. 82r, **Ranunculaceae**) are **botanically unrelated plants** that share only the drug-name "hellebore" — the white acts chiefly upward as an emetic/errhine, the black downward as a purge.)



f. 83v — *Camedreos* (Wall germander)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 170 · master 0265_0169.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Camedreos

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Camedreos* — in English, **Wall germander**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Three upright stems closely set with **small paired leaves** (mint/speedwell-like), over fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Chamaedrys** ("ground-oak," from the oak-like leaf); *Trissago*, *Quercula minor*; It. *camedrio*, *querciola*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Teucrium chamaedrys* L.**, family **Lamiaceae**.
- *Common*: wall germander; It. *camedrio*. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

Germander was a warm bitter **tonic and febrifuge**, a chief ingredient of gout remedies (the "*decoctum ad podagram*") and of theriac; an "opener" for the spleen and liver.



f. 84r — *Faba grecha*

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 171 · master 0265_0170.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Faba grecha

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Faba grecha*; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bushy plant of **paired rounded leaves** on reddish stems (mint-like), over fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — over fibrous roots; *leaves* — A bushy plant of paired rounded leaves on reddish stems (mint-like).

tentative — *fabā graeca* / *fenum graecum* most often = **fenugreek**, *Trigonella foenum-graecum* L. (Fabaceae); some herbals use *fabā graeca* for a vetch (*Vicia*) or for *Smyrnium*. **Tentative.**

COMMENTARY

If fenugreek: a mucilaginous, warming **emollient and maturative** — the meal in soothing poultices, a decoction for the chest and the "mother," and a galactagogue.



f. 84v — *Pes colonbinus* (Dove's-foot crane's-bill)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 172 · master 0265_0171.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Pes colonbinus

Layout: **SPLIT-BY-IMAGE** — 4 lines read **across**, divided by the central stem (left fragment + right fragment per line).

- 1 L Questa herba a ogni [malo?] R malofo[?] pefta, [fi] macera, capr-
 2 L [per] ogni malofe: al mal R [d]e denti, el fugo cu[m] lacto tenuto i[n] boca[?]
 3 L [le]va il dolore d[e] denti R et rifchiara il vedere d[e] doctor[?]
 4 L 3 a molte 3e[?] de la verena[?] R u[n]de[?] mari et i foffi[?]

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 7 expanded abbrev.); C (2 supplied words); D (8 marked [?]).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Pes colonbinus* — in English, **Dove's-foot crane's-bill**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A branching plant of **divided leaves** dotted with red-purple **star flowers**, over a long curving brown root; a note sits at the lower left.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Pes columbinus** ("dove's-foot," from the leaf shape); *Pulmonaria geranium*, *Rostrum gruis*; lt. *piede colombino*, *geranio*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Geranium columbinum* L.** (or *G. molle*), family **Geraniaceae**.
- *Common*: dove's-foot crane's-bill; lt. *geranio colombino*. — **Secure** (by name; palmate leaf + pink flowers).

COMMENTARY

A mild **astringent vulnerary** — the herb "for ruptures and inward bruises" and to staunch bleeding and fluxes; a domestic wound-herb.

f. 85r — *Pes corvinus*

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 173 · master 0265_0172.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Pes coruinuf

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Pes corvinus* — in English, **crowfoot**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Large **palmate, hand-shaped leaves** (five-to-seven lobes) on red stalks radiating from a central crown over fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Name-led (image weak or stylized)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — hand-shaped leaves (five-to-seven lobes) on red stalks radiating from a central crown over fibrous roots; *leaves* — Large palmate.

- *Old / historical:* MS heading **Pes corvinus** ("crow's-foot"); *Ranunculus*, *Coronopus*, *Sardonias*; It. *piede corvino*, *ranuncolo*.
- *Modern accepted:* a ***Ranunculus* sp.** (crowfoot/buttercup, Ranunculaceae); some herbals read *pes corvinus* as *Coronopus* / buck's-horn plantain. **Secure at the "crowfoot" tradition.**
- *Common:* crowfoot; It. *piede di corvo*. — **Tentative** (by name).

COMMENTARY

Crowfoot/buttercup is **acrid and blistering** — used as a counter-irritant rubefacient (a "vesicatory" to raise blisters over pain) and with great caution, being caustic when fresh.



f. 85v — *Mapellus* (Monkshood / Wolfsbane)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 174 · master 0265_0173.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Mapellus (so written, *M-* for *Napellus*)

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Mapellus* — in English, **Monkshood** / **Wolfsbane**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

On a single stem, finely **divided**, parsley-like leaves with small **blue flowers** at the top, on a fibrous root.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Napellus**; *Aconitum*, *Cuculli*, *Luparia*, *Tora*; It. *napello*, *aconito*, *strozzalupo*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Aconitum napellus* L.**, family **Ranunculaceae**.
- *Common*: monkshood, wolfsbane, aconite; It. *napello*. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

Aconite is among the **deadliest of all herbs** — a violent neurotoxin; used externally in minute doses as an anodyne for neuralgia and gout, and notoriously as "wolfsbane" (a wolf-bait poison). (*The famed **arrow-poison** use belongs chiefly to the more virulent Asian aconites such as *Aconitum ferox*; European *A. napellus* is deadly enough but was the apothecary's species.*) Handled here as a herbal curiosity to be known and avoided.





f. 86r — *Scrofolaria* (Figwort)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 175 · master 0265_0174.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Scrofolaria · overo borana[?]

Layout: the name runs across the leaf — *Scrofolaria* at the left, continued «overo borana[?]» at the right; plant-name only.

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Scrofolaria* — in English, **Figwort**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A stem of **paired rounded leaves** topped by a small flower-cluster, rising from a brown rooty base.

IDENTIFICATION

- Old / historical: MS heading *Scrophularia*; *Ficaria major*, *Millemorbia*, *Castrangula*; It. *scrofolaria*, *erba delle scrofole*.
- Modern accepted: *Scrophularia nodosa* L., family *Scrophulariaceae*.
- Common: figwort, common figwort; It. *scrofolaria*. — *Secure* (by name).

COMMENTARY

By signature the knobby root marked it for the "**king's evil**" (**scrofula**) and for piles, glandular swellings and skin ulcers — a resolvent and vulnerary; "the herb of a thousand diseases" (*millemorbia*).





f. 86v — *Alchachengi* (Winter cherry)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 176 · master 0265_0175.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Alchachengi

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Alchachengi* — in English, **Winter cherry**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall leafy stem of **paired oval leaves** hung with round **red and green fruits** (nightshade-like), on a fibrous root with a horizontal runner.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Alkekengi** (Arabic *al-kākanj*); *Halicacabus*, *Vesicaria*, *Solanum halicacabum*; It. *alchechengi*, *alicacabo*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Physalis alkekengi* L.** (= *Alkekengi officinarum* Moench), family **Solanaceae**.
- *Common*: winter cherry, bladder cherry, Chinese-lantern; It. *alchechengi*. — *Secure* (by name).

COMMENTARY

The bright "bladder" berries were a noted **diuretic and lithontriptic** for gravel, stone and gout ("they drive forth gravel and provoke urine"), and cooling for fevers.





f. 87r — *Rafanus ma[ior]* (Radish / Horseradish)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 177 · master 0265_0176.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Rafanus ma[ior]

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Rafanus ma[ior]* — in English, **Radish / Horseradish**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A bold **rosette of large, toothed and lobed leaves** (dock/thistle-like) springing from a thick **red root**.

IDENTIFICATION

- Old / historical: MS heading **Raphanus major**; *Raphanus rusticanus*, *Armoracia*; It. *rafano*, *ramolaccio*, *barbaforte*.
- Modern accepted: *Armoracia rusticana* P.Gaertn. (horseradish) or *Raphanus sativus* L. (radish), family Brassicaceae.
- Common: horseradish / great radish; It. *rafano*, *barbaforte*. — **Secure at the radish tradition.**

COMMENTARY

A pungent, **hot-and-dry** antiscorbutic and stimulant — "cuts gross humours," provokes urine and appetite, clears the chest; the grated root a rubefacient plaster for sciatica.





f. 87v — *Ipoquistidos* (*Hypocistis*)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 178 · master 0265_0177.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Ipoquistidof

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Ipoquistidos* — in English, **Hypocistis**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Clusters of upright, scaly **purple-brown spikes** without true leaves (broomrape-like), rising from a small rooty base.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Hypocistis** ("[that grows] under the *Cistus*"; *Hypoquistidos*, *Orobethron*).
- *Modern accepted*: ***Cytinus hypocistis* (L.) L.**, family **Cytinaceae** — a **parasite on the roots of *Cistus*** (rock-rose).
- *Common*: hypocistis; It. *ipocisto*. — **Secure** (by name; the parasitic habit).

COMMENTARY

The expressed juice (*succus hypocistidis*) was a powerful **astringent** in the ancient pharmacy — thickened and dried, used against fluxes, haemorrhages and dysentery, and an ingredient of theriac.





f. 88r — *Aristologia longa · rotunda* (Long & round birthwort)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 179 · master 0265_0178.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Aristologia longa · Aristologia rotunda[?]

Layout: TWO-COLUMN — two birthworts side by side, *Aristologia longa* (left) and *Aristologia rotunda*[?] (right), each with its own note beside its plant. Line numbers restart per column.

Left column — *Aristologia longa*

(Re-read with decorrelation stretch — earlier the lines were mis-ordered; the manuscript sequence is restored here, ~9 lines.)

- 1 Erba aristologia longa. Al mal del cataro
- 2 o tose, la radice cota foto la brafà,
- 3 inpinta[?] co[n] il fale e olio, [e] di fubito libera.
- 4 El fugo d[e] la femenza, [maturo?], dato a bere
- 5 mefedado co[n] vino, lava il mebro dove fuffe il pizego[?];
- 6 -io- distila fugo d[e]lle foie, mefo al [mezo?][...]
- 7 [contra] i demonij, portandola adoffo [...] no ti nocerà;
- 8 ha molte virtù; nafce i tereni inginguy[?] e fabionizi;
- 9 Anchora, [per chi è] paralitico, ufa la radice [...] le vue[?].

Right column — *Aristologia rotunda*[?]

(The two columns are divided by a thin drawn line; the right note — ~14 lines, wrapping round the round root — is recovered here, partly abraded.)

- 1 Erba aristologia rotunda[?]: la radife [p]olverizata, cò il pepe[?]
- 2 [e] cò il mele, guarife da la paralitifa[?],
- 3 ufandola p[er] [tem]po di adgenos[?]. Brufa[?]
- 4 la foia, et [con] el fumo còza[?]
- 5 i demonij da doffo, e libera. Ancora,
- 6 ufandola[?], no li fià nofo[?] ferpe;
- 7 e portadola adoffo, no ti morde ferpe.
- 8 Ha molte [virtù]; nafce i[n] tereni
- 9 domefifi et altri, et i[n] fi[li]i[?] et
- 10 foffi fabionizi; toliela d[e] zugno(giugno).
- 11 [...] fubito libera; fana la gratadura[?]
- 12 [per chi] fe lo fpi[?]e[?], fubito et leva lo ardore;
- 13 [tereni fa]bionizi et teneri; trovafe d[e] mazo(maggio) fin[a]
- 14 [per] chi è paralitico, ufa la radice cù [...]

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 13 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); C (B supplied words); D (17 marked [?]); 5x lost [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

Left column — *Aristologia longa*: "Herb long-birthwort — of many virtues; it grows in sandy, soft soils. For cough/catarrh, the root roasted under the embers with salt and oil frees [the patient] at once. The seed-juice, mixed with wine, washes the [affected] member; distil the juice of the leaves ... to soothe the burning. Carried on the body it guards against demons — 'it will not harm you'; and for the paralytic, use the root ..." — a composite medicinal-and-apatropaic note wrapping round the plant.

Right column — *Aristologia rotunda*[?]: "[Round birthwort]: the root, powdered, with pepper and honey, cures the palsy ...; burn the leaf, and with the smoke it drives off demons from the body and frees [the sufferer]. Also, carrying it, no snake will harm or bite you. It has many virtues; it grows in cultivated and other ground, and in woods and sandy ditches; gather it in June ... it frees at once and soothes the burning; found from May ...; for the paralytic, use the root ..." — the round-birthwort note, now recovered, rehearsing the same virtues as the left column (abraded; several words [?]).

(Translation provisional — same-ink and abraded; ~10 words in the left note are marked [?]; the right note is essentially unrecoverable in RGB.)





f. 88r — *Aristologia longa* · *rotonda* (Long & round birthwort) (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Two plants share the leaf: at left **broad heart-shaped leaves** on a long curving root ending in a round **tuber**, at right a stem of rounded leaves — with a dense note between (birthwort-like).

IDENTIFICATION

- Old / historical: MS heading *Aristolochia longa*; *Aristologia*, *Malum terrae*; It. *aristolochia lunga*, *strallogia*.
- Modern accepted: *Aristolochia longa* L., family *Aristolochiaceae*.
- Common: long birthwort; It. *aristolochia lunga*. — **Secure** (by name; companion to round birthwort in the tradition).

COMMENTARY

Birthwort is the classic **emmenagogue** and "birth-helper" (*aristolochia*, "best for childbirth") — to expel the afterbirth and "dead child," and a wound-cleanser; **toxic** (now known nephrotoxic) and used with care.





f. 88v — *Oculus bovis* (Ox-eye daisy)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 180 · master 0265_0179.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

oculus bovis

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Oculus bovis* — in English, **Ox-eye daisy**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A clump of upright stems set with **small paired leaves** and tiny flowers, over fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Oculus bovis** ("ox-eye"); *Bupthalmum*, *Consolida media*; It. *occhio di bue*, *margherita*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Leucanthemum vulgare* Lam.** (ox-eye daisy; syn. *Chrysanthemum leucanthemum* L.), family **Asteraceae**.
- *Common*: ox-eye daisy, marguerite; It. *occhio di bue*. — *Secure* (by name; the radial daisy flowers as drawn).

COMMENTARY

A mild astringent **wound- and chest-herb** — an infusion for coughs and "for the eyes," the flowers a vulnerary; a cheerful meadow simple.





f. 89r — *Lentisco* (Mastic tree)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 181 · master 0265_0180.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lentisco

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Lentisco* — in English, **Mastic tree**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Arching **pinnate-leaved stems** with a golden **serpent/dragon root** drawn at the upper left, over fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Lentiscus**; *Schinus*, *Mastiche*; It. *lentisco*, *mastice*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Pistacia lentiscus* L.**, family **Anacardiaceae**.
- *Common*: mastic tree, lentisk; It. *lentisco*. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

Mastic (the resin) is a warm aromatic **astringent** — chewed to sweeten the breath and firm the gums, taken for the stomach and fluxes, and a binder in pills and varnishes.



f. 89v — *Vnbilici veneris* (Navelwort)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 182 · master 0265_0181.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Vnbilici veneris

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Vnbilici veneris* — in English, **Navelwort**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A sprawling plant of rounded, **lobed ivy/mallow-like leaves** on thin trailing stems, spreading wide across the page.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Umbilicus Veneris**; *Cotyledon, Acetabulum, Scatum-coeli*; It. *ombelico di Venere, scodellina*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Umbilicus rupestris* (Salisb.) Dandy** (syn. *Cotyledon umbilicus-veneris* L.), family **Crassulaceae**.
- *Common*: navelwort, wall pennywort; It. *ombelico di Venere*. — **Secure** (by name; the round, navelled succulent leaf).

COMMENTARY

A cooling, moist **refrigerant and emollient** — the juicy leaves laid on inflammations, burns, piles and "hot" swellings, and a diuretic for the stone.



f. 90r — *Morsus diaboli* (Devil's-bit)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 183 · master 0265_0182.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Morsus diaboli

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Morsus diaboli* — in English, **Devil's-bit**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A plant of finely **divided leaves** with a single nodding **blue bell-flower** atop a tall stalk, over a taproot.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Morsus diaboli** (the root looks "bitten off"); *Succisa*, *Praemorsa*; It. *morso del diavolo*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Succisa pratensis* Moench** (syn. *Scabiosa succisa* L.), family **Caprifoliaceae** (Dipsacoideae).
- *Common*: devil's-bit scabious; It. *morso del diavolo*, *succisa*. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

A diaphoretic, "pestilential" and **detergent** herb — for plague-fevers, coughs, internal bruises and skin scabies; the legend held the Devil bit the root short in envy of its virtues.





f. 90v — *Cucumeri asenini* (Squirting cucumber)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 184 · master 0265_0183.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Cucumeri asenini

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Cucumeri asenini* — in English, **Squirting cucumber**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A plant of **lobed, cucumber-vine leaves** bearing **spiny oval fruits** (little gourds), over fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Cucumis asininus* / *agrestis*; *Elaterium*; It. *cocomero asinino*, *sputaveleno*.
- *Modern accepted*: *Ecballium elaterium* (L.) A.Rich., family **Cucurbitaceae**.
- *Common*: squirting / wild cucumber; It. *cocomero asinino*. — *Secure* (by name).

COMMENTARY

The dried fruit-juice (*elaterium*) is a **drastic hydragogue purge** — among the most violent in the materia medica, used in minute doses for dropsy; **toxic**.





f. 91r — *Scorpionaria*

[Tentative]



manuscript leaf img 185 · master 0265_0184.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Scorpionaria

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Scorpionaria*; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall stem of **paired pointed leaves** rising from a brown rooty base — upright and plain.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *leaves* — A tall stem of paired pointed leaves rising from a brown rooty base; *habit/stem* — upright and plain.

tentative — *scorpionaria* / *scorpioides* named plants used against scorpion- and snake-bite or with a coiled "scorpion-tail": most often *Scorzonera* (viper's-grass) or *Doronicum pardalianches* (leopard's-bane), sometimes *Heliotropium*. Tentative.

COMMENTARY

As an alexipharmic "scorpion-herb," it was a reputed **antidote to venomous bites and stings** and a cordial against poison — the *scorzonera* root also a sudorific in fevers.



f. 91v — *Brionia* (Bryony) — with note

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 186 · master 0265_0185.tif — (note wrapping the root)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Brionia · *Galldana*[?] · vite *falvatica* · *zolutina*[?]

The foot-note is ~7 same-ink lines, partly overlapped by the painted root (the documented RGB limit). Re-read here with the CONCUS decorrelation-stretch plus an orange-suppression pass (subtracting the root's LAB b/a signal), which lifts the writing off the bare parchment and off the leaf-tips; the words that fall directly under the dense orange taproot still cannot be separated (they need MSI).

- 1 Erba *Brionia*[?], a molti nomi: fa una bevera^{3a}[?] [...] et tuto de[po]-
- 2 come e[t] fa boier(bollire) che cale il ter^{3o}(terzo); a la mità poi [...]
- 3 [il tuto] cū lo ung[u]to(unguento) e[t] guarir(guarire); e fe uol [...]
- 4 [?] la fo^{3a}(foglia) gionta [...] li [...]
- 5 del fūgo(sugo) [...]
- 6 la radife(radice) [...] fara andar be[n] d[e]l corpo, zunto[?] [...]
- 7 qualità d[e] la proua[?]. —

Evidence grade (A-D): **A** (direct, incl. 7 expanded abbrev.); **B** (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); **C** (1 supplied word); **D** (5 marked [?]); 8x lost [...]. — Improved 04.07.2026: decorrelation + orange-suppression firmed "*fa boier che cale il terzo*"; *a la mità*" ("boil till it reduces to a third; then at the half...") and "*la radice ... fara andar ben del corpo*" ("the root makes [matter] pass well out of the body"); the words under the taproot stay [...].

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

A bryony medicinal note: the **root purges** ("makes [matter] go out of the body"); boil [it] down until it falls to a **third**, then [take] half ... work it **with the ointment**, and it **heals** ...; it ends with an **eye-reference** and a note on the **quality of the trial** (*qualità de la proua*). (Only partly legible — the bryony vine and root are drawn over the note in the same ink, the documented same-ink overlap limit; uncertain words marked [?].) (Translation provisional — the underlying transcription is substantially uncertain; 8 words are marked [?].)



f. 91v — *Brionia* (Bryony) — with note (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A sprawling **vine** of lobed grape/maple-like leaves with curling tendrils, springing from a large pair of brown **forked tap-roots**; the note runs beneath (bryony).

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Bryonia**; *Vitis alba*, *Vitis nigra*, *Cucurbita agrestis*; It. *brionia*, *vite bianca*, *zucca salvatica*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Bryonia dioica* Jacq.** (white bryony; or *B. alba* L.), family **Cucurbitaceae**.
- *Common*: (white) bryony, wild vine; It. *brionia*. — **Secure** (by name; the tendrilled climbing vine). Cf. the **black bryony** (*Tamus*) at f. 13v.

COMMENTARY

Bryony root is a **drastic purgative and emetic**, an emmenagogue and an external resolvent for bruises and "the stone"; **toxic**, and (like mandrake) its big root was carved into amulets.

Editorial note (native-resolution re-read): the heading is an alias-string, not a single word: «Brionia □ Galldana[?] · vite salvatica(wild vine) · zolotina[?]». The foot-note is heavily overlapped by the root and leaves drawn in the same ink — the documented RGB limit — so the body stays only partly recoverable and honestly marked [?]. Recovered sense: a decoction reduced to a third, worked into an ointment that heals, with the root that "makes [matter] go out of the body" (purges) and an eye-reference.





f. 92r — *Cauda equina* (Horsetail)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 187 · master 0265_0186.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Cauda equina

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Cauda equina* — in English, **Horsetail**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall **horsetail-like plant**: a straight stem carrying tiers of fine **whorled needle-leaves**, on a thin root.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Cauda equina* / *Equisetum*; *Hippuris*, *Asprella*; It. *coda cavallina*, *equiseto*, *asprella*.
- *Modern accepted*: *Equisetum arvense* L. (and allies), family *Equisetaceae*.
- *Common*: horsetail, mare's-tail, scouring-rush; It. *coda cavallina*. — *Secure* (by name; whorled-branch habit).

COMMENTARY

A silica-rich **astringent and styptic** — to staunch bleeding and the "whites," consolidate wounds and ruptures, and a diuretic; the gritty stems scoured pewter ("scouring-rush").





f. 92v — *Oleandro* (Oleander)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 188 · master 0265_0187.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Oleandro

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Oleandro* — in English, **Oleander**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tall stem of **palmate leaves** topped by clusters of **pink flowers**, over a fibrous root.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Oleandro**; *Nerium*, *Rhododendron*, *Rhododaphne*; It. *oleandro*, *leandro*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Nerium oleander* L.**, family **Apocynaceae**.
- *Common*: oleander, rose-bay; It. *oleandro*. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

Oleander is **violently poisonous** (a cardiac glycoside) to man and beast; used only externally and warily — a parasiticide wash for scab and mange — and known chiefly as a deadly ornamental to be recognised and shunned.





f. 93r — *Consolida media* (Bugle)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 189 · master 0265_0188.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Consolida media

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Consolida media* — in English, **Bugle**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A clump of upright stems with **paired oval leaves** and small flower-spikes (marjoram/mint-like), over fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Consolida media*; *Bugula*, *Consolida minor*; *It. consolida media*, *bugola*.
- *Modern accepted*: *Ajuga reptans* L. (bugle), family **Lamiaceae** (the "middle" of the three consolidas: *major* = comfrey, *media* = bugle, *minor* = daisy/self-heal).
- *Common*: bugle; *It. bugola*, *consolida mezzana*. — **Secure at the tradition** (by name).

COMMENTARY

A noted **vulnerary** and "**consouder**" — bugle "wound-drink" and salves to knit wounds, stop internal bleeding and bruises; "*he that hath bugle and sanicle will scarcely need a surgeon.*"





f. 93v — *Serpentaria ma[ior]* (Dragon arum)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 190 · master 0265_0189.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Serpentaria major

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Serpentaria ma[ior]* — in English, **Dragon arum**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A **rosette of broad, spotted lance-shaped leaves** with a tall reddish **flower-spike**, over fibrous roots.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading *Serpentaria major* / *Dracontea*; *Dracunculus*, *Colubrina*; It. *serpentaria*, *dragontea*, *erba serpe*.
- *Modern accepted*: *Dracunculus vulgaris* Schott (syn. *Arum dracunculus* L.), family *Araceae*.
- *Common*: dragon arum, snakeroot; It. *dragontea*. — **Secure** (by name; spotted stem + spadix).

COMMENTARY

A hot, acrid **expectorant and resolvent** for the chest and "cold" tumours, and (by signature of the snake-stem) an alexipharmic against bites; the acrid root was tamed by cooking.



f. 94r — *Cartifilago*[?]

[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 191 · master 0265_0190.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Cartifilago

Layout: **SPLIT-BY-IMAGE** — the note runs in **two lines** across the foot of the leaf, divided by the plant stem (left fragment + right fragment per line).

- 1 L H[erb]a cartifilago fana le piaghe; et metenu[?] R ... ful vafo[?]; [quando è] in
fior, fardene polver[e] ...
2 L ... la [terra] ... R ... fabion[i] la fa faldar[?] ...

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 3 expanded abbrev.); C (2 supplied words); D (3 marked [?]).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Cartifilago*[?]; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A **spiny thistle**: an upright stem with prickly lobed leaves and yellow **thistle-heads**, on a root; a note beneath.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — on a root; *leaves* — A spiny thistle: an upright stem with prickly lobed leaves and yellow thistle-heads.

ID update (batch 4 · image re-read): naturalistic **thistle** — spiny stem and leaves with yellow flower-heads = a **safflower/thistle** (*Carthamus* / *Carduus* / *Carlina*); the name *Cartifilago* echoes *cardo*/*Carthamus*. — **tentative-moderate (a thistle)**.

unresolved — a tall slender plant with yellow flowers over a root.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.



f. 94v — *Bislingua* (Horse-tongue)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 192 · master 0265_0191.tif — (with small animal figures)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Bislingua

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Bislingua* — in English, **Horse-tongue**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

An upright stem of **paired pointed leaves** strung with small **red berries**, on a brown **horizontal log-root** with finger-roots.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading ***Bislingua* / *Hippoglossum*** ("horse-tongue," from the little tongue-like leaflet on each "leaf"); *Uvularia*, *Bonifacia*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Ruscus hypoglossum* L.** (horse-tongue lily), family **Asparagaceae**; sometimes glossed *Danae racemosa*.
- *Common*: horse-tongue, double-tongue; It. *bislingua*. — **Secure at the tradition** (by name).

COMMENTARY

Bislingua was an aperient and **throat herb** (*uvularia*, for the uvula and hoarseness) and an emmenagogue, the root in "opening" decoctions.





f. 95r — *Philipendula* (Dropwort)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 193 · master 0265_0192.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Philipendula

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Philipendula* — in English, **Dropwort**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A fern-like plant of **much-divided pinnate fronds** with a row of round **bead-tubers** strung along the root (polypody).

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Filipendula** (from the root-tubers hanging on thread-roots); *Saxifraga rubra*, *Oenanthe*; It. *filipendola*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Filipendula vulgaris* Moench** (syn. *Spiraea filipendula* L.), family **Rosaceae**.
- *Common*: dropwort; It. *filipendola*. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

Dropwort root was an **astringent lithontriptic** for urinary gravel and "the stone," and for fluxes; the tubers eaten in scarcity.



f. 95v — *Erba dentaria* (Toothwort)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 194 · master 0265_0193.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Erba dentaria

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Erba dentaria* — in English, **Toothwort**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A slender stem of **pinnate leaves** (paired leaflets) over a brown **forked root** drawn like two legs.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Dentaria** (from the tooth-like root-scales); *Squamaria*, *Anblatum*; It. *dentaria*, *erba dei denti*.
- *Modern accepted*: *Lathraea squamaria* L. (toothwort, a root-parasite, Orobanchaceae) or *Cardamine* (*Dentaria*) spp. (coralroot, Brassicaceae) — both carried the name.
- *Common*: toothwort; It. *dentaria*. — **Secure at the tradition** (by name).

COMMENTARY

By signature of the toothy root it was a **remedy "for the teeth"** and gums, and an astringent for fluxes and (the parasitic kind) "for the falling sickness."



f. 96r — *Polipodio* (Polypody)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 195 · master 0265_0194.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Polipodio

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Polipodio* — in English, **Polypody**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A true fern: **pinnate fronds** rising in a row from a horizontal, scaly **rhizome** (polypody).

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Polypodium** ("many-foot," from the knobbly rhizome); *Filicula*, *Pulpoda*; It. *polipodio*, *felce dolce*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Polypodium vulgare* L.**, family **Polypodiaceae**.
- *Common*: polypody, wall-fern; It. *polipodio*. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

The sweet rhizome is a gentle **purge for melancholy and phlegm**, a pectoral for the chest and a decoction for "the spleen" — milder than the hellebores.





f. 96v — *Scolopendria* (Hart's-tongue fern)

[Secure — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 196 · master 0265_0195.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

***Scolopendria* (*Scolopendrium*)**

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Scolopendria* — in English, **Hart's-tongue fern**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A clump of long, **undivided strap-shaped fronds** (hart's-tongue fern) rising from a fibrous root-crown — simple ribbon leaves.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading ***Scolopendria* / *Lingua cervina*** ("hart's-tongue"); *Phyllitis*; It. *scolopendria*, *lingua cervina*, *erba milza*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Asplenium scolopendrium* L.** (syn. *Phyllitis scolopendrium* (L.) Newman), family **Aspleniaceae**.
- *Common*: hart's-tongue fern; It. *lingua cervina*. — **Secure** (by name; strap-shaped fronds).

COMMENTARY

Hart's-tongue was the chief **spleen herb** (*erba milza*) — a decoction "for the hardness and stopping of the spleen," and an astringent for fluxes and the liver.





f. 97r — *Lucida*

[Unresolved]



manuscript leaf img 197 · master 0265_0196.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Lucida · Lucida

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Lucida*; no prose note is written on it to translate. See Identification for its English name.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A tuft of narrow, **grass/leek-like leaves** with a single bud, springing from a small **bulb** with roots.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Partial agreement (name and image loosely consistent)

Morphology (structured, from the drawing): *root/underground* — springing from a small bulb with roots; *leaves* — grass/leek-like leaves with a single bud; *habit/stem* — A tuft of narrow.

unresolved — *Lucida* group (luminous magical herb); the heading is written twice across the leaf; narrow leaves over a bulb-root. The luminous moon-herb theme returns to close the book (cf. the Lucia cluster at f.67v, f.68r, f.77r).

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded.





f. 97v — *Luzida* (left) + *Erba pelaria* (depilatory "hair-herb", right) — TWO plants, with note

[Secure — by name + note (the noted plant, *Erba pelaria*); the paired *Luzida* is *Unresolved*]



manuscript leaf img 198 · master 0265_0197.tif — (note at right of the stalk)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Luzida* · *Erba pelaria

- 1 Erba pelaria, questa 3e[?] [vertu]: pilia(piglia) et pestila
- 2 et spolverizala, et fabie[?] for3a et deftruge[?]
- 3 et metila cū questa polvere — o 3o[?] o fe-
- 4 3(fe) uolese pelar(pelare) barba o altra pelar[a]
- 5 et la p[er]fona metafe questa onzione(unzione)
- 6 i[n] fina a[d] 24[?] matine, 3 no(che non) li romagnera(rimarrà)
- 7 pelo. —

Evidence grade (A-D): A (direct, incl. 4 expanded abbrev.); B (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); C (1 supplied word); D (5 marked [?]).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Luzida* — in English, **left**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.





f. 97v — *Luzida* (left) + *Erba pelaria* (depilatory
"hair-herb", right) — TWO plants, with note

(continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

Two plants share the leaf — at left a grassy plant with a **yellow flower**, at right a fan of fine root-hairs (the depilatory 'Erba pelaria' beside *Luzida*) — with a note below.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Luzida* (left): **unresolved** — a *Lucia/Luzida*-group name; an erect lily-like stalk with a terminal flower.
- *Erba pelaria* (right): a **depilatory herb** named for its use (*pelare* = "to remove hair"); the bulb-and-strap-leaf drawing suggests a bulbous plant. Catalogue no. "3".

COMMENTARY

A **cosmetic/depilatory** recipe — the powdered "hair-herb" worked into an ointment to remove the beard or unwanted hair, applied over several mornings. A genuine **cosmetic claim** (correcting the earlier "no claim recorded"); depilatory herb-pastes are well attested in Renaissance Italian receipt-books. (Cf. the coltsfoot hair-rinse at f.59v.)





f. 98r — *Centaurea mediana* (Centaury)

[Secure — by name (at the tradition)]



manuscript leaf img 199 · master 0265_0198.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Centaurea mediana · *Centaurea media*

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Centaurea mediana* — in English, **Centaury**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A low, spreading plant of rounded, **scallop-edged leaves** (ground-ivy fashion) over a thick pale **taproot**.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Centaurea** (minor/media); *Fel terrae*, *Centaurium minus*; It. *centaurea minore*, *biondella*, *cacciafebbre*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Centaurium erythraea* Rafn** (common centaury, Gentianaceae) for *centaurea minor*; *Centaurea* (Asteraceae) for the major.
- *Common*: (lesser) centaury; It. *centaurea minore*, *biondella*. — **Secure at the tradition** (by name).

COMMENTARY

Lesser centaury is the classic intensely **bitter tonic and febrifuge** (*fel terrae*, "gall of the earth") — a stomachic "fever-chaser," vermifuge and wound-wash; the herb of Chiron the Centaur.





f. 98v — *Agrimonia* (Agrimony)

[Secure — by name]



manuscript leaf img 200 · master 0265_0199.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Agrimonia

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Agrimonia* — in English, **Agrimony**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A small branching plant of **rounded leaves** with tiny flowers, on a fibrous root.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Agrimonia**; *Eupatorium*, *Hepatoria*, *Ferraria*; It. *agrimonia*, *erba di San Guglielmo*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Agrimonia eupatoria* L.**, family **Rosaceae**.
- *Common*: agrimony, church-steeple; It. *agrimonia*. — **Secure** (by name).

COMMENTARY

Agrimony is a mild astringent **liver- and wound-herb** (*hepatoria*) — agrimony-wine and "arquebusade water" for wounds, jaundice and fluxes, and a gargle for the throat.





f. 99r — *Ermodatilus* · *Ermodatilo* (*Hermodactyl* /
Autumn crocus)

[Secure — by name + image (at the tradition)]



manuscript leaf img 201 · master 0265_0200.tif

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Ermodatilus · *Ermodatilo* (*Hermodactylus*)

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The leaf carries only the plant-name *Ermodatilus* · *Ermodatilo* — in English, **Hermodactyl** / **Autumn crocus**. No prose note is written on this leaf to translate; the full English naming is under Identification.

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

A clump of **strap-like leaves** carrying several **red-pink lily/tulip flowers** on stalks, rising from a **bulb** — the showiest bloom in the book.

IDENTIFICATION

- *Old / historical*: MS heading **Hermodactylus** ("Hermes' finger," from the finger-like corm); It. *ermodatilo*.
- *Modern accepted*: ***Colchicum autumnale* L.** (autumn crocus/meadow saffron, Colchicaceae) — the source of the "hermodactyls" of the old pharmacy; sometimes *Iris tuberosa*.
- *Common*: hermodactyl, meadow saffron; It. *colchico*, *ermodatilo*. — **Secure at the tradition** (by name; corm + crocus-flower).

COMMENTARY

The corm ("hermodactyl") is the classic **gout specific** — purgative and anti-inflammatory (the source of colchicine) — but **highly toxic**, dosed with great care.





f. 99v — *Salvia salvatica* — a nature-printed leaf
+ colophon

[Probable — by name + image]



manuscript leaf img 202 · master 0265_0201.tif — (nature print + colophon)

TRANSCRIPTION (AS WRITTEN)

Salvia falvatica (leaf-caption)

- 1 [top-left] N. 39[?] · 100 carte (number 3/5-ambiguous)
- 2 [leaf caption] *Salvia falvatica* ... dal reverfo anguftiffima ... hoc modo nostro
- 3 [red ink, lower-right corner] nigela ... idest 3e[faro/gith?] ... ni ch ftmi[?] / le bianche(le bianche)

Evidence grade (A-D): **A** (direct); **B** (parts recovered by enhancement — see note); **C** (1 supplied word); **D** (3 marked [?]).

ENGLISH TRANSLATION

The closing leaf. Top corner: a cataloguer's mark "N. 39"[?] and "100 carte" — "100 leaves," the book's own statement of its extent. By the printed leaf, a caption naming it **wild sage** (*Salvia salvatica*), noting it is "**very narrow on the reverse**," and «**hoc modo nostro**», "in this our manner" — i.e. recorded by *this impression method*. A small **red-ink gloss** in the corner identifies a **nigella** ("...idest...; the white ones"). (Native-res reading; the caption ink is very faint at master resolution — "100 carte" and the red gloss are the firmly legible inscriptions; the number reads 3/5-ambiguous.)





f. 99v — *Salvia salvatica* — a nature-printed leaf
+ colophon (continued)

DESCRIPTION OF THE PLATE

This closing leaf is among the manuscript's most important pages: it documents a **direct-impression ("nature-print") method** of recording plants, carries the «**hoc modo nostro**» caption, and the "**100 carte**" note that fixes the book's extent at **100 leaves**.

IDENTIFICATION

Name-image relationship: Unresolved — emblematic tradition figure

- *Plant:* the print appears to be a **sage leaf** (*Salvia* sp.) — toothed, veined, ovate — captioned *Salvia salvatica* (wild sage).
- *Method:* a **nature print / direct impression** — a real leaf inked and pressed onto the page, beside the book's painted plates.

COMMENTARY

No medicinal claim recorded — a colophon/specimen leaf rather than a materia-medica entry.

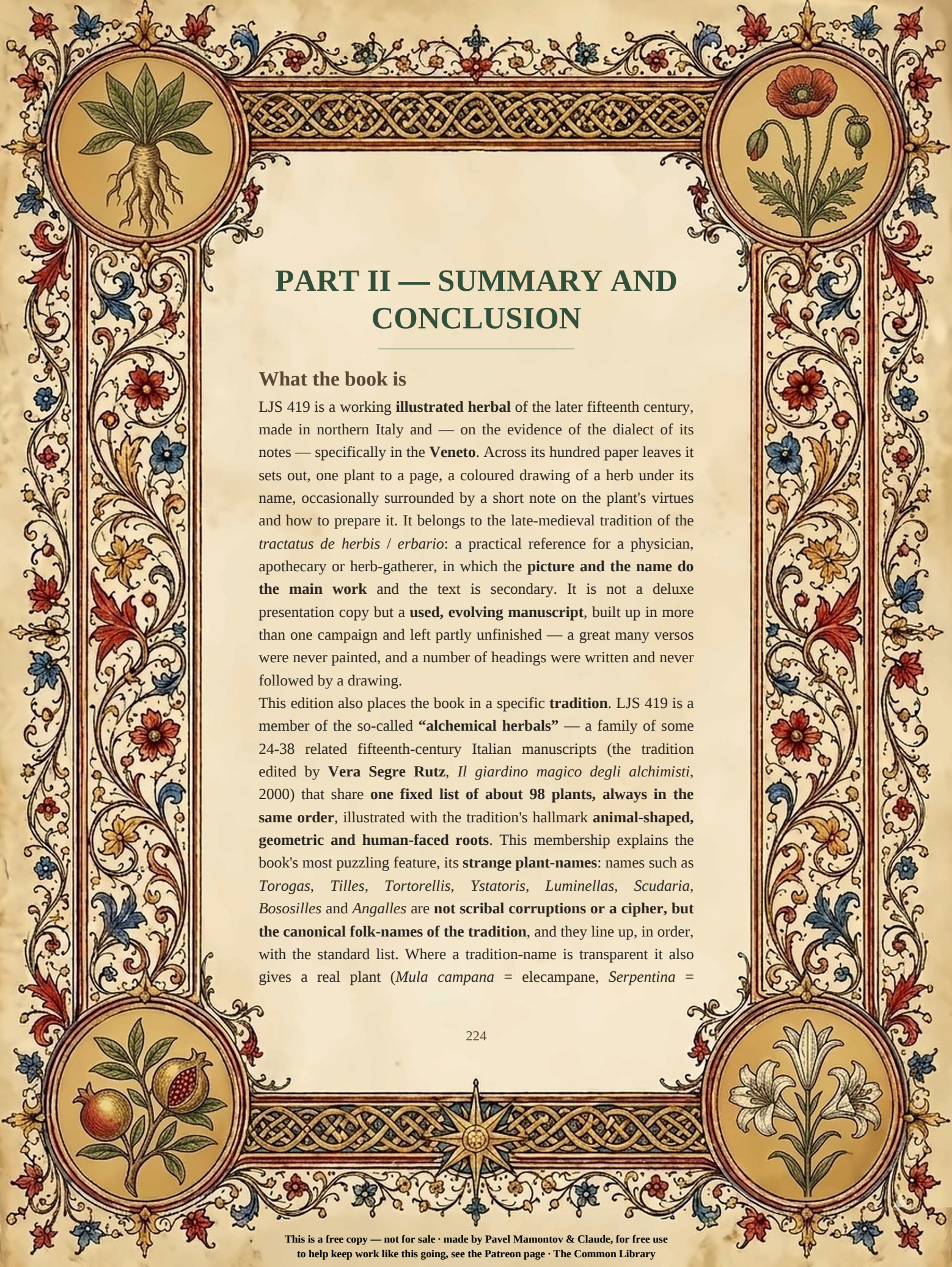




Blank & unfinished leaves

The following 24 leaves carry no plant-drawing and no text. They are almost all blank versos; any faint shapes visible on them are *show-through* from the painted plant on the other side of the leaf. They are listed here for completeness rather than given a page each:

f. 41v · f. 44v · f. 45v · f. 47v · f. 48v · f. 49v · f. 50v · f. 51v · f. 52v
· f. 53v · f. 54v · f. 55v · f. 56v · f. 57v · f. 58v · f. 61v · f. 62v · f.
63v · f. 64v · f. 66v · f. 68v · f. 71v · f. 72v · f. 73v



PART II — SUMMARY AND CONCLUSION

What the book is

LJS 419 is a working **illustrated herbal** of the later fifteenth century, made in northern Italy and — on the evidence of the dialect of its notes — specifically in the **Veneto**. Across its hundred paper leaves it sets out, one plant to a page, a coloured drawing of a herb under its name, occasionally surrounded by a short note on the plant's virtues and how to prepare it. It belongs to the late-medieval tradition of the *tractatus de herbis* / *erbario*: a practical reference for a physician, apothecary or herb-gatherer, in which the **picture and the name do the main work** and the text is secondary. It is not a deluxe presentation copy but a **used, evolving manuscript**, built up in more than one campaign and left partly unfinished — a great many versos were never painted, and a number of headings were written and never followed by a drawing.

This edition also places the book in a specific **tradition**. LJS 419 is a member of the so-called “**alchemical herbals**” — a family of some 24-38 related fifteenth-century Italian manuscripts (the tradition edited by **Vera Segre Rutz**, *Il giardino magico degli alchimisti*, 2000) that share **one fixed list of about 98 plants, always in the same order**, illustrated with the tradition's hallmark **animal-shaped, geometric and human-faced roots**. This membership explains the book's most puzzling feature, its **strange plant-names**: names such as *Torogas*, *Tilles*, *Tortorellis*, *Ystatoris*, *Luminellas*, *Scudaria*, *Bososilles* and *Angalles* are **not scribal corruptions or a cipher, but the canonical folk-names of the tradition**, and they line up, in order, with the standard list. Where a tradition-name is transparent it also gives a real plant (*Mula campana* = elecampane, *Serpentina* =



dragon-arum, *Pionia* = peony, *Betonega* = betony). Each matched leaf now carries its **tradition-name and Segre Rutz number** in its entry; a full folio-by-folio alignment is in the companion concordance.

The plants

The repertory is the standard medieval-Mediterranean *materia medica*, read here leaf by leaf from **f. 1r (tormentil) to f. 99v**. It runs through the common medicinal herbs (betony, sage, rue, oregano, agrimony, centaury, eyebright, germander, costmary, burnet, lungwort), the great purgatives and poisons handled as objects of knowledge (**black and white hellebore, monkshood, bryony, squirting cucumber, oleander, autumn crocus, mandrake**), aromatic and exotic drugs (spikenard, mastic, hypocistis), ferns and "cold" plants (polypody, hart's-tongue, horsetail, navelwort), and a long sequence of roots — dragon-arum, birthwort, cyclamen, peony, rhubarb, madder. Identifications are **secure by name and picture for the great majority** of the named leaves; a residue of headings are too **corrupt or phonetic** to resolve, and are transcribed as they stand. Several traits recur often enough to be characteristic of this particular book:

- **Name/picture divergence.** The workshop sometimes drew a stock plant to a famous name (spikenard drawn as an ivy-leaved vine, "wild sage" as a fern), a reminder that the drawings were not always made from the living plant.
- **Doubled and paired entries.** Some plants appear twice (two oregano plates, two "branca ursina"), and many are deliberately paired as **greater/lesser** or **wild/garden** — *Lucia maggiore* / *minore*, *Ruta salvatica* / *ortense*, black / white hellebore, *Pes columbinus* (dove's-foot) / *Pes corvinus* (crow's-foot), long birthwort and its round companion. This pairing is a structural habit of the compiler.
- **"Fantastic" and magical matter.** A distinctive group of leaves shows **human- and animal-faced roots** (the mandrakes and the "face-root" plates) and, above all, the remarkable **moon-herb cluster** of *Lucida* / *Lucia* and *Lunaria* plants (f. 67v-68r, f. 77r-80v, f. 97r-v)





— luminous herbs believed to **shine at night "like a star"** (*come stella*), drawn with zoomorphic figures and accompanied by **astrological gathering-charms** (gather at the waxing moon in Taurus; wrap in white silk; gather under the planet Jupiter). Higher-contrast re-reading of their notes (f. 67v, f. 75v) shows these are not merely luminous but **counter-magic and healing herbs**: the *Lucida* "**heals every wound**" and "**lifts every spell**" (*lieva ogni magia*), and the "queen-herb" of f. 75v likewise "**leva le magie**" — placing this whole group in the tradition of apotropaic, curse-breaking plants gathered by lunar and planetary timing.

The notes

About **a quarter of the leaves** carry written notes; of these, the legible ones have been transcribed best-effort and translated here. They are not learned commentary but **practical recipes and lore**: a coltsfoot flower-distillate and a lye-and-root **hair-rinse "to make the hair long and blond"** (f. 59v); a depilatory (f. 97v); the "queen-herb" charm with its lunar timing and chastity injunction (f. 75v); habitat-and-keeping notes for the moonworts and for the shade-loving herb of f. 64r; and physician's preparations such as the bryony bath (f. 91v). Their language is a fast, heavily abbreviated **humanistic cursive in Veneto vernacular**, frequently written around or over the drawing, and is in places at the very limit of what the digital images will yield.

The closing leaf

The book ends with one of its most interesting pages: **f. 99v is a nature print** — an actual leaf inked and pressed directly onto the paper, captioned *hoc modo nostro*, "in this our manner." Beside the painted herbal, the maker recorded a plant by **direct impression**, one of the earliest expressions of a technique that would not be described in print for another century. A later hand has noted the book's extent on the same leaf: "*100 carte.*"



The page is framed by an elaborate decorative border. The top and bottom borders feature a repeating geometric knotwork pattern. The left and right borders are composed of vertical panels with floral motifs, including red and blue flowers and scrolling vines. At the four corners, there are circular medallions: top-left shows a plant with a thick, knotted root; top-right shows a red poppy; bottom-left shows a pomegranate; and bottom-right shows a white lily. The page number '227' is centered at the bottom.

Conclusion

LJS 419 is best understood as a **practitioner's herbal of the Veneto, c. 1450-1500**, compiled in stages from more than one model, mixing the **inherited medieval iconography** (schematic plants, magical roots, moon-herbs) with episodes of **fresh naturalistic observation** (the later coloured versos, and the nature print that closes the volume). Its value is threefold: as a **witness to the working vernacular pharmacy** of fifteenth-century northern Italy; as a vivid document of **herbal magic and astrological gathering-lore** surviving inside an otherwise practical book; and as an early instance of **nature printing**. The present edition reads the whole of it page by page, transcribing every legible name and note, translating the notes, and identifying the plants — while marking honestly, throughout, the boundary between what the manuscript securely says and what the modern reader can only probably infer.

PART III — STATISTICS AND DATA FOR REPLICATION

Everything needed to characterise, reconstruct or facsimile the manuscript, gathered in one place. Physical figures are from the Schoenberg/Kislak catalogue description; content figures are tallied from this edition.

A. Physical specification (the "spec sheet")

Parameter	Value
Repository shelfmark	/ UPenn, Kislak Center, Schoenberg Collection, Oversize LJS 419
Date / origin	15th century, Northern Italy (Veneto)
Support	Paper (laid; period Italian stock)
Extent	100 leaves, collation [i], 1-99; ink foliation upper-right recto
Leaf size	245 x 176 mm
Bound size	254 x 190 mm
Quire structure	$1^1 \cdot 2^{10(-1)} \cdot 3 \cdot 10^8 \cdot 11^3 \cdot 12^{8(-1)} \cdot 13 \cdot 14^8$
Layout	One plant per page; name as a heading (upper-left or upper-centre, occasionally red); drawing centred; notes set around/over the drawing
Script	Humanistic cursive (notes); display-ish heading hand for names

Languages	Italian (Veneto dialect) + Latin, vernacular-Latinate mix; many corrupt/phonetic names
Illustration campaigns	(1) medieval-convention coloured plants (often recto), some with <i>fantastic</i> faces; (2) rough naturalistic ink-outline (often verso/added); (3) naturalistic coloured plants (verso)
Binding	Contemporary limp parchment , ties on three sides; " Erbario " inked on upper cover
Rights	Public domain (CC Public Domain Mark); facsimiles on OPenn & BiblioPhilly

B. Content tally (from this edition)

Measure	Count
Leaves (folios)	100 (~ 200 page-sides)
Page-side entries catalogued here	199 (incl. front leaf [i])
Blank / unfinished leaves	24
Page-sides bearing a plant drawing	~ 170
Leaves carrying written notes	29 leaves carry a transcribed and translated note (~ a quarter of the leaves — matches the catalogue estimate); 8 of these are substantial recipe/charm notes

Identifications by confidence tier 84 Secure · 13 Probable · 65 Tentative · 13 Unresolved + 24 blank/unfinished = 199 catalogued page-sides (recounted from the entries; the front flyleaf is counted among the Tentative)

= uncertain identifications (Tentative + Unresolved) 78 (corrupt names and/or schematic drawings)

"Fantastic" leaves (faced roots, zoomorphic figures, moon-herbs) ~20

Approx. word-count of this reading edition ~47,000 (grown by the tradition concordance, tradition-names, and the per-leaf Name-image and structured-morphology apparatus)

The 8 substantial notes (recipes & gathering-charms) are: f. 59v, 64r, 67v, 68r, 75v, 78v, 91v, 97v. A further ~21 leaves carry shorter transcribed-and-translated notes (e.g. f. 1r, 1v, 5v, 18v, 19r, 21v, 24v, 25r, 26v, 31r, 40v, 46v ...), for 29 noted leaves in total. (Note-placement convention: substantial original-language notes appear in a dedicated "Notes — transcription" block with the English under Translation; shorter notes sit inline in the Transcription block.)

C. Folio / facsimile-image conversion (to find any leaf)

- f. N recto = OPenn/PDF image $2N + 3$ (e.g. f. 1r = image 5; f. 50r = image 103).
- f. N verso = image $2N + 4$.
- Master TIFF for image $k = 0265_{-}\{(k-1):04d\}.tif$ (e.g. image 122 = 0265_0121.tif).

• High-resolution masters: https://openn.library.upenn.edu/Data/0001/ljs419/data/master/0265_XXXX.tif (~ 3378 x 4296 px); the bound facsimile PDF embeds only ~ 1415 x 1800 px.

D. Palette and materials (observed in the drawings)

Element	Colourants typical of such a book
Leaves / stems	verdigris / vegetable greens (copper-green and plant-green, two distinct greens visible)
Roots	iron-gall brown outline with brown/ochre wash; some red lead / red earth "serpentine" and "tentacle" roots
Flowers / fruit	reds (red lead, red lake), yellows (orpiment/ochre), blues (azurite/indigo) for the star- and bell-flowers
Text & outlines	iron-gall ink (measured here as brown and fairly saturated — close in hue to the brown roots, which defeats colour-based text/illustration separation)
Headings	iron-gall; occasionally red
Support prep	none elaborate; plain laid paper

E. Script & abbreviation (to imitate the hand)

A **Veneto humanistic cursive**, written quickly: frequent ç for z/c, x for s/sc (e.g. *fxe*, *uxi*), the tilde for n/m and for -us/-um contractions, &/et ligatures, çoe (= *cioè*, "that is"), p (*per/pro*), and phonetic doubling. Plant-names are Latinate but often **vernacularised or corrupted** (*rigamo* = origano; *eleboro*; *ipoquistidos*). Full conventions are set out in **Appendix A**.



F. A practical "recipe" to recreate a comparable leaf

1. **Paper:** a laid sheet trimmed to 245 x 176 mm.
2. **Layout:** write the **plant-name** as a heading, upper-left or upper-centre, in iron-gall (occasionally red).
3. **Drawing:** centre **one plant** on the page, showing **root, stem, leaf and (where known) flower/fruit**; outline in iron-gall, then wash with greens (leaf), brown/ochre (root), and spot reds/yellows/blues (flowers). For the "fantastic" manner, give the root a **human or animal face**, or paint it as a **red serpentine/tentacle form**.
4. **Note (optional, ~¼ of leaves):** in a fast cursive, set a short **recipe or gathering-charm** around or partly over the drawing — humoral virtues, a preparation (distilled water, lye decoction, bath), and any **astrological timing** ("at the waxing moon in Taurus," "under Jupiter").
5. **Sequence:** group some plants in **greater/lesser** or **wild/garden** pairs; leave many **versos blank** (the book was never finished).
6. **Closing flourish:** make a **nature print** — ink a real leaf and press it to the page — and caption it *hoc modo nostro*.
7. **Binding:** sew the quires (per the collation above) into **limp parchment** with ties on three sides; ink the title "**Erbario**" on the cover.

G. High-resolution reading, enhancement & machine corroboration

So that the difficult readings can be judged and reproduced, the full workflow is set out here.

Image sources & resolution. Routine reading used the bound facsimile PDF (embedded images ~ 1415 x 1800 px). For the hardest notes the **master TIFFs** from OPenn (3378 x 4296 px, ~ 2.4x linear) were used — file `k = 0265_{k-1:04d}.tif` (see §C). The three densest magical notes (f. 67v, 75v, 78v) were re-read at master resolution; the finding was that the master sharpens the diagnostic words but the remaining gaps are **physical abrasion of the ink, not scan resolution**.





Enhancement workflow (applied to faded / cramped / bled-through notes, in order):

- **Foxing-restoration** — local-contrast equalisation (CLAHE) plus morphological background-normalisation, lifting faded iron-gall strokes off the parchment.
- **Decorrelation stretch** — a DStretch-style stretch in CIE-LAB that amplifies the residual *iron-stain colour* where the black organic ink has flaked but the brown stain remains; this recovered, e.g., *leva le magie* on f. 75v. The same stretch also **separates writing from a drawing rendered in the same ink**: because the line-ink and the figure's wash differ very slightly in hue, the stretch pushes them to different colours (the writing dark-red, the figure orange), so text crossing a drawing becomes legible. This is how the **15-line salamander note** on f. 67v was read, and it independently **confirmed** the same-ink notes on f. 64r (the Trinity charm), f. 88r and f. 91v.
- **Upscaling + overlapping tiling** — cramped, letter-touching lines are up-sampled so the eye (and the recogniser) sees enough pixels.
- **Recto-verso subtraction** — because both sides of every leaf exist, show-through is removed by registering the mirrored verso and erasing only faint front pixels that coincide with real back-ink (used where bleed-through overlaps the text, e.g. behind f. 76r).

Machine corroboration (a *second opinion*, never an authority):

- **Model: CATMuS-Medieval** (a general medieval-Latin/vernacular hand model) run through **Kraken** — **not fine-tuned** on this scribe.
- **Wallis local-contrast filter** — normalises every neighbourhood to a target mean/variance, which forces **very faint ink** (barely above the parchment) up to full contrast where a global stretch cannot. Best for the faintest single lines (e.g. the f. 17r caption, recovered in full); pairs with a **Sato ridge filter** that enhances thin strokes by their shape rather than their darkness.
- **Ensemble method**: each line is read **four ways** (plain grey · foxing-restore · decorrelation-stretch · strong-CLAHE) and scored by **model character-probability x cross-variant agreement**, graded HIGH / MEDIUM / LOW. Lines that several independent enhancements read the *same way* are trustworthy; disagreement flags a line for human review.



- **Honest limits:** the tool has **no validated error rate** on this hand and its raw output is gist-level. It **supports** a reading by independent convergence but **does not prove it**; **every reading printed in this edition is the editor's judgement from the images.**

Verification outcome. The engine independently agreed with the notes read confidently (f. 59v *fegato / fuse palido / tornar il colore*; f. 68r *aqua a l'ambico ... luce la nocte*; f. 75v *a luna crescente in segno di Tauro ... leva le magie*; f. 97v *pelo*) and came out garbled on exactly the two we had flagged fragmentary (f. 64r, f. 91v) — a useful check in both directions.

Leaf	Engine result	Effect on confidence
f. 59v, 67v, 75v, 78v, 68r, 97v	diagnostic words independently recovered	^ confirmed
f. 64r, 91v	engine also reads them as low-confidence / garbled	= validates the "fragmentary" flag

Software. Python (OpenCV, Pillow, pypdfium2); Kraken (PyTorch, CPU); the engine and its CLI live in `Visual2/htr_engine/ensemble.py`, `bleedthrough.py`.

H. Sources & references

This is an independent reading of a public-domain manuscript; no modern copyrighted edition was reproduced. Works and resources consulted or cited:

- **Primary source / facsimile:** UPenn, Kislak Center, Schoenberg Collection, **Oversize LJS 419**; digital facsimile and master TIFFs on **OPenn** (openn.library.upenn.edu) and **BiblioPhilly**; catalogue record (Schoenberg/Kislak) for collation, date and physical description.





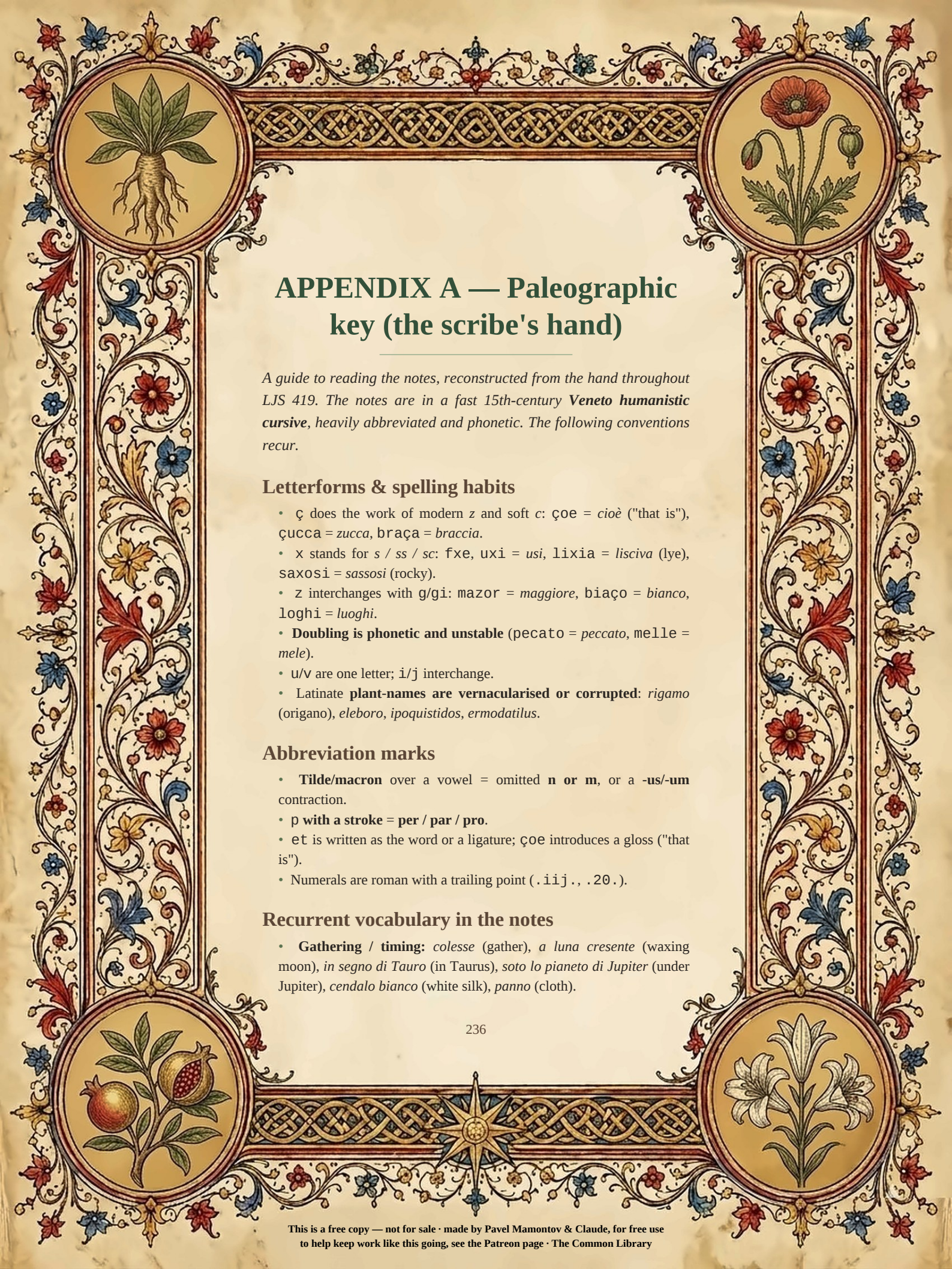
• **External identification cited (unverified):** B. Beasley, unpublished M.A. thesis on alchemical herbals (Univ. of Oklahoma, 2024) — proposed the *Isatis tinctoria* (woad) reading of f. 42r. **The present editors have not been able to verify this source;** accordingly f. 42r is held at family level (Brassicaceae) and the species is recorded only as that thesis's proposal, not as an adopted identification.

• **Medical-historical background** (for the *materia medica* notes): the Salernitan tradition and the *Circa instans* / *Tractatus de herbis* family of herbals, and standard reference works on medieval/Renaissance pharmacy and plant nomenclature. These inform the commentary generally; specific period attestations (e.g. the f. 59v cosmetic recipe, the lunar-gathering charms) are noted as belonging to that tradition rather than tied to a single edition.

• **Botanical nomenclature:** modern accepted names follow standard botanical authorities (genus *species* + author).

Where the commentary calls a usage "well-attested" it refers to this general tradition; readers wanting chapter-and-verse should consult the works above and the standard literature.





APPENDIX A — Paleographic key (the scribe's hand)

A guide to reading the notes, reconstructed from the hand throughout LJS 419. The notes are in a fast 15th-century Veneto humanistic cursive, heavily abbreviated and phonetic. The following conventions recur.

Letterforms & spelling habits

- ç does the work of modern z and soft c: çoe = cioè ("that is"), çucca = zucca, braça = braccia.
- x stands for s / ss / sc: fxe, uxi = usi, lixia = lisciva (lye), saxosi = sassosi (rocky).
- z interchanges with g/gi: mazor = maggiore, biaço = bianco, loghi = luoghi.
- **Doubling is phonetic and unstable** (pecato = peccato, melle = mele).
- u/v are one letter; i/j interchange.
- Latinate **plant-names are vernacularised or corrupted**: rigamo (origano), eleboro, ipoquistidos, ermodatilus.

Abbreviation marks

- Tilde/macron over a vowel = omitted n or m, or a -us/-um contraction.
- p with a stroke = per / par / pro.
- et is written as the word or a ligature; çoe introduces a gloss ("that is").
- Numerals are roman with a trailing point (. iij ., .20.).

Recurrent vocabulary in the notes

- **Gathering / timing**: colesse (gather), a luna crescente (waxing moon), in segno di Tauro (in Taurus), soto lo pianeto di Jupiter (under Jupiter), cendalo bianco (white silk), panno (cloth).



- **Places:** *nasce in* (grows in), *monti alpestri*, *prati* (meadows), *loghi humidi / saxosi / marini*.
- **Preparation:** *suzo* (juice), *polvere* (powder), *aqua a l'ambico* (distilled water), *bulire* (boil), *ungere* (anoint), *bagno* (bath), *cu'l late / cu'l mele* (with milk / honey).
- **Virtues:** *leva le magie* (lifts spells), *solda ogni ferita* (heals every wound), *luce la nocte* (glows at night), *come stella* (like a star), *guarisce* (heals).

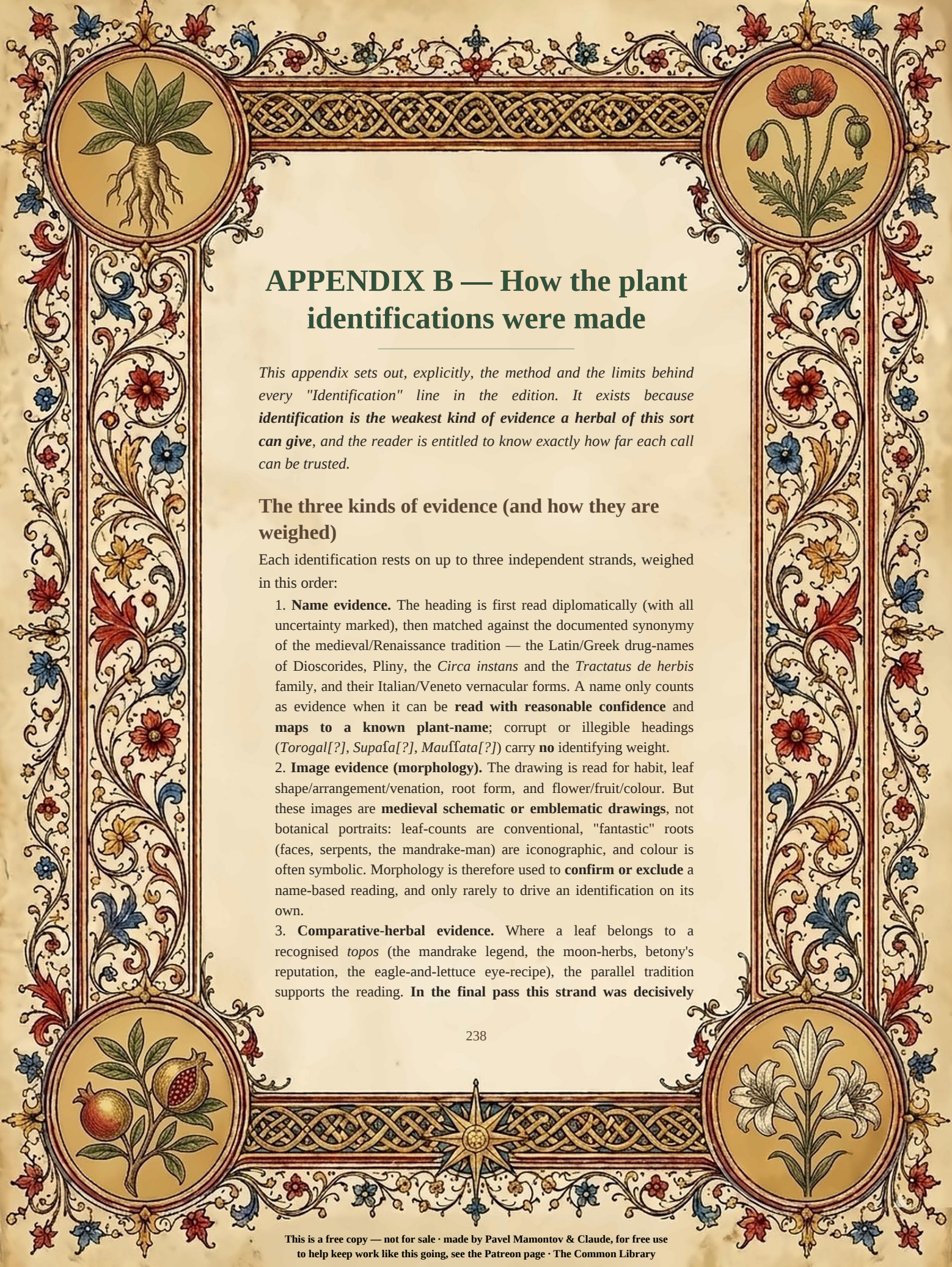
Editorial sigla

The notation keeps four different things apart, so the reader always knows where the manuscript ends and the editor begins:

- [?] — *doubtful reading*: the letters are there but uncertain (*salbiazi*[?]).
- [...] — *lost / illegible text*: nothing recoverable at that point.
- [word] — *editorial restoration*: a word **supplied** from sense or context where the ink is gone ([*osso*] *rotto*); always conjectural.
- [= ...] — *expansion / modern equivalent*: an abbreviation spelled out or a modern gloss of what is written (*p[i]etra*, [= *occhi*]).
- / — line-break in the original; + a cross/maltese mark.

By this scheme, *translation* renders only what is transcribed; where a fragmentary note forced heavy restoration the entry says so and the brackets show exactly which words were supplied rather than read.





APPENDIX B — How the plant identifications were made

This appendix sets out, explicitly, the method and the limits behind every "Identification" line in the edition. It exists because identification is the weakest kind of evidence a herbal of this sort can give, and the reader is entitled to know exactly how far each call can be trusted.

The three kinds of evidence (and how they are weighed)

Each identification rests on up to three independent strands, weighed in this order:

1. **Name evidence.** The heading is first read diplomatically (with all uncertainty marked), then matched against the documented synonymy of the medieval/Renaissance tradition — the Latin/Greek drug-names of Dioscorides, Pliny, the *Circa instans* and the *Tractatus de herbis* family, and their Italian/Veneto vernacular forms. A name only counts as evidence when it can be **read with reasonable confidence** and **maps to a known plant-name**; corrupt or illegible headings (*Torogal*[], *Supafa*[], *Mauffata*[]) carry **no** identifying weight.
2. **Image evidence (morphology).** The drawing is read for habit, leaf shape/arrangement/venation, root form, and flower/fruit/colour. But these images are **medieval schematic or emblematic drawings**, not botanical portraits: leaf-counts are conventional, "fantastic" roots (faces, serpents, the mandrake-man) are iconographic, and colour is often symbolic. Morphology is therefore used to **confirm or exclude** a name-based reading, and only rarely to drive an identification on its own.
3. **Comparative-herbal evidence.** Where a leaf belongs to a recognised *topos* (the mandrake legend, the moon-herbs, betony's reputation, the eagle-and-lettuce eye-recipe), the parallel tradition supports the reading. **In the final pass this strand was decisively**



strengthened. LJS 419 was identified as a member of the “**alchemical herbal**” tradition (edited by Vera Segre Rutz, *Il giardino magico degli alchimisti*, 2000) — a family of ~24-38 manuscripts sharing **one fixed list of ~98 plants in a fixed order**. Aligning our folios to that canonical list (via Philip Neal’s summary of Segre Rutz) showed that most of the “corrupt” headings are in fact **canonical tradition-names** (*Torogas*, *Tilles*, *Tortorellis*, *Ystatoris*, *Luminellas*, *Scudaria*, *Bososilles*, *Angalles*), not scribal noise; ~30+ folios now carry their **tradition-name and Segre Rutz number** (see each entry’s *Tradition-name* line and the companion concordance). This resolves the **names** as tradition-names and, where the folk-name is transparent, yields a real plant (*Mula campana* = elecampane; *Serpentina* = dragon-arum; *Pionia* = peony). The remaining step — reading the same-position plant in the **digitised parallels** (Pavia Aldini 211, Oxford Can. Misc. 408, Paris BnF Lat. 17844/17848, Trent 1591) to take Segre Rutz’s own identification verbatim — is now a targeted IIF task, not an open question.

The weighting system (the four confidence tiers)

- **Secure** — name and image agree, or the name is unambiguous and the drawing is consistent (e.g. the mandrakes, the orchids’ twin tubers, madder’s dye-root). A species or genus may be named.
- **Probable** — one strand is strong and the other is consistent but not decisive.
- **Tentative** — the identification rests on **one** strand only (usually a stylized image, or a name that the image does not confirm). **As a rule, Tentative entries are now held at genus or family level, or left unidentified** — a species is given only where a **securely-read name** demands it (and the image-mismatch is then flagged).
- **Unresolved** — neither the name nor the image yields a defensible identification; the entry is marked *unidentified*.

The conservatism rule (added in the final pass)

Following review, the edition was swept for the specific failure the reviewer rightly fears — **species-level certainty drawn from a**



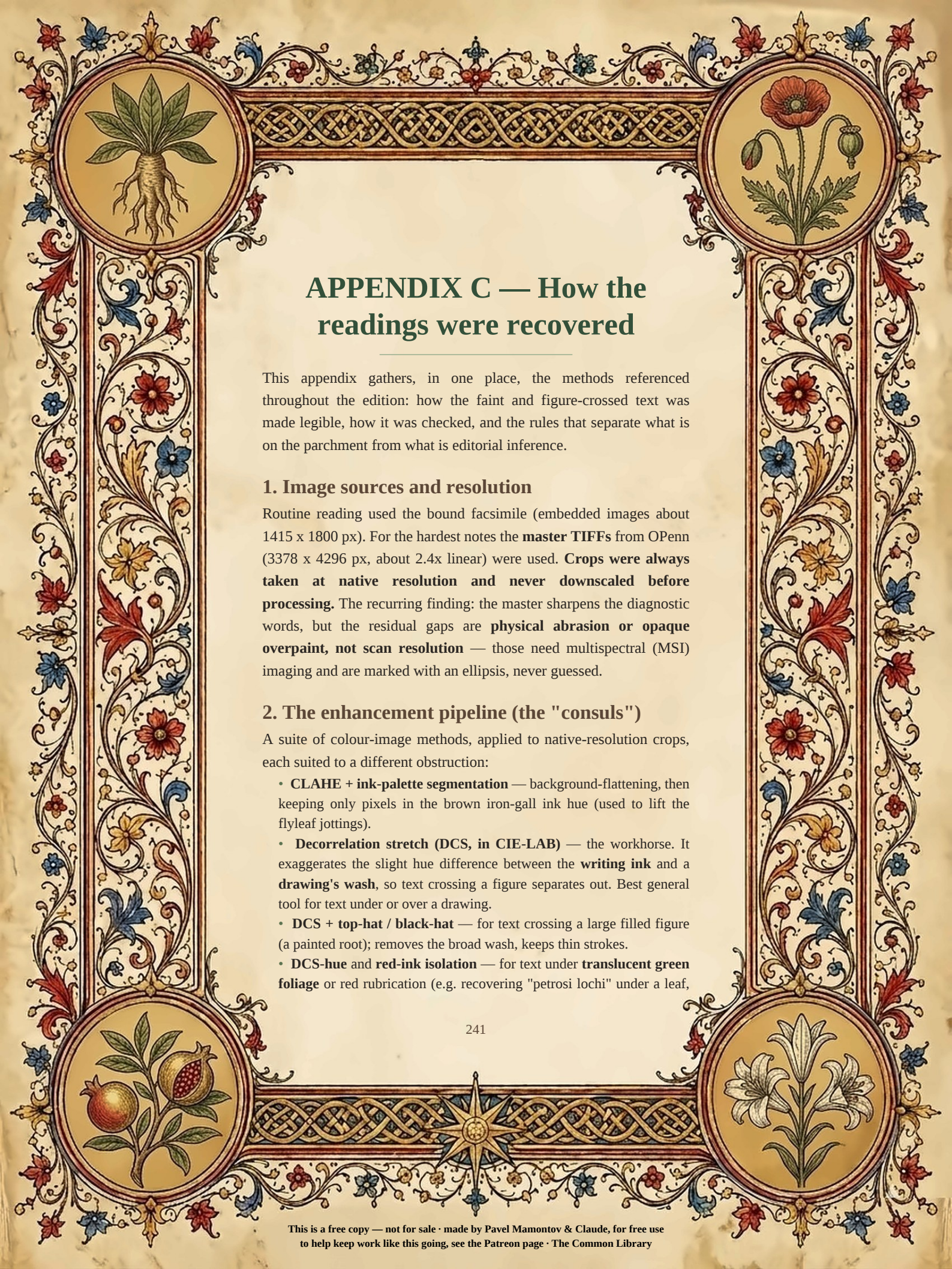


corrupt name plus a stylized image. Where a species rested only on morphology, it was **downgraded to genus, family, or "unidentified"** (e.g. f.8r = bindweed, Convolvulaceae; f.14r = *Valeriana* sp.; f.22v = Ranunculaceae only; f.3r = *Cardamine* sp.). A binomial is now retained on a Tentative entry **only** when it follows from a **securely-read name** (e.g. f.28v *Camepitos* = *Ajuga chamaepitys*, with the name/image mismatch noted) or from **specific iconography** (e.g. f.42r, whose blue dye-root suggests woad/*Isatis* — a reading proposed by an **unverified 2024 thesis** and held here only at family level).

The honest bottom line

Of the identified leaves, roughly **two in five are Tentative or Unresolved** (see Part III). This is **not** a defect of the edition but a true property of the manuscript: a fifteenth-century practitioner's herbal, drawn in convention and named in corrupt vernacular, simply does **not** yield modern species for most of its plants. The transcription layer is more secure than the identification layer, and the reader should treat every "Modern accepted" line as **editorial inference graded by the tier shown**, not as botanical fact.





APPENDIX C — How the readings were recovered

This appendix gathers, in one place, the methods referenced throughout the edition: how the faint and figure-crossed text was made legible, how it was checked, and the rules that separate what is on the parchment from what is editorial inference.

1. Image sources and resolution

Routine reading used the bound facsimile (embedded images about 1415 x 1800 px). For the hardest notes the **master TIFFs** from OPenn (3378 x 4296 px, about 2.4x linear) were used. **Crops were always taken at native resolution and never downscaled before processing.** The recurring finding: the master sharpens the diagnostic words, but the residual gaps are **physical abrasion or opaque overpaint, not scan resolution** — those need multispectral (MSI) imaging and are marked with an ellipsis, never guessed.

2. The enhancement pipeline (the "consuls")

A suite of colour-image methods, applied to native-resolution crops, each suited to a different obstruction:

- **CLAHE + ink-palette segmentation** — background-flattening, then keeping only pixels in the brown iron-gall ink hue (used to lift the flyleaf jottings).
- **Decorrelation stretch (DCS, in CIE-LAB)** — the workhorse. It exaggerates the slight hue difference between the **writing ink** and a **drawing's wash**, so text crossing a figure separates out. Best general tool for text under or over a drawing.
- **DCS + top-hat / black-hat** — for text crossing a large filled figure (a painted root); removes the broad wash, keeps thin strokes.
- **DCS-hue and red-ink isolation** — for text under **translucent green foliage** or red rubrication (e.g. recovering "petrosi lochi" under a leaf,

f.11v).

- **Wallis / Wallis + Sato** local-contrast and ridge filters — for faint, thin strokes.
- **palette (3-darkest-ink clustering)** and **green-suppress** — for notes among green leaf-wash.

These were validated empirically. A test of **NMF / ICA spectral unmixing** on the three hardest leaves (f.6v, f.78v, f.91v) was found to **bury** the faint ink in noise — DCS + top-hat beat it decisively — so unmixing was not adopted.

3. Line segmentation

Lines were located with **Kraken's blla baseline segmenter**; a small **U-Net** (trained on 176 hand-drawn text/drawing/background masks) was also trained to separate writing from illustration on figure-heavy leaves. This handled the manuscript's habit of writing **around and across** the plant, including the **split-by-image** layouts where one sentence reads across a central figure (e.g. f.30r, f.88r).

4. Machine corroboration (HTR) — a secondary aid only

The **CATMuS-Medieval** handwriting model (run via Kraken on a GPU) read each noted leaf independently, as a **second witness** to the editors' own reading — never as the primary text. Its raw output was **frequently garbled** and the model was **never successfully fine-tuned to this hand**, so it functioned as a **fallible prompt, not an authority**: combined with the enhancement panel (informally **Armageddon**), every machine reading was compared **line by line** against the **high-resolution image**, with a 1,522-token Veneto/Latin herbal lexicon supporting decoding. Where the machine reading and the editors' reading **diverged**, the conflict was adjudicated against the high-resolution image — this is what caught genuine misreadings (e.g. f.5v *restrengre* not *refrigera*; f.26v *dolor de corpo ... per ventosita* not *trizaca*; f.76v *caldo e seco* not *fredo*; f.78v *multiplicar*



l'oro et l'argento not moltissime cose). Every reading printed here is the editors' own judgement from the image; the HTR was consulted, not transcribed.

5. Evidence grades (A-D)

Every noted entry closes with an **Evidence grade** tag making explicit how much rests on the parchment versus inference (full definition in the front matter): **A** directly visible (incl. expanded abbreviations); **B** visible only after enhancement; **C** a whole word supplied from context (square brackets); **D** a doubtful reading (marked with a query); lost text is shown as an ellipsis (ungraded).

6. Reconstruction rules

- Doubtful readings are queried; editorial supply from sense or parallel text is bracketed; lost text is an ellipsis. Nothing is silently supplied.
- Where a reading is restored from a standard herbal *topos* (the mandrake legend, the moon-herb lore, betony's profile), it is offered as **a marked conjecture**, never as plain text; and the *Commentary* — drawn from the external herbal tradition — is **never** used as evidence for the reading or the identification.
- Diplomatic transcription is **original-language only**; English belongs in the *Translation* and *Identification* sections.

7. The integrity guards

A set of automated **consistency guards** is run over the whole edition after every change, as a reproducible self-audit: title-vs-heading agreement; confidence-tier consistency; translation coverage; last-line-vs-translation; English-gloss-in-transcription; line-count vs machine reading (advisory); edition-vs-CATMuS divergence (advisory); transcription-vs-translation quality-word agreement (e.g. *caldo* must not be rendered "cold"); Evidence-grade-tag accuracy; and English-plant-name leaks into translations. They do not replace editorial judgement, but they keep the edition internally consistent and





flag drift for review.

— End of the edition (final, checked & consolidated). —

